



Manual on Electronic Voting Machine

Edition 9
August 2026



भारत निर्वाचन आयोग
Election Commission of India

Nirvachan Sadan, Ashoka Road, New Delhi-110001
“Greater Participation for a stronger democracy”

Manual on Electronic Voting Machine

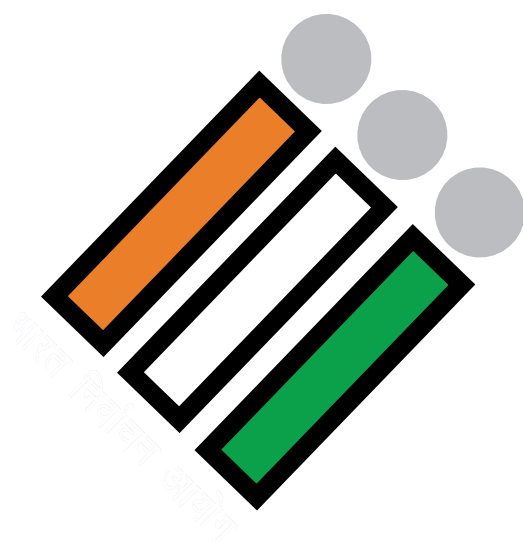
(Ballot Unit + Control Unit + VVPAT)

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PREFACE

The use of Electronic Voting Machine (EVM) has revolutionized the Electoral System and introduction of Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) system has provided greater transparency to the poll process. EVM means Ballot Unit (BU), Control Unit (CU) and Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) unit unless specified particular unit.

This is the **9th Edition** of Manual on Electronic Voting Machine which has been updated in view of progressive decisions taken by the Commission and directions/instructions/guidelines issued on use of EVM since the last Edition. The Manual shall prevail in case of any difference with earlier directions/instructions/guidelines of ECI in the subject matter. Henceforth, for any reference in the subject matter, relevant sub-para, para and Chapter may be referred.

The Manual has been divided into four parts for ease of understanding. Part-I covers introduction, storage and movement of EVMs during non-election period, First Level Checking and Training & Awareness. Part-II covers all processes from first randomization to counting of votes including EVM Checking and Verification. Part-III gives legal perspective of EVMs alongwith precautions, documentation and responsibilities. Part-IV contains all Annexures and Formats.

It is hoped that this Manual will be useful to all election related officials and other stakeholders. The Commission would welcome suggestions from all users of this Manual for making it more informative and useful in future.

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INTRODUCTION

An EVM consists of three units, namely, Ballot Unit (BU) with a cable (5 m long), Control Unit (CU) and Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) unit with a cable (5 m long).



CONTROL UNIT (CU)- Control Unit is kept with the Presiding Officer/Polling Officer to enable the Ballot Unit to accept vote from the voter and store the vote cast.

Control Unit runs on a power pack (Battery) of 7.5 volts.



BALLOT UNIT (BU)- Ballot Unit(s) is kept along with VVPAT in the voting compartment. When a voter presses the blue button against the candidate of his choice in Ballot Unit, the red light glows against the candidate of his choice in the Ballot Unit.

On the right side of the BU along the candidate's vote button, digits 1 to 16 are embossed in Braille signage for guidance of visually impaired electors. A Ballot Unit caters up to 16 candidates. 24 (twenty four) Ballot Units can be cascaded together for catering to 384 candidates (including NOTA) which can be used with one Control Unit. Power Packs are inserted in 5th, 9th, 13th, 17th and 21st Ballot Unit, if more than 4 BUs are connected to a Control Unit.



VOTER VERIFIABLE PAPER AUDIT TRAIL (VVPAT)- allows the voters to verify that their votes are cast as intended. A paper slip showing the serial number, name and the symbol of the candidate of his choice is generated and is visible for about 7 seconds through transparent lighted window of VVPAT. The VVPAT slip gets cut and falls into a sealed box in the VVPAT machine.

VVPAT runs on a power pack (Battery) of 22.5 volts.

ECI has been continuously using EVMs in every election to Parliamentary and Assembly Constituencies since 2000 and VVPATs since 2017 with active participation of the Political Parties and Candidates. EVMs have been used so far in all constituencies in 163 General Elections to State Legislative Assemblies and 05 General Elections to Lok Sabha (2004, 2009, 2014, 2019 and 2024) besides several bye-elections. There is no doubt in fairness and integrity of EVMs which have stood the test of several elections, public and legal scrutiny over the years.

EVM is a Standalone machine with no Radio frequency communication capability, hence cannot communicate through wireless, Bluetooth, wifi etc. It incorporates several technological security features such as One Time Programmable chip, Unauthorised Access Detect Module, advance encryption techniques, strong mutual

authentication capability, dynamic coding of key presses and Real Time Clock for date and time stamping key presses etc. Also, Election Commission of India has put in place stringent and secure administrative procedures during storage and movement, and opening and closing of EVM warehouse/strong room during non-election period till counting is done in the presence of the recognised political parties/candidates under videography. Further, first level checking, two stage randomization, commissioning, dispersal, mock poll, actual poll and counting etc. is done in the presence of representatives of recognized political parties/candidates along with videography at every stage of the electoral process.

Around 42 petitions on EVM have been filed before various High Courts and Hon'ble Supreme Court of India. After going through various aspects of the technological soundness and the administrative measures involved in the use of EVMs, the Honourable courts have repeatedly held that EVMs are credible, reliable and tamperproof.

For further details, kindly read Status Paper on EVM, Presentation on EVM, Legal History of EVMs and FAQs on EVM available in the ECI's website (<https://www.eci.gov.in/evm-vvpat>).

CHAPTER-1

STORAGE, SECURITY, OPENING AND CLOSING OF EVM WAREHOUSE/STRONG ROOM, MOVEMENT/SHIFTING OF EVMs

1.1. Various types of EVM Storages:

- (a) **EVM Warehouse:** EVM warehouse means the designated building having room(s) for storing EVMs during non-election period, after counting of votes and even during election period at District Headquarters or at Tehsil Headquarters in exceptional case(s) with valid reason.
- (b) **EVM Strong Room:** EVM Strong Room means the designated hall/room for storing EVMs from FLC to completion of Election Petition filing period. Various categories of EVM Strong Room include:
 - (i) **FLC Strong Room:** FLC Strong Room means the designated hall/room having FLC OK EVMs after completion of First Level Checking of EVMs.
 - (ii) **Repair Strong Room:** Repair Strong Room means the designated hall/room having FLC-rejected EVMs, un-pollled non-functional EVMs pertaining to Awareness, Training, Commissioning, dispersal, mock poll (Category-C) etc.
 - (iii) **Training & Awareness Strong Room:** Training & Awareness Strong Room means the designated hall/room having EVMs pertaining to Training & Awareness.
 - (iv) **AC/AS Strong Room:** AC/AS Strong Room means the designated hall/room having EVMs after First Randomization of EVMs.
 - (v) **Polled Strong Room:** Polled Strong Room means the designated hall/room having EVMs [Category-A (Polled functional) and Category-B (Polled non-functional)] after completion of poll or Re-poll (if any) till Counting of Votes.
 - (vi) **Reserve Strong Room:** Reserve Strong Room means the designated hall/room having unused reserve EVMs (Category-D) after completion of poll.
 - (vii) **District Strong Room:** District Strong Room means the designated hall/room for storing Category-A (Polled functional) and Category-B (Polled non-functional) EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) after Counting of Votes till Election Petition period.
 - (viii) **Intermediate Strong Room:** Intermediate Strong Room means the designated hall/room meant for storing poll and reserve EVMs on P-2/3 day or P+1 day, if required.

1.2. Location for Storage of EVMs

- (a) District Headquarters/Designated EVM warehouse
- (b) In Treasury
- (c) If it is not possible to store as above, then the alternative storage place shall not be below the Tehsil Headquarters. The same shall be done with valid reasons with the prior approval of the Chief Electoral Officer concerned.
- (d) Warehouse of Food Corporation of India (FCI), Central Warehouse Corporation (CWC) and State Warehouse Corporation (SWC) may be used for storing EVMs only as last resort after exhausting all other options.

- (e) **Storage of EVMs in Educational Institutions:** Where EVMs are stored in any School/Educational Institution due to Election Petition and where the educational institution has requested to vacate the same, the Chief Electoral Officer shall immediately file an application before the Court concerned for shifting EVMs from school/educational institution to alternate storage place (warehouse). The application should contain the purpose of vacation of School/Educational Institution and also the following protocol to be followed for shifting of Election Petition related EVMs:
- (i) A Notice informing the opening of strong room having EVMs involved in EP shall be given to the petitioner(s) and respondent(s) of the EP and recognised political parties, in writing at least 48 hours in advance, requesting them to remain present at the time of opening and closing of the strong room.
 - (ii) The room shall be opened in the presence of the District Election Officer, Petitioner(s) and Respondent(s) of the EP and representatives of recognised political parties.
 - (iii) Petitioner(s) and Respondent(s) of the EP and representatives of recognised political parties shall be allowed to follow the vehicle carrying EVMs.
 - (iv) EVMs shall be stored under double lock system, in the presence of the District Election Officer, Petitioner(s) and Respondent(s) of the EP and representatives of recognised political parties.
 - (v) The strong room shall be sealed in presence of the District Election Officer, Petitioner(s) and Respondent(s) of the EP and the petitioner(s)/Respondent(s) and representatives of recognised political parties shall also be allowed to put their own seals.
 - (vi) The entire process shall be videographed.

Where reason for not vacating school/educational institution cited is lack of space, the Chief Electoral Officer shall review and certify that all other warehouses, including the option of hiring warehouses, has been explored and still there is no space available anywhere in the entire district to store these EVMs.

1.3. Physical Aspects of the EVM warehouse/Strong Room:

- (a) Only one (1) entry/exit point (Single entry and exit for the warehouse/Strong Room).
- (b) Seal all other doors/windows of the warehouse/strong room, if any, using brick-masonry or concrete.
- (c) Install Main switch outside the warehouse/strong room and disconnect electricity of room, where EVMs are kept, after sealing.
- (d) Free from dampness, pests, rodents etc.
- (e) Free from flood/water logging risk/cracks/leakage etc.
- (f) Provide exhaust fan on the front side at the highest feasible point for air-circulation and install strong iron grill at the vent/passage.
- (g) Vacuum Cleaner for each warehouse.
- (h) No other material whether election related or not, to be kept with the EVMs.
- (i) In no case, SEC-EVMs and ECI-EVMs loaned to State Election Commission (SEC) shall be stored in EVM warehouse meant for storage of ECI-EVMs.

- (j) Before storing EVMs in newly constructed warehouse or any EVM warehouse, District Election Officer shall obtain a certificate from the authority concerned to ensure the quality and physical aspects of the EVM warehouse and to be kept on record for future reference.



1.4. Security and Safety arrangements for EVM warehouse/Strong Room

- (a) **Double Lock System** with all keys of each lock with two separate specified officers. Here double lock system means either 2 separate locks on the single entry/exit door or separate locks on two different doors of the same entry/exit.

If EVM warehouse/strong room is at District HQs: all keys of Lock-1 shall be in the custody of District Election Officer (DEO) and all keys of Lock-2 with Dy. DEO or equivalent.

If EVM warehouse outside the District HQs: all keys of Lock-1 shall be in the custody of SDM and all keys of Lock-2 with Tehsildar or equivalent.

Handing over and taking over of the keys are to be a part of Certificate for Transfer of Charge (CTC).

- (b) During non-election period, minimum 1/2 (half) Section of Armed Police for 24x7 security (only Government Security Personnel). When regular police cannot be posted, Home Guards Security as an exception, can be posted with approval of the CEO. Ensure proper maintenance of duty roster of Security Personnel.
- (c) **Installation of CCTV** Camera to capture hall door and corridor with DVR for storing at least 30 days recording. The output of CCTV cameras on LED screen/Monitor should be installed in the security guard room. In case of any complaint regarding storage and security of EVMs, the CCTV recording shall be kept intact till final disposal of complaint with approval of the Chief Electoral Officer concerned.
- (d) Ensure maintenance of Log book for each entry and exit.
- (e) Duty roster for security personnel.
- (f) Adequate fire safety and fire alarm system.
- (g) Videography at the time of opening and closing of warehouse/strong room.

1.5. Protocol for opening and closing of EVM warehouse/Strong Room

- (a) Inform National and State Recognized Political Parties/Candidates in writing at least 24 hours in advance with due acknowledgment about the date and time of opening and closing of EVM warehouse/Strong Room.
- (b) Do not open EVM warehouse/Strong Room having EVMs involved in Election Petition or Court

Case for any purpose.

- (c) DEO to nominate an Officer not below the rank of SDM for the purpose of opening and closing of EVM warehouse/Strong Room.
- (d) Allow representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties to remain present during opening and closing of EVM warehouse/Strong Room.
- (e) Conduct of videography is mandatory for opening and closing of EVM warehouse/Strong Room. Recording of videography shall be preserved as per existing instructions of the Commission.
- (f) **Opening and Closing of EVM warehouse/Strong Room in case of exigencies:** In case of exigencies like flood, fire etc., the CEO/DEO may shift the EVMs under intimation to the Commission and also take post facto approval. The DEO shall inform the CEO on the same day and the CEO shall immediately send report to the Commission with his comment.

If EVMs are pertaining to Election Petition, shift the EVMs in the presence of DEO, petitioner and respondents of Election Petition including recognised political parties, under advance intimation to the Hon'ble Court concerned specifying the reason. In case of exigencies like flood, fire etc., if videography is not feasible, video of opening and closing of the warehouse/strong room shall be made through mobile.

1.6. Master Stock Register: Maintain details of EVMs in a Master Stock Register (MSR) for every EVM warehouse/Strong Room within District as per format in **Annexure-1**.

1.7. Monthly/Quarterly Inspection of EVM warehouse by the DEO/CEO in person (cannot be delegated)

- (a) Monthly inspection of sealed EVM warehouse/strong room every month and submission of inspection report in **Annexure-2** in EVM Management System (EMS).
- (b) Quarterly inspection report of opening and checking of EVM warehouse for internal condition in March, June, September and December every year and submission of inspection report in **Annexure-3** in EMS. National and State Recognized Political Parties shall be invited to remain present during opening and closing of the warehouse, in writing at least 24 hours in advance with due acknowledgment, about the date and time of opening and closing of EVM warehouse.
- (c) It shall be ensured that in no case warehouse/strong room be opened for checking its internal condition (Quarterly Inspection), if it has EVMs pertaining to any Election Petition/Court case and during FLC to finalization of Election Petition status period.
- (d) Time stamping along with GPS location to be printed on photographs while inspecting warehouse.
- (e) Opening and checking of warehouse for its internal condition during rainy season or in case of exigencies, if required and submit the report to the CEO concerned.
- (f) The CEO shall also do inspection of at least one EVM warehouse per Quarter and should countersign the report in **Annexure-3**. Similarly, the EVM Nodal Officer shall also do inspection of one EVM warehouse per month and should countersign the report in **Annexure-2**.
- (g) Inspection of EVM warehouse by the Chief Electoral Officer and the EVM Nodal Officer to be

done in the following ways:-

Officer	Minimum Frequency	Remarks
Chief Electoral Officer	At least one EVM warehouse per Quarter in the State.	Inspection date should coincide with concerned DEO's Quarterly Inspection date. CEO should countersign the report.
EVM State Nodal Officer	One EVM warehouse per month in the State.	Inspection date should coincide with concerned DEO's Monthly Inspection date. EVM State Nodal Officer should countersign the report.

- (h) The CEO shall review consolidated inspection reports received at each interval and immediately proceed to remove any deficiencies pointed out.

1.8. **Transportation/Shifting of EVMs**

- (a) Movement of EVMs shall be through EVM Management System (EMS) only.
- (b) Use only containerized trucks or sealed trucks with proper locking arrangement.
- (c) Seal all trucks transporting EVMs with lock and paper seals.
- (d) Ensure smooth movement to avoid physical damage.
- (e) Use GPS enabled vehicles for movement of EVMs and tracking of movement.
- (f) Written information with acknowledgment to National and State Recognized Political Parties in advance about opening, stocking and sealing of warehouse while shifting of EVMs. However, if no representative attends, the work should not be stopped.
- (g) Videograph the whole process of transfer/receipt of EVMs.
- (h) Adequate foolproof armed security arrangements to be made for the transportation of the EVMs.
- (i) The movement of each of the vehicle carrying EVMs should be closely monitored on daily basis, until it reaches the destination, by the Chief Electoral Officers/District Election Officers of the State concerned through which the vehicles carrying EVMs are to pass.
- (j) One official not below the rank of Tehsildar (or equivalent as known), with each vehicle shall also be appointed by the CEO/DEO and their cell numbers shall be given to officers concerned of States through which vehicle passes, who shall be in contact with the official on monitoring of the transportation of EVMs.
- (k) A signage shall be labeled on the wind-screen of the vehicle carrying EVMs "Election Materials-Urgent" for smooth passage of the vehicle with clear mention of originating and destination places.
- (l) Proper entry of moving out/moving in the EVMs in the Master Stock Register/Movement Register to be ensured by nominated officer with the acknowledgment from the officer receiving the same.
- (m) Responsibility to provide armed security, track GPS movement of vehicles and to inform enroute/destination State/UT/PSU shall be as follows:

Sender	Receiver	Responsibility to		
		Provide Armed Security (by CEO/DEO)	Track GPS Monitoring of vehicles (by CEO/DEO)	Inform enroute/destination States/UTs/PSUs (by CEO/DEO)
State/UT	State/UT	Receiver State/UT	Receiver State/UT	Receiver State/UT
State/UT	PSU	Sender State/UT	Sender State/UT	Sender State/UT
PSU	State/UT	Receiver State/UT	Receiver State/UT	Receiver State/UT

(n) Movement of EVMs from or to or within poll bound State(s)/District(s):

- (i) Movement of EVMs from or to or within poll bound State(s)/District(s) especially during the period commencing from commissioning of EVMs to counting of votes shall be avoided, as there may be possibility of miscommunication/disinformation resulting into avoidable aspersions. However, various essential movements of EVMs originating from or terminating at the poll bound State/District having manufacturing premises/companies cannot sometimes be avoided for several weeks.
- (ii) The manufacturers (BEL & ECIL) and the sender/receiver CEOs shall provide tentative full movement plan of containerized vehicle(s) carrying EVMs to be passed through any enroute State/district in advance to the Chief Electoral Officer by email, letter and telephonically. The Chief Electoral Officer of poll-bound State/UT shall intimate the National and State Recognized Political Parties, in writing, about all such movements of EVMs that is planned through the State/UT and destined to go or come from other States.

(o) Competent Authority to issue order on movement/shifting of EVMs:**(i) PSU (BEL/ECIL) to State/UT:**

- Allocation Order of EVMs from PSU (BEL/ECIL) to States/UTs is to be done by Election Commission of India.
- Transportation arrangement of New EVMs is to be done by PSU concerned.
- Consignee State/UT to depute official alongwith armed security for movement of EVMs.
- State/UT to bear the transportation charges of shifting of EVMs except newly manufactured EVMs.

(ii) Inter-State Movement:

- Allocation Order of EVMs from One State/UT is to other State(s)/UT(s) to be done by Election Commission of India.
- Borrowing State/UT to depute official alongwith armed security at sender State/UT for movement of EVMs.
- Ensure the location of districts for collection of EVMs is in a cluster on the same route.

(iii) Intra-State or Intra-district Movement:

- Allocation Order of EVMs from District(s) to District(s) within the State/UT or within District is to be done by Chief Electoral Officer concerned.
- Share the list of EVMs to National and State Recognized Political Parties.

(iv) States/UTs to PSU:

- Movement Order of non-functional, damaged, recovered and economic life completed etc. EVMs from State/District to PSU is to be done by Chief Electoral Officer concerned.
- Sender State/UT to depute official alongwith armed security for movement of EVMs.

1.9. Lost/stolen EVMs

Action to be taken in case of traced or recovered lost/stolen EVMs

- Furnish a detailed report to the Commission.
- Recovered/traced units to be kept in a separate store and stock-taking of the same not to be done, if it already does not exist in stock inventory.
- After disposal of court cases (if any) send to the factory for destruction.

1.10. Intra-State (inter-district) shifting of First Level Checking (FLC) completed EVMs:

- (a) De-novo FLC in the district where these units are being shifted.
- (b) During Parliamentary election, within the Parliamentary Constituency (covering more than one district)

BEFORE first randomization of EVMs, ensure **de-novo** FLC of the EVMs.

AFTER first randomization of EVMs, there is no need of FLC of the EVMs.

1.11. In case of Intra-district shifting of FLC completed EVMs:

- (a) FLC of these EVMs is not required, subject to the following conditions:-
 - (i) For General Election to State Legislative Assembly, from one Assembly Constituency to another Assembly Constituency after first randomization of EVMs, ensure **de novo FLC of the EVMs**.
 - (ii) For Parliamentary Election, from one Parliamentary Constituency to another Parliamentary Constituency after first randomization of EVMs, ensure **de novo FLC of the EVMs**.
- (b) In case of simultaneous elections to Assembly and Parliamentary constituencies, FLC of EVMs is conducted, if EVMs pertaining to Assembly election are required to be used in Parliamentary constituency or vice-versa.

CHAPTER-2

FIRST LEVEL CHECKING (FLC) OF EVMs



2.1. **Overall responsibility of FLC:**

- (a) District Election Officer (DEO) shall be responsible for overall FLC process.
- (b) DEO shall ensure strict adherence and compliance of FLC instructions.
- (c) DEO will appoint a senior officer of the rank of Addl./Dy. DEO fully trained with FLC process as FLC Supervisor.

2.2. **Requirement of EVMs for conducting FLC:**

- (a) For bye-election to the Parliamentary and Assembly Constituencies, the requirement of EVMs for conducting FLC shall be at least 200% of total number of polling stations.
- (b) For General Elections to the Parliamentary and Assembly Constituencies, the requirement of EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) and VVPATs for conducting FLC shall be at least 125% and 135% respectively of total number of polling station or as allocated by the Commission considering geographical or past experiences.

2.3. **FLC when to be done:**

- (a) FLC of EVMs shall be done before every General/Bye-election to Parliament and Assembly Constituency or in any elections where EVMs are used.
- (b) FLC of EVMs shall commence:
 - (i) within one month of occurrence of vacancy in case of bye-election.
 - (ii) at least P-120 days in case of General Election to State Legislative Assembly or as instructed by the Commission/Chief Electoral Officer.
 - (iii) at least P-180 days in case of General Election to House of the People (Lok Sabha) or as instructed by the Commission/Chief Electoral Officer.

(P- May be estimated based on the last General Election)

- (c) FLC is to be done sufficiently in advance so that all checks are carried out without any undue haste in the presence of representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties.

- (d) FLC of EVMs shall be completed, as far as possible, three months before tentative announcement of election. The same may be calculated considering the last time of announcement of election.

2.4. Schedule of FLC:

- (a) Depending on the number of EVMs to be checked in FLC, the CEO/DEO shall prepare a schedule for the FLC of EVMs in consultation with EVM manufacturers (BEL & ECIL).
- (b) Ensure timing of FLC from 9 A.M. to 7 P.M. on all day including holidays. For any exemption request for timing or OFF on a particular day due to any valid reason, prior approval of the CEO concerned is required under intimation to the ECI.

2.5. FLC to be done in the presence of representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties:

- (a) The schedule for FLC shall be communicated to every National and State Recognized Political Party at the District Headquarters with proper acknowledgment and copy endorsed to the parties at State Headquarters, in writing by the DEO at least 2 days before the commencement of the FLC in the district.
- (b) On the day of FLC, representatives of all National and State Recognized Political Parties authorized by the District President of the party shall be encouraged to be present.
- (c) If the representative of no or only one National/State Recognized Political Party is present on 3 consecutive days, a written reminder shall be given to every National and State Recognized Political Party at the District Headquarters with proper acknowledgment and copy endorsed to the parties at State Headquarters by the DEO.
- (d) A register shall be kept at FLC hall by the DEO in **Annexure-4**, in which signatures of the representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties shall be taken every day as token of their presence.

2.6. Arrangements in the premises of FLC:

- (a) FLC Hall shall be spacious to accommodate the EVMs, officials nominated by DEO, engineers of BEL/ECIL and the representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties.
- (b) FLC hall shall be large, well-lit, well ventilated and dust free. Non-heating high illumination LED lights to be installed so that each table is brightly lit.
- (c) In consultation with BEL/ECIL, install TV/Monitor of minimum 24 inches display with HDMI input, for each SLU under use in FLC hall for simultaneously viewing the dummy symbols being loaded in VVPATs by the representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties.
- (d) FLC area to be fully barricaded and sanitised by police.
- (e) Ensure the hall is free from any electronic components, device, except those permitted by the Commission for the purpose of FLC process.
- (f) Make proper arrangements like drinking water, toilets (separate for male and female), first aid, fire extinguishers, fire alarm inside and outside of FLC hall etc.
- (g) Single entry and exit in hall with full security by armed police force (minimum 1 Section) round the clock with 24x7 CCTV coverage.

- (h) Copy of detailed Standard Operating Procedure (SoP) mentioning step-by-step instructions of FLC shall be pasted in FLC Hall. The SoP shall be provided by BEL and ECIL, as the case may be, in advance so that the SoP shall be pasted in FLC Hall before starting FLC.
- (i) Entry to hall through Door Frame Metal Detector (DFMD) on production of Identity Card of authorized official/pass issued by the DEO.
- (j) Proper frisking of every person/officer/engineer with record in the log book for every entry and exit.
- (k) Any electronic devices including Cell phones, smart watches, cameras, spy pens etc. not to be allowed inside the FLC hall and kept at the collection centre made outside the hall **except two mobiles to be used by the election official(s) nominated by the DEO for marking FLC-OK and one mobile to BEL/ECIL engineer for marking FLC-Reject in EVM Management System (EMS) using mobile app with proper reason.**
- (l) No other equipment allowed inside the hall except those mentioned in FLC User Manual and paper shredding machines to dispose of VVPAT slips generated during FLC process, on a daily basis.
- (m) Web casting of the entire FLC process and monitoring the same in the Control Room at DEO and CEO level.
- (n) Arrangement of one PC/laptop with internet connectivity outside FLC Hall for transmission of FLC data from P-FLCU on daily basis.
- (o) During entire FLC period in the district, both P-FLCU and SLUs including their accessories shall be in the custody of the FLC-in-Charge deputed by the DEO and to be kept in the FLC premises with proper security. The same shall be returned back to BEL/ECIL (engineers authorized by the BEL/ECIL) after completion of FLC in the respective district, for further use in other stations or to move to safe custody of the manufacturers.

2.7. **Manpower in FLC:**

- (a) FLC shall be conducted only by the authorized and certified engineers of BEL and ECIL. BEL and ECIL shall be fully responsible for the integrity, efficiency and competency of their engineers. They shall provide the list along with engineers' cell numbers to DEO concerned.
- (b) Randomization of list of engineers to be deputed by BEL/ECIL for carrying out FLC shall be done by the CEO for district-wise allocation.
- (c) Deputation of Sr. level engineers at State Headquarters as well as each district headquarters by BEL/ECIL to supervise FLC.
- (d) Deputation of one Manager by BEL/ECIL for 4-5 districts to remain in the field for daily supervision and co-ordination.
- (e) No entrance of engineers, technicians or other technical staff except authorized engineers/ technical staff of BEL and ECIL to the FLC Hall.
- (f) Deployment of sufficient unskilled labourer by the DEO for cleaning, unpacking and packing of EVMs in consultation with the manufacturers.

2.8. **Work to be done during FLC:**

- (a) **Cleaning of EVMs by official/staff/labour deputed by DEO:** This include removal of old address tags, special tags, ballot papers etc., cleaning of superscriptions on EVMs, clearing of earlier polled

data, dusting of EVMs etc. as per the prescribed guidelines at **Annexure-5** by the manufacturers in the designated FLC Hall under supervision of team leader of engineers and FLC-in-Charge.

- (b) **Visual Inspection by authorized engineers of BEL/ECIL:** Visual inspection of BU, CU and VVPAT, connecting cables or connectors, latches, carrying cases etc., will be conducted to ensure there is no damage or breakage of plastic parts, latches, switches etc. Any error in the unit will be noted down against unit serial number. Replacement of plastic parts, latches, switches etc. are permissible (as per SoP for FLC of BEL/ECIL) in the field.
- (c) **Functionality checks using P-FLCU by authorized engineers of BEL/ECIL:** The functionality checks of CU, BU & VVPAT will be conducted using P-FLCU as per the detailed procedure contained in the P-FLCU user manual for field engineers.
- (d) **Symbol Loading in VVPAT using SLU by authorized engineers of BEL/ECIL:** P-FLCU passed Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPATs) shall be moved to Symbol Loading table before moving to manual FLC table. Symbol loading in VVPAT shall be done using SLU as per the SLU user manual and facilitation of simultaneously viewing of symbol loading on Monitor to the representatives of National and State Recognized political parties. Only dummy symbols prescribed by the ECI shall be loaded in the VVPATs for conduct of FLC and Mock polls.
- (e) **Full functionality checks:**
 - (i) Diagnostic test of each BU, CU and VVPAT prescribed by the manufacturer.
 - (ii) Check response of all switches and carry out tests prescribed by the manufacturers as per the SoP to confirm all the components of the EVM are original. BEL and ECIL engineers will certify in **Annexure-6** that all the components of the EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) are original.
 - (iii) In order to provide assurance to the political parties, the authorized engineers will ensure opening of cabinets of BU and CU in the presence of the representative of National and State Recognized Political Parties during FLC and carry out visual inspection of PCB to check for spurious components, if any. Any discrepancy should be brought to the notice of DEO or his representative immediately. Seal the cabinet of the CUs with Pink Paper Seals as per the SoP.
 - (iv) For conducting FLC of BU, CU and VVPAT together, Mock poll of 6 votes against each candidate button shall be conducted and electronic count of CU will be tallied with VVPAT paper slips of each VVPAT.
 - (v) Wherever, additional BUs or CUs or VVPATs are required to be added with EVMs of already conducted FLC-OK EVMs at later stage like commissioning, de-novo FLC of additional units shall be conducted.
 - (vi) Once the unit is passed, Green FLC OK sticker will be pasted on Ballot Unit (BU), Control Unit (CU) and Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT).
 - (vii) Red Sticker with reasons of rejection will be pasted on FLC-reject units.
 - (viii) Ensure signatures of BEL/ECIL Engineers and the representative of DEO on both red/green stickers as applicable.
 - (ix) Pink Paper Seals will be pasted on FLC-OK CU and signed by FLC Engineer, FLC

supervisor and the representative of National and State Recognized Political Parties.

- (x) If any EVM is found to be non-functional, it will be kept aside and sent to the factory of BEL and ECIL for repairs **within 7 days** of completion of FLC in the district. CEO shall club dispatches from more than **1** district to economise transport.
- (xi) In case of bye-elections to Parliamentary and Assembly Constituencies, all the non-functional EVMs pertaining to First Level Checking, commissioning, dispersal and mock poll (before actual poll) replacement shall be sent together to the respective manufacturers namely; BEL and ECIL for repairing purpose **within 7 days of completion of the bye election(s)**.
- (xii) Superscription on the cabinet/carrying cases of EVM with marker pen or any other pen is **strictly prohibited** to avoid defacing of the machines.
- (xiii) No electronic repair of the machine shall be carried out in the field. Changing of electronic components of the machines in the field is strictly prohibited.
- (xiv) BEL/ECIL engineers shall bring with them the detailed Standard Operating Procedure (SoP) mentioning the step-by-step instructions of checking of the machine. Copy of this SoP shall be pasted prominently at FLC Hall.
- (xv) List of equipment and spares, which the engineers shall be allowed to carry with them in FLC Hall is attached as **Annexure-7**.

(f) Conduct of Mock Poll by engineers/official deputed by DEO:

- (i) Casting of 6 (six) votes **against each of the 16 candidate buttons**, observation of result and clearing of mock poll data will be done for each set of EVM by FLC Engineers.
- (ii) A load test on 1% of the randomly selected FLC-OK EVMs will be conducted by connecting 4 BUs to 1 CU and 1 VVPAT and casting at least 1 vote for each candidate button of connected BUs (i.e. 64 votes) and tallying the VVPAT slips count with the CU count.
- (iii) Additionally, mock-poll in **1% of EVMs (BUs, CUs and VVPATs) of 1200 votes, in 2% EVMs of 1000 votes and in 2% EVMs of 500 votes** shall be done in the presence of the representatives of the recognized political parties and electronic count shall be tallied with VVPAT slips count by the officials deputed by the DEO. Percentage shall be taken/calculated on quantity of FLC OK Control Units.
- (iv) Representatives of the political parties shall be allowed to pick machines randomly for the purpose of mock-poll and also do the mock poll themselves, if they so desire and their signatures will be obtained in the registers at **Annexure-8** and **Annexure-9** respectively.
- (v) In rest of the machines, number of votes polled during the mock poll should be to the satisfaction of the representatives of the political parties.
- (vi) Signatures of representatives of political parties shall be taken in a register in **Annexure-10**, as a token of confirmation that there are no discrepancies between the VVPAT paper slips count and electronic count of Control Unit.
- (vii) Destruction of VVPAT paper slips generated during FLC shall be done on daily basis through shredding machine.

(g) Updation of FLC status in EMS: Unique ID of FLC-OK units will be uploaded (In case of Control Units along with Unique Serial Number of Pink Paper Seals) using EMS Mobile App

by the authorized official of DEO, on a daily basis. Unique ID of rejected Units with rejection details will be uploaded in EMS using Mobile APP, on a daily basis, by FLC engineers.

- (h) **Uploading P-FLCU Data:** At the end of the day FLC-in-Charge (BEL/ECIL) shall move all P-FLCUs to the internet room (Room with PC & Internet) of the FLC Centre and upload the P-FLCU data to respective factory server on a daily basis. In case of physical and plastic damages, Data which could not be captured by P-FLCU, shall be manually entered into application against unit serial number. Further, FLC Data will be sent to BEL/ECIL FLC server through internet using “Field FLC Data Transfer” Application only.
- (i) Flow chart for the FLC procedure is attached at **Annexure-11**.

2.9. Sealing of cabinet of Control Unit of EVMs with Pink Paper Seal

- (a) In order to ensure that the Control Unit of EVM cannot be opened after First Level Checking of the EVMs, the cabinet of the Control Units shall be sealed with the Pink Paper Seals supplied by the India Security Press, Nasik in the presence of the representatives of the National and State Recognized Political Parties present at the time of FLC, as per the following procedure:
- (i) Pink Paper Seal has two portion/part of same Unique Serial Number. First, split the seal into two separate Pink Paper Seals.
 - (ii) Remove the gummed paper from Pink Paper Seal carefully.
 - (iii) These two Pink Paper Seals shall be pasted on two sides of the Cabinet of the Control Unit as shown in the figures:



Control Unit sealed with Pink Paper Seal

- (iv) For proper fixing of the seals, BEL/ECIL shall emphasize the following:
- Proper handling of seals.
 - The surface on which seal needs to be applied should be clean and free from dust, dirt, water, chemical and oil.
 - The peeling off/removal of seal from the release liner surface with clear finger nails.
 - The application to the applicable surface should be done gently with thumb pressure or finger (4-5 times) to avoid possibility of air pocket, crease.
 - The seal applied on the EVM surface should not be partially stuck and removed and re-used.
- (v) While marking FLC-OK in EVM Management System (EMS) using Mobile App, the Unique Serial Number of Pink Paper Seal shall be entered by scanning QR-Code. If QR-Code could not be scanned, Unique Serial Number of Pink Paper Seal shall be entered manually in Mobile App.

- (b) Take signature of the Engineer and the representative of the National and State Recognized Political Parties present along with the party name in abbreviations below their signatures. Allow them to note down the serial number of the Pink Paper Seal.
- (c) Marking of FLC-OK and FLC-Reject machines in EMS should be done on a daily basis.
- (d) Maintain a register in **Annexure-12** for mentioning the unique number of CU and serial number of pink paper seal and take their signatures. Provide photo copy to the National and State Recognized Political Parties with acknowledgment.
- (e) Provide list of FLC-OK Ballot Units, Control Units and VVPATs generated from EMS to the National and State Recognized Political Parties after completion of FLC and also to all the contesting candidates as soon as last date of withdrawal of candidature is over and take their acknowledgement.
- (f) Ensure the availability of photocopy of the register at the time of Commissioning of EVMs.

2.10. Supervision of FLC

- (a) FLC shall be carried out under the direct and close supervision of District Election Officer.
- (b) The DEO shall nominate one Officer not below the rank of Additional/Deputy DEO as FLC Supervisor to supervise the entire process of FLC. This officer shall be present in the FLC Hall for the entire duration of FLC. FLC Supervisor shall submit a certificate in **Annexure-13** to the CEO concerned through DEO before starting of FLC to the effect that all the arrangements of FLC have been done as per ECI instructions and upload it on EMS.
- (c) District Election Officer shall invariably conduct a daily inspection of the FLC venue and FLC process to ensure that the FLC is being carried out as per the instructions of the Commission. The process of FLC shall be webcast & continuously recorded. Video, CD, DVD or other suitable modes will be kept in the custody of DEO.
- (d) Webcast camera shall be installed in the FLC Hall in such a manner that the process of FLC can be fully seen on webcast. The web link shall be shared only with CEO and ECI, preferably as a single dashboard view with individual links for all the FLC centers.
- (e) Control Room shall be set up at CEO office for monitoring through webcast whether FLC instructions & procedures are being fully followed.
- (f) After completion of the FLC of all the BUs, CUs and VVPATs and updating of FLC-Status in the EMS. DEOs shall submit a Certificate to this effect to the CEO in the format given at **Annexure-14** and CEO will submit a consolidated certificate for all the districts to the Commission.

2.11. Inspection of preparedness and quality check of FLC:

- (a) In case of bye-election(s) to Parliamentary/Assembly Constituency(ies), EVM Nodal Officer of the State/UT concerned shall do inspection.
- (b) In case of General Election to Lok Sabha/State Legislative Assembly, Nodal Officer(s) of other States/UTs shall be deputed to do surprise inspection. In Lok Sabha election, State Officers/

NLMTs/ECI Officers and consultants can also be deputed.

- (c) Deputed officers will submit report to the Commission at **Annexure-15**.
- (d) CEO shall also depute teams to conduct surprise inspection of FLC process in the districts from time to time. The report of such inspection undertaken by CEO shall be submitted to the Commission.

2.12. Security measures for EVMs after FLC:

After completion of FLC, FLC-OK EVMs shall be kept in FLC strong room till first randomization of EVMs.

- (a) Comprehensive arrangements should be made for round-the-clock security of the strong rooms having EVMs after First-Level-Checking.
- (b) Minimum one Section of State Armed Police shall be deployed for 24X7 security of Strong room having FLC “OK” EVMs.
- (c) The entry point of the strong room having EVMs after FLC shall have 24x7 CCTV coverage.
- (d) **There should be sufficient arrangement of fire extinguishers and fire alarm near and inside the strong room.**
- (e) A log book shall be maintained by the security personnel in which entry should be made about date, time, duration and name(s) of anyone entering near the strong rooms. This includes visits by the Observers, DEOs, SPs and the recognized Political Parties/Candidates or their agents or any other person.

CHAPTER-3

TRAINING AND AWARENESS OF EVMs

3.1. Schedule of Awareness Program:

- (a) The Chief Electoral Officer shall fix a **time schedule for a focused campaign** throughout the State/UT. The campaign shall have three components:
 - (i) EVM Demonstration Centers (EDC)
 - (ii) Mobile Demonstration Vans (MDV)
 - (iii) Digital Outreach
- (b) The awareness campaign shall be started approximately 3 months prior to announcement of election (for this purpose date of announcement of the last election may be considered). Further, **awareness of EVMs by way of physical display and/or demonstration** of the EVMs in public shall **not** be conducted after announcement of election, whereas digital outreach may be intensified after announcement.
- (c) **A schedule for awareness campaign** should be prepared by the DEO assembly constituency/segment-wise and adequate publicity shall be made in the media about the campaign. Schedule of Awareness program shall be **shared with National and State Recognized Political Parties**.
- (d) Only FLC-Ok EVMs shall be used in training, demonstration and awareness.
- (e) Physical demonstration of EVM would be carried out through 'EVM Demonstration Centre' and 'Mobile Demonstration Vans'.
- (f) CEOs to submit plan on Awareness for EVM at **Annexure-16** approximately 3 months prior to announcement of election and progress on EVM awareness every week on Monday at **Annexure-17** till the date of announcement of elections.

3.2. EVM Demonstration Centers (EDC):

- (a) For physical demonstration-cum-awareness on use of EVMs, EVM Demonstration Centers shall be set up at District Election Office and at the Returning Officer Headquarters/Revenue Sub-Division Offices.
- (b) The EVM Demonstration Centers shall remain operational till the announcement of the elections.



- (c) Adequate infrastructure with proper signage (banner on EDC and close to demonstration table and Standee on demonstration table so as to be clearly visible from all angles) should be provided in the EVM Demonstration Centers. Adequate publicity shall be made in this regard.

- (d) General members of the public should be allowed to cast mock votes on the EVM. Before next day of operation of EDC, ensure mock poll data is cleared and EVM is functional.

3.3. **Mobile Demonstration Vans (MDV):**

- (a) **A Mobile Demonstration Van** must be deployed for every Assembly Constituency/Segment. However, the requirement of Vans may be assessed based on the geographical and other local conditions of the AC/AS by the CEO/DEO and decision may be taken accordingly, so that all polling locations/clusters/ELCs (Electoral Literacy Clubs) are covered during the campaign period at least once.



- (b) An officer designated by DEO shall accompany each Mobile Demonstration Van.
- (c) Mobile Demonstration Vans shall be functional till announcement of elections.
- (d) Mobile Demonstration Vans should be appropriately equipped with Audio-Visual Equipment and proper signage (**banner on vehicle and close to demonstration table and Standee on demonstration table so as to be clearly visible from all angles**). Route chart with programme dates shall be adequately publicized. The demonstration should be carried out in secure premises.
- (e) Mobile Demonstration Van shall be provided proper security and safeguards.
- (f) General members of the public should be allowed to cast mock votes on the EVM. Before next day of MDV, ensure mock poll data is cleared and EVM is functional.

3.4. **Digital Outreach:**

Digital outreach component of the awareness campaign shall be developed in the SVEEP Plan of the districts and the State and executed accordingly during the campaign period. Innovative creative contents on **usage of EVMs** shall be developed locally, if required in vernacular languages, as part of the SVEEP Plan under guidance of SVEEP Division.

3.5. **Protocol for usage of EVM for Training and Awareness:**

- (a) For the purpose of Training and Awareness (T&A), District Election Officers shall take out FLC-OK EVMs keeping the overall **upper ceiling of 10%** of the total number of polling stations in the district.
- (b) The Training and Awareness EVMs shall be marked as 'Training/Awareness' in EVM Management System (EMS).
- (c) **Awareness EVMs shall be used only for the innovative physical outreach mode described in para 3.2 and 3.3.**

- (d) It shall be ensured that only First Level Checking Ok EVMs shall be used for the aforesaid purpose.
- (e) The representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties shall be invited to witness the process from opening and closing of the FLC Strong Room for the purpose of taking out the EVMs under videography.
- (f) The **list of Training & Awareness EVMs** shall be provided with acknowledgment to the **National and State Recognized Political Parties**. This list shall also be shared with acknowledgment to the candidates/their agents, as and when they are finalized.
- (g) A **yellow color sticker** mentioning “Training & Awareness EVMs” shall be affixed on such EVMs and also on their carrying cases without fail.
- (h) There shall be **no distinction** between Training and Awareness EVMs. The machines marked for Training/Awareness could be used interchangeably between Training and Awareness purpose.
- (i) The DEO shall ensure that the officials chosen for creation of EVM awareness campaign, as well as those nominated for handling EVMs must be comprehensively trained on the usage and functioning of EVMs.
- (j) **Standard Operating Procedure (SoP)** for Training including demonstration and Awareness program of EVM is at **Annexure-18**. A list of Potential Errors during training and awareness is at **Annexure-19**.
- (k) Only dummy symbols shall be used for training and awareness.

3.6. Storage Protocol for Training and Awareness EVMs:

- (a) The Training and Awareness EVMs shall be stored in a **separate designated warehouse** (Training and Awareness Strong Room), not below the sub-divisional headquarters with proper security and lock. Training and Awareness EVM warehouse should not be in the same premises as planned for polled EVMs as well as FLC strong room.
- (b) The list of ‘Training and Awareness Strong Rooms’ shall be shared with National and State Recognized Political Parties and also with candidates/their agents once they are finalized.
- (c) In no case, EVMs pertaining to Training and Awareness shall be kept in FLC Strong Room.
- (d) For opening and closing of Training and Awareness Strong Rooms, there is no need to invite the representatives of the recognized political parties/candidates. However, the opening and closing of the Training and Awareness Strong Rooms shall be done by the authorized officer nominated by the DEO.
- (e) A proper log-book shall be maintained for proper account of EVMs pertaining to Training and Awareness.
- (f) Such EVMs shall be given only to the authorized officials deputed by the DEO.
- (g) After the conclusion of daily training and awareness programs, these machines shall be stored in the **Training and Awareness Strong Rooms** only.
- (h) Install CCTV and deploy minimum 1/2 section police personnel at Training and Awareness Strong Room. Deploy Home Guards Security as an exception when regular police cannot be posted, with prior approval of CEO. Ensure proper maintenance of duty roster of Security Personnel.

- (i) DEO concerned shall be responsible for overall storage and security of training and awareness EVMs.

3.7. Training of Master Trainer, Polling Personnel, Counting Personnel and Storage Personnel:

- (a) Presiding Officers, Polling Officers, Returning Officers, Assistant Returning Officers, Sector Officers and Counting Personnel etc. must be given hands-on-training related to their role/duties on use of EVMs.
- (b) Every official to get an opportunity to operate the EVM system and understand the process of recording of votes using VVPAT. A mock drill shall be arranged during training.

In the mock drill, Presiding Officers shall be individually given hands on experience of the entire EVM process including:

- (i) Connection of Ballot Unit, Control Unit and VVPAT.
- (ii) Enabling Ballot Unit by pressing BALLOT button on Control Unit.
- (iii) Casting of 100 votes and checking of display of VVPAT slips through VVPAT display window.
- (iv) Checking of Total votes on Control Unit.
- (v) Closing of Control Unit after close of poll.
- (vi) Checking the result from Control Unit and tallying with manual record to be kept by them during mock poll.
- (vii) Counting of VVPAT slips and tallying with result in Control Unit.
- (viii) Clearing the mock voting from Control Unit.
- (c) Separate training to be given on counting of printed paper slips from the VVPAT system and tallying the count of VVPAT paper slips with the count of the Control Unit.
- (d) A copy of EVM Brochure for Presiding Officer should be given to all officers during training and be made available at polling station on poll day, alongwith the Dos and Don'ts for handling EVMs.
- (e) A training session may be incorporated in the training module of State Public Administration Institution on operation and use of EVMs.

3.8. Hands-on-Training on VVPAT slips counting during training of counting of votes:

- (a) Mock Drill of VVPAT slips count shall be included in training module of counting staff for a more in depth and hands on experience so that there is **no need** to rush up conduct of mock drill of VVPAT slip count for counting staff **on previous day of counting of votes**, which has logistical issues/problems.
- (b) Only EVMs pertaining to Training and Awareness shall be used. In **no** case, reserve EVMs shall be used for training of polling and counting staff.
- (c) Only dummy symbols prescribed by the Commission shall be used.
- (d) Mock drill of VVPAT slips counting shall be done along with training of counting staff. Mock drill of VVPAT slips shall be conducted in a dummy VVPAT Counting Booth (VCB). For mock drill of VVPAT slips counting during training, a dummy VCB shall be made.
- (e) For training of counting staff at least 500 VVPAT slips shall be generated.

- (f) VVPAT slips generated during training and Mock drill shall be destroyed through shredding machine on a daily basis.

3.9. Destruction of VVPAT slips generated during Training & Awareness:

- (a) Destruction of VVPAT slips generated/printed during the training and awareness using Paper Shredding Machines on a daily basis, in the presence of a Gazetted Officer duly nominated by the DEO.
- (b) Issuance of a certificate by the Nodal Officer in-Charge of Training and Awareness exercises regarding the daily destruction of all VVPAT slips as per Commission's direction.
- (c) Further, the DEO shall submit a Certificate to the CEO concerned on P-3 day for the entire district attesting the compliance of these instructions.

3.10. Re-introduction of EVMs pertaining to training and awareness for Poll day reserve:

EVMs pertaining to training and awareness may be re-introduced for poll day reserve, after de-novo FLC, randomizations, commissioning etc. carried out as per the extant instruction of the Commission.

NOTE: Only use FLC-OK EVMs with dummy symbols for training, awareness and demonstration purpose.

3.11. Advisory for using dummy Ballot Unit for awareness/campaigning by Political Parties and Candidates:

The dummy Ballot Units being used by political parties/candidates for awareness/campaigning may be made of wood, plastic or ply board boxes, half the size of the official Ballot Unit and may be painted brown, yellow or grey. These dummy Ballot Units may have provision for showing the serial number, name and symbol of the candidate as in the dummy ballot paper. It may also have a battery-operated button and a lamp which may lit on the button being pressed.

PART-II			
FIRST RANDOMIZATION OF EVMs TO POST-COUNTING			
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CHAPTER-4

FIRST RANDOMIZATION OF EVMs

4.1. Steps for First Randomization of EVMs to be done by DEO:

Before 1 st Randomization of EVMs, take out upto 10% EVMs for training and awareness purpose and mark as “Training and Awareness” in EVM Management System (EMS) [Ref: Chapter-3]			
DEO shall fix a schedule for 1 st Randomization and invite the National and State Recognized Political Parties in writing, at least 48 hours in advance, with acknowledgment			
Conduct 1 st Randomization of EVMs through EVM Management System (EMS), under videography.			
Conduct 1 st Randomization of EVMs in the presence of the representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties			
In case of General/ Bye-elections to Legislative Assembly, allocate EVMs Assembly Constituency-wise	In case of General/ Bye-elections to Lok Sabha, allocate EVMs Assembly Segment-wise	In case of Simultaneous elections to Lok Sabha and Legislative Assembly, allocate EVMs Assembly Segment-wise (for PC) and EVMs Assembly Constituency-wise (for SLA)	Exceptional case: In case Assembly Constituency/ Segment is falling in two or more districts, refer Scenarios 4 and 5.
Provide the list of randomized EVMs generated from EMS to each National and State Recognized Political Party and obtain written acknowledgment. RO/ARO shall provide the list of randomized EVMs to all the contesting candidates/their election agents before second randomization and obtain written acknowledgment.			
Taking charge of EVMs by the respective Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer, as the case may be.			
Receiving of 1 st Randomized EVMs in AC/AS Strong Room using EMS Mobile App.			

During the General Elections to the Lok Sabha, the States/UTs may face the following scenarios:

Scenario No.1: When the entire district consists of the PC, the District Election Officer (DEO) is the custodian of EVMs of that district and is the Returning Officer of that PC.

Ex: PC consists of only one District-A having 9 Assembly Segments (AS) (a, b, c, d, e, f, g, h and i).

District-A (1-PC = 9 AS: fully covered in District –A)

a	b	c
d	e	f
g	h	i

Shaded Area is PC

Scenario No.2: When the entire two or more districts consist of the PC, the DEOs are the custodian of EVMs of the respective district and the DEO of one district is the Returning Officer of that PC.

Ex: PC consists of two Districts-A & B. District-A having 9 AS (a, b, c, d, e, f, g, h and i) and District-B having 4 AS (j, k, l and m). DEO of District-A is the RO of PC.

District-A			District-B	
a	b	c	j	k
d	e	f	l	m
g	h	i		

District-C

Shaded Area is PC

Scenario No.3: When the PC consists of entire district as well as some AS of some adjoining district/districts and the DEO of this district is RO of the PC.

Ex: PC consists of entire Districts-A (a, b, c, d, e, f, g, h and i) & some AS of District-B (only AS-j) & District-C (only AS- o and p). DEO of District-A is the RO of PC.

District-A			District-B	
a	b	c	j	K
d	e	f	l	m
g	h	i		
n	o	p		
q	r	s		

District-C

Shaded Area is PC

Scenario No.4: The PC consists of entire district as well as some AS or some parts of AS of some adjoining district/districts and the DEO of this district is RO of the PC.

Ex: PC consists of entire Districts-A (a, b, c, d, e, f, g, h and i) & some part of AS of c i.e. c (ii) is in District-B & some AS of District-C (only AS- o and p). DEO of District-A is the RO of PC.

District-A			District-B		
a	b	c(i)	c(ii)	j	K
d	e	f	L	m	
g	h	i			
n	o	p			
q	r	s			

District-C

Shaded Area is PC

Scenario No.5: In case of Assembly election: If any AC falls in two or more districts, First Randomization for allocating EVMs to that AC will be conducted by the DEO of the district in which RO HQs of that AC is situated. That AC shall be mapped in EMS with the district where RO HQs is situated.

Ex: Some part (b1) of AC-b is in District-A and remaining part (b2) in District-B. AC-b-RO HQs is at District-A. AC-b shall be mapped in EMS with District-A.

District-A		District-B	
a	b(b1)	b(b2)	g
c	D	H	i
e	F	J	k

4.2. Action to be taken if 120% EVMs (BUs and CUs) and 130% VVPATs are not available for first randomization:

- (a) Randomize all the CUs and VVPATs available in the district for allocating them AC/AS wise. Hence, as far as possible equal percentage of Control Units should be allocated to all the ACs/ASs without retaining any CU at District level.
- (b) In case of BUs, randomize the number of BUs equivalent to number of CUs for allocating them to AC/AS wise i.e. the percentage of BUs should be equal to percentage of CUs at each AC/AS.
- (c) The remaining BUs should be available in the FLC strong room at the District level for allocating to the PC/AC where more than one BU would be needed after withdrawal of candidatures. However, this additional allocation after withdrawal should also be randomized.
- (d) Training and Awareness EVMs may be re-introduced to meet the shortfall, if any, by following de-novo FLC and supplementary randomization etc., at later stage before commissioning of EVMs.

4.3. Identification and recognition of EVMs for simultaneous elections:

For clear identification and recognition of EVMs for simultaneous elections:

- (a) Paste distinct colour (same as that of ballot paper i.e. White for Lok Sabha and Pink for Legislative Assembly) self-adhesive stickers containing the words 'LOK SABHA' or 'LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY', as the case may be, on the carrying cases of BU, CU and VVPAT.
- (b) Apart from the above, paste distinct colour (same as that of ballot paper i.e. White for Lok Sabha and Pink for Legislative Assembly) self-adhesive stickers containing the words 'LOK SABHA' or 'LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY', as the case may be, on top cover 'BATTERY SECTION' of the CU and on top of VVPAT.
- (c) Size of self-adhesive sticker-**6cm x 3cm**.

4.4. Pre-Poll Storage: After first Randomization of EVMs till dispersal of polling parties

- (a) After first randomization of EVMs, handover EVMs to the RO/ARO concerned, as the case may be, under proper armed police escort.
- (b) Guidelines to be followed:
 - (i) Store EVMs in AC/AS strong room in the presence of representatives of National and State Recognized Political Parties under Videography.
 - (ii) Keep Training and Awareness EVMs in Training/Awareness warehouse.
 - (iii) 24x7 minimum 1 Section Armed Security and CCTV coverage should be ensured.
 - (iv) All the keys of Lock-1 with RO and all the keys of Lock-2 with ARO. In case of Parliamentary Constituency election, if some Assembly Segments are in other district(s), then all keys of Lock-1 with ARO and all the keys of Lock-2 with SDM/Tehsildar concerned.

- (c) Store EVMs in separate strong rooms AC/AS wise.
- (d) In case of simultaneous elections, store EVMs pertaining to AC and AS in separate strong rooms.
- (e) In exceptional cases, make separate temporary strong rooms for each AC/AS within large strong room with separate entry for every temporary strong room.
- (f) Open the Strong Room at the time of commissioning of EVMs.
- (g) After commissioning of EVMs, again store them in the strong room and open on the day of dispersal in the presence of candidates or their representatives.

CHAPTER-5

SECOND RANDOMIZATION OF EVMs

Steps for Second Randomization of EVMs to be done by RO:

Second Randomization of EVMs is to be done after finalization of List of the Contesting Candidates and just before the commissioning of EVMs in the presence of candidates/their representatives and ECI Observer.			
Returning Officer shall fix a schedule for 2 nd Randomization and invite all the Contesting Candidates in writing with acknowledgment at least 24 hours in advance. “ EVM Brochure for Candidate & Political Parties ” (available in ECI website at link: https://eci.gov.in/evm-vvpat) shall also be provided to all contesting candidates.			
Conduct 2 nd Randomization of EVMs through EVM Management System (EMS), under videography.			
NOTE			
(i) RO shall personally ensure that all the Polling Stations of AC/AS are reflected in EMS correctly before conduct of second randomization of EVMs.			
(ii) For any roll back request to ECI, the RO shall submit a proceeding of meeting with all the contesting candidates along with his/her explanation through the CEO concerned.			
Conduct Second Randomization of EVMs in the presence of all the Contesting Candidates/their representatives and General Observer(s) appointed by ECI.			
In case of General/ Bye-elections to Legislative Assembly, allocate EVMs Polling Station-wise by RO	In case of General/ Bye-elections to Lok Sabha, allocate EVMs Polling Station-wise by RO of PC concerned	In case of Simultaneous elections to Lok Sabha and Legislative Assembly, allocate EVMs Polling Station-wise, by RO of AC (for SLA) and RO of the PC (for PC election)	Exceptional case for General/Bye Election to Lok Sabha by ARO
After, 2 nd Randomization of EVMs, RO shall provide the list of randomized EVMs generated from EMS to all the Contesting Candidates and obtain written acknowledgment.			
RO shall fix a date for preparation of EVMs for poll (also called candidate setting or commissioning) after the last date of withdrawal of candidatures and finalization of the ballot paper under written intimation with acknowledgment to all the Contesting Candidates at least 48 hours in advance.			

CHAPTER-6

COMMISSIONING OF EVMs

6.1. Commissioning of EVMs after the last date of withdrawal of candidatures:

- (a) RO shall draw schedule for commissioning of EVMs.
- (b) Commissioning of EVMs shall be done for all the Assembly Constituencies/Segments in separate halls.
- (c) Written intimation with acknowledgment to all the contesting candidates about the schedule for their presence to oversee the commissioning and actively participate in the mock poll process and take their signatures on the register maintained as per **Annexure-20**.
- (d) In case of Parliamentary Elections, ARO will supervise the commissioning of EVMs for Assembly Segment.

6.2. Arrangements in the premises for commissioning of EVMs

- (a) Large Preparation hall to accommodate EVMs, officers nominated by the DEO, engineers of manufacturers concerned and representative of contesting candidates.
- (b) In consultation with BEL/ECIL, install a TV Monitor for each SLU under use in commissioning hall for simultaneously viewing the symbols being loaded in VVPATs, by candidates/ their representatives.
- (c) Fully sanitised to ensure that hall is free from any electronic components or devices.
- (d) Single entry and exit point to hall with full security by at least one Section Armed Police forces round the clock with 24X7 CCTV coverage.
- (e) Permission for Entry to hall through Door frame metal detector (DFMD) on production of Identity card of authorized official/pass issued by DEO.
- (f) Proper frisking at every entry and exit.
- (g) Neither allow anyone to carry any electronic device inside the hall nor anybody to take out anything outside the Preparation Hall.
- (h) Commissioning of EVMs pertaining to Assembly Segment(AS) of PC falling in RO headquarters may be done at ARO level under direct supervision of RO in the presence of candidates/their representatives. Further, the commissioning of EVMs of remaining AS may be done by the respective **ARO** in the presence of candidates/their representatives.

6.3. Manpower for commissioning of EVMs

- (a) Commissioning of EVMs shall be done by the officials deputed by the RO/ DEO.
- (b) Only the authorized engineers of BEL/ECIL to be associated for the commissioning of EVMs.
- (c) BEL/ECIL to share the list of engineers with DEO for the commissioning of EVMs in a district along with their identity card numbers etc.
- (d) Allow only authorized engineers/technical staff of BEL and ECIL to enter the commissioning hall.
- (e) Separate teams for conducting mock poll of 1000 votes in randomly selected 5% of EVMs.

6.4. Main tasks during commissioning

Execute the following tasks:

(a) **Checking and commissioning of Ballot Unit(s)-**

- (i) Opening of outer cover of BUs by BEL/ECIL Engineers to examine and certify as in **Annexure-21** that all components of BUs are original and show to the candidates/their representatives.

- (ii) **FIXING THE BALLOT PAPER** There is provision for fixing the ballot paper on the Ballot Unit under a transparent acrylic sheet (ballot paper screen). The Returning Officer shall either sign or affix his facsimile signature on the back of every ballot paper before it is fixed in a Ballot Unit.

For fixing the ballot paper under that screen, Returning Officer has to first open the top cover of the Ballot Unit. This can be done by pressing simultaneously, towards right, the latches at the top and bottom on the right edge of the unit and swinging the cover up. The top cover and the lower portion of the Ballot Unit will then open like a book. Thereafter, Returning Officer should open the ballot paper screen, which is hinged to the top cover on the extreme left side. The release latches of the screen are inside the top cover. By pressing the latches simultaneously, first slightly towards right and then pushing them downwards, the ballot paper screen will become free for opening on the upper side of the top cover. While opening the screen, every care should be taken to ensure that it does not get damaged in the process.

After so opening the ballot paper screen, the ballot paper should be placed in the space provided for the purpose on the upper side of the top cover of the Ballot Unit. The ballot paper should be properly aligned so that each candidate's name, photograph and his/ her symbol are in line with the corresponding lamp and button and the thick lines dividing the panels of candidates on the ballot paper are exactly in line with the corresponding grooves on the Ballot Unit. It should be noted that alignment of the ballot paper is a very important step. There should not be any misalignment as this will create confusion in the minds of the voters and might lead to serious complications. After ensuring such alignment, Returning Officer should close and press fit the ballot paper screen to secure the ballot paper firmly underneath that screen.

After ballot paper has been firmly fixed and the ballot paper screen has been pressed-fit on the upper side of the top cover, the screen should be sealed on the inner side of the top cover. This should be done by passing the thread through the two holes on the screen specially provided for the purpose on the inner side. The thread should be tightened and given a firm knot. The two ends of the thread should be placed on an address tag and Returning Officer should put his/her seal on the thread and the address tag. Note that the address tag is common for BU, CU and VVPAT.

- (iii) Sealing of ballot paper screen of BU(s) with thread and address tags.



After firm fixation of the ballot paper under the Ballot Paper Screen on the upper side of top cover, seal the screen from inside, by passing the thread through two holes at the back of the ballot paper screen, using address tag showing the particulars of election with seal of the RO.

- (iv) **Setting of Thumb Wheel Switch:** Set the two digits of the rotary thumbwheel switches, at the top right corner of BU, at desired position like 01 for BU-I, 02 for BU-2 and so on.

Where the number of contesting candidates is up to fifteen, only one Ballot Unit will be used. Since NOTA will be in sixteenth position. In such a case, the thumbwheel switch shall be set as '01'. Where the number of contesting candidates is more than fifteen and up to thirty-one, two Ballot Units will be used. In the first Ballot Unit in which the ballot paper containing the names of candidates at serial nos. 1 to 16 is fixed, the thumbwheel switch shall be set as '01' and the second Ballot Unit where the ballot paper containing the names of candidates from 17 onwards is fixed, shall be set as '02'. Likewise, if three Ballot Units are to be used in a constituency where the number of contesting candidates exceeds thirty-one and is up to forty-seven, the thumbwheel switch will be set as '01' in the first Ballot Unit in which the names of candidates at serial nos. 1 to 16 appear, as '02' in the second Ballot Unit in which the names of contesting candidates at serial nos. 16 to 32 appear and as '03' in the third Ballot Unit. If the fourth Ballot Unit is used in case the number of contesting candidates exceeds forty-seven, then the thumbwheel switch will be set as '04' in the fourth Ballot Unit. Similarly, if the fifth Ballot Unit is used in case the number of contesting candidates exceeds sixty-three, then the thumbwheel switch will be set as '05' in the fifth Ballot Unit. In this way, 24 Ballot Units can be set and connected to Control Unit in M3 EVM.

Note: It is absolutely essential to ensure that the thumbwheel switch is set in the appropriate position in each Ballot Unit as any wrong linking of the Ballot Units will show error on CU display. The error should be set right by interlinking the Ballot Units in the proper sequential order.

- (v) **Masking Unused Buttons of BU(s):** Unmask all candidate buttons including NOTA button of BU as per the ballot paper and mask all remaining unused buttons of BU.

- (vi) **Sealing of cabinet of BU with thread and address tags**



After unmasking candidate buttons, seal the upper cover of the BU by thread passed through holes on the top and bottom end at right side using address tags showing the particulars of the election with the seal of the RO.

- (vii) **Sealing of cabinet of BU(s) with Pink Paper Seals:**

- Pink Paper Seal has two portion/part of same Unique Serial Number. First, split the seal into two separate Pink Paper Seals.
- Remove the gummed paper from Pink Paper Seal carefully.
- These two Pink Paper Seals shall be pasted on lower and upper sides of the Cabinet

of the Ballot Unit as shown in the figures:



Lower Portion

Upper Portion

- (viii) In case more than 01 Ballot Unit is used, Braille Sticker “Ballot Unit-1”, “Ballot Unit-2 and so on shall be printed and affixed on the corresponding Ballot Unit on the TOP MIDDLE PART of the Ballot Unit.
- (ix) Register for sealing of Ballot Units using Pink Paper Seals shall be maintained in **Annexure-22**. A copy of the same shall be provided to all the contesting candidates/ election agents.
- (b) **Commissioning of VVPATs- Rule 49B [4(c) (i)-(iii)] of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961**



Installation of Paper Roll



Inserting of Power Pack

- (i) Install a new power pack (battery) to the VVPAT unit and shut the door of the battery compartment. Do not seal the battery compartment as the power pack can be replaced in case of low battery.
- (ii) Install a fresh paper roll in the printer unit as per the procedure mentioned in **Annexure-23**.
- (iii) Load allotted Serial numbers, names and symbols of candidates in VVPAT with the help of engineers using Symbol Loading Unit (SLU). RO/ARO to check the test printout from VVPAT with the ballot paper in BU and sign and certify the same. The RO/ARO shall keep the test printout in a black envelope and seal it. The envelope shall clearly indicate details of election, date of commissioning and SLU. User Manual on SLU shall be provided by the PSU concerned.
- (iv) **Sealing of paper roll compartment with thread and address tags**



After installation of paper roll in the paper roll compartment of VVPAT, seal the paper roll compartment by passing a thread through holes provided on the latches using Address Tags showing the particulars of the election with the seal of the RO. Obtain the signatures of candidates/their representatives on Address Tags with party abbreviation.

(Ensure Switching OFF of Control Unit and keep the paper roll knob in horizontal position (transport position) before sealing of paper roll compartment)

(c) Commissioning and Candidate Setting in Control Units:

- (i) Install new Power Pack in CU
- (ii) Connect cable of VVPAT with CU and cable of BU with VVPAT. In case of more than one BU, Connect cable of VVPAT with CU and cable of BU-1 with VVPAT and cable of BU-2 with BU-1 and cable of BU-3 with BU-2 and so on.
- (iii) Unlock Paper Roll knob of VVPAT (Rotate to Working Position)
- (iv) Switch ON the CU.
- (v) Press Candidate Set button on CU to set candidate (Display Panel of CU shows 'Set Candidate__'.)
- (vi) Press last candidate button (NOTA button) of BU to set candidate in CU.
- (vii) Mock Poll with one vote to each candidate to check that the VVPAT is printing the paper slips accurately.
- (viii) Switch OFF the CU and lock paper roll knob of VVPAT (Transport Position).
- (ix) Delink the interconnecting cables of BU(s), CU and VVPAT.
- (x) Seal the Battery and Candidate Set Compartments of CU by passing a thread through hole provided on the respective sides using Address Tags showing the particulars of the election with the seal of the RO/ARO.

Sealing of Control Units (CUs)-



- (xi) Allow the candidates/their representatives to affix their signatures with party abbreviation on Address Tags.

(d) Identification of Reserve Units:

- (i) Paste adhesive stickers with inscription 'RESERVE' on carrying cases of reserve BUs, CUs and VVPATs.
- (ii) Pink stickers for Assembly Election and White stickers for Parliamentary Election.
- (iii) Dimension of sticker: 15 cm x 10 cm.
- (iv) Sealing of carrying cases of reserve BUs, CUs and VVPATs with Address Tags.

(e) Conduct of higher rate Mock Poll:

- (i) In 100% VVPATs, one vote for each candidate including NOTA shall be given to check that the VVPATs are printing the paper slips accurately.
- (ii) Mock Poll of 1000 votes on 5% randomly selected EVMs. Percentage shall be calculated on quantity of Control Units. Allow candidates/their representatives to pick EVMs randomly for this purpose.
- (iii) All candidates/their representatives to do the mock poll themselves and take their signatures in a register in **Annexure-24** as token of having done mock poll themselves.
- (iv) Tally the electronic result with paper slips count. Ensure that VVPAT drop box is emptied.
- (v) Ensure that the Pink Paper Seal of CU and BU(s) are not damaged in any manner during commissioning and mock poll.
- (vi) Install new Paper Roll and Power Pack in VVPAT and new Power Pack in CU in which higher mock poll of 1000 votes cast.

(vii) CLEARING THE MACHINE

For this purpose, the button marked 'Clear' in the Result Section of the Control Unit should be pressed. On the 'Clear' button being pressed, all the counts in the machine will be automatically set to ZERO and the display panels on the Control Unit will start displaying that the number of votes recorded in the machine for each contesting candidate is '0' (ZERO).

6.5. Supervision of the commissioning: RO or one of the AROs will supervise the commissioning of EVMs under CCTV/videography.

6.6. Braille Signage Features: Additional arrangements to facilitate visually impaired electors to exercise their franchise.

- (a) **Do not paste any Braille Sticker** on the right of the blue button (voting button) on the BU as it has embossed serial numbers of the candidates in Braille Signage.
- (b) After finalization of list of the contesting candidates, immediately send the list of contesting candidates to the State approved/recognized Association Institution/University having requisite expertise for **preparation of Dummy Ballot Sheets** which contains the serial numbers of contesting candidates, names of candidates arranged in the same serial numbers order in which their names appear on the ballot paper on the BU.
- (c) Indicate the party affiliation of each of the candidates by printing the name of the political party concerned against the name of candidate. In the case of Independent Candidate, print the word 'Independent'.

- (d) Prepare **Dummy Ballot Sheet in regional language** (i.e. language printed on actual Ballot Paper) in addition to English and supply a copy of the same to all the Polling Stations.
- (e) **If more than 1 BU** is used at a polling station, print separate dummy ballot sheet for each BU.

6.7. Preparation of Dummy Ballot Sheet:

- (a) Give serial number to candidate in each Dummy Sheet from 01 to 16. Ex. If number of contesting candidates are 19 including NOTA, number the serial number of contesting candidates at serial **number 17-19 of BU-2**, start the serial numbers again from **01 on 2nd Dummy Ballot Sheet i.e. 01 for 17th Candidate, 02 for 18th Candidate and 03 for NOTA.**
- (b) If more than 1 BU is used, **print BU-01** in Braille on the **TOP MIDDLE PART** of first Dummy Ballot Sheet and **BU-02** in second dummy ballot sheet and so on.
- (c) Similarly, print Braille Stickers '**BU-01**', '**BU-02**' and so on and affix on the corresponding BU on the **TOP MIDDLE PART**'.
- (d) Print Dummy Ballot Sheets mentioned above in Braille signage by the State approved/recognized Association/Institution/University having requisite expertise for this purpose under the supervision of one responsible officer appointed by CEO of the State/UT. Write the name of the constituency on Dummy Ballot Sheets in normal script at the top.
- (e) Commissioner of Disabilities of concerned State or his/her authorized representative who will be an official knowing Braille, will certify each such sheet prepared for every polling station.
- (f) Conduct detailed training and briefing sessions for the Presiding Officers and the Polling Officers explaining them these facilities for the visually impaired electors.
- (g) Arrange for wide publicity of these measures through advertisement in newspapers and TV etc. to inform the visually impaired voters about the arrangements made.
- (h) At the polling station, allow the visually impaired persons to take a companion along as provided in Rule 49N of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961.
- (i) Give the Dummy Ballot Sheet in Braille to the visually impaired voter on his/her request if he/she prefers to cast his/her vote with the help of same. After he/she studies the contents of Dummy Ballot Sheet, allow him/her to proceed to the voting compartment to cast their vote.
- (j) Such electors after reading the Dummy Ballot Sheet will be able to cast their vote by reading the serial number of the candidate of their choice on the numeric sticker fixed on the Ballot Unit(s) [BU-01, BU-02 etc.].
- (k) After the voter has cast his/her vote, ensure that the Dummy Ballot Sheet delivered to the voter is returned to the Presiding Officer.
- (l) After the close of poll, seal the Dummy Ballot Sheet in separate cover superscribed "**Dummy Ballot Sheet**" for visually impaired and send to the RO along with other Non-Statutory forms.

6.8. Destruction of VVPAT paper slips taken out during commissioning of EVMs:

VVPAT slips generated during Commissioning of EVMs (except test printout) shall be shredded by using Paper Shredding machine on daily basis in the presence of Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer. The shredded VVPAT slips shall be kept in a trunk and sealed. The same shall not be disposed of before completion of election petition period. The envelope having test printout shall be kept in the strong room having statutory documents and disposed of as procedure followed for destruction of VVPAT slips pertaining to poll.

Note:

1. In case any BU or CU or VVPAT does not work properly during commissioning of EVMs, **only** concerned unit **should be replaced from the reserve one.**
2. **All seals used at the time of commissioning of EVMs shall be signed by the Returning Officers or Assistant Returning Officer and candidates / their agents or representatives.**

6.9. Safe custody of Symbol Loading Unit(s)

- (a) **During the commissioning period** in Assembly Constituency/Segment, all Symbol Loading Unit(s) alongwith its accessories shall be in the custody of the Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer, as the case may be and shall be securely stored in locker/safe/cupboard etc. under lock and key in the Commissioning premises with proper security. RO/ARO shall be responsible for safe custody of Symbol Loading Unit(s) alongwith its accessories during the commissioning period.
- (b) **After the completion of commissioning process** i.e. symbol loading process for the AC/AS, the SLU(s) used for symbol loading alongwith the accessories shall be stored in transparent container(s) *(of minimum dimensions of 10 X 8 X 3.5 inches)* by the Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer in the presence of candidates or their representatives.
- (i) Each set of SLU alongwith its accessories used in a particular AC/AS shall be kept in a separate container. Not more than one set of SLU alongwith its accessories should be kept in one container.
 - (ii) Enough number of containers (generally, 2-4 numbers per AC/AS) is to be kept ready in advance based on the requirements.)
 - (iii) Reserve SLUs and their accessories, which were not used for symbol loading in VVPATs, if any, shall also be kept in such transparent containers with proper labeling as 'Reserve SLUs'. Each Reserve SLU and its accessories shall be placed in a separate container.
 - (iv) Each container shall be numbered properly (SLU CONTAINER NO.1, SLU CONTAINER NO.2, and so on). A self-adhesive sticker containing Container No., Particulars of Election, PC/AC/AS number and SLU serial number shall be pasted on TOP side of the container, as shown in the below sticker format:

SLU CONTAINER No. _____	
General/By-Elections to _____	
District _____ SLU Manufacturer _____ (BEL/ECIL)	
No. & Name of AC/AS (with PC) _____	
Reserve SLU or Used SLU: _____	
Date of Completion of Commissioning _____	
Number & Name of AC/AS	Serial Number of the SLU
<i>Signature of RO/ARO</i>	

- (v) per seal. The candidates or their representatives shall be allowed to sign the seals pasted on the SLU Container.
- (vi) Above processes shall be done in the presence of candidates/their representatives under videography. The video footage shall be preserved as per existing instructions of the Commission.

- (c) **After sealing the SLU containers**, the same shall be **deposited with the District Election Officer** concerned within 24 hours of the completion of commissioning. These containers shall be stored by the DEO in a separate strong room/secured room and shall be marked clearly on the door as **‘SLU STORAGE ROOM’**. It is clarified that both the used SLUs and Reserve SLUs shall be stored in the SLU Storage Room. District Election Officer shall be responsible for their storage and security. The SLU Storage Room shall be under double lock system with all keys of each lock with two separate specified officers.
- (d) In exceptional case, if it is not feasible to store in separate storage room, the SLU containers may be kept in treasury/locker/secured cupboard after due approval of the respective Chief Electoral Officer of the State/UT and with intimation to the candidates or their representatives.
- (e) An **‘SLU Inventory Register’** shall be maintained by the DEO listing out the AC/AS-wise, container-wise, Serial Number of the SLUs being stored. The entries of the Register shall be signed by the DEO. Signature of the candidates/their authorised representatives and Engineer-in-charge of BEL/ECIL shall also be obtained on the Register. Format of the Register as per **Annexure-25**. The entries pertaining to different AC/AS shall be made in separate pages of the SLU Inventory Register.
- (f) In case of **additional Commissioning**, the respective SLU container shall be taken out by the DEO from the SLU STORAGE ROOM under videography with prior intimation to the respective candidates / their representatives. Thereafter, SLU container shall be provided to the RO/ARO concerned for the additional commissioning. Necessary entries to this effect shall be made in the SLU Inventory Register and signature of the candidates/their authorised representatives and BEL/ECIL Engineer shall also be obtained.
- (g) After **completion of additional commissioning**, SLU and its accessories shall again be kept in the container and procedure mentioned in (b) to (e) above shall be followed. Necessary entries shall again be made in the SLU Inventory Register and signatures of candidates/their authorised representatives and Engineer-in-charge of BEL/ECIL shall also be obtained once again.
- (h) Photocopies of the Register shall be provided to all the candidates and BEL/ECIL Engineer in-charge with due acknowledgement.
- (i) **On the P+1 day:**
 - (i) **Only the Reserve SLUs** and their accessories shall be handed over to the authorised BEL/ECIL engineers in the presence of candidates/their representatives and their signatures shall be obtained in the Register. Proceeding of the same shall be made and placed in the SLU Inventory Register. It shall be ensured by the DEO that the Reserve SLUs that are handed over do not have the actual symbols of the AC/AS.
 - (ii) The **used SLUs will continue to be stored** in the SLU Storage Room until the completion of counting of results.
- (j) **Opening and closing** of SLU Storage Room/Other places mentioned at (d), shall be carried out only after due invitation to candidates/their representatives. Necessary proceeding shall be drawn and placed in the SLU Inventory Register.
- (k) **Completion of counting of votes:** After completion of counting of votes, the SLU containers shall be stored in the respective AC/AS-wise strong room(s) in a **steel trunk labeled** as **‘SLUs USED IN AC/AS NO. __’** for safe storage and convenience, alongwith polled EVMs under the

overall responsibility of the DEO.

- (i) More than one sealed SLU container may be kept in the steel trunk. As far as possible, it shall be ensured that all the sealed SLU containers of a particular AC/AS are kept in one trunk.
 - (ii) There shall be no inter-mixing of sealed SLU containers of different AC/AS in a steel trunk.
 - (iii) The minimum dimension of the trunk shall be 2 X 1 X 1.5 ft.
 - (iv) The steel trunks having the sealed SLU containers shall be under lock and key.
- (l) Action to be taken **after completion of Election Petition Period:**
- (i) The Chief Electoral Officer shall immediately ascertain the EP status from the High Court concerned.
 - (ii) **No EP filed:** The SLUs alongwith their accessories pertaining to the AC/AS, where no EP has been filed shall be sent back to the respective manufacturers. The SLUs may be sent alongwith the non-functional EVMs-VVPATs (Commissioning to Poll) of the district, if any.
 - (iii) **EP filed:** Where EP has been filed, the Chief Electoral Officer shall ascertain the subject matter of the petition(s).
 - (iv) If EVM/VVPAT is **not the subject matter** of the petition, an application shall be filed before the Hon'ble High Court concerned to release EVMs and SLUs. Only after getting permission from the Hon'ble High Court concerned, SLUs alongwith their accessories shall also be sent back to the respective manufacturers, on release of EVMs.
 - (v) If EVM/VVPAT is the **subject matter** of the petition, the SLUs alongwith their accessories shall be sent back to the manufacturer only after final disposal of the Election Petition.
 - (vi) It is clarified that SLUs alongwith their accessories shall be sent **only to the respective manufacturers** upon completion of the applicable timeframes, i.e. SLUs shall not be sent to any other State/UT or any field units. All the protocols applicable for EVM transportation to the manufacturers shall be applicable for transportation of SLUs and its accessories to the manufacturers.
- (m) DEOs shall make necessary entries of sending SLUs to the manufacturers in the SLU Inventory Register and also keep a copy of the acknowledgement received from the manufacturers in the Register.
- (n) The cost of transportation of the SLUs back to the manufacturers shall be borne by the States/Uts as part of the election expenditure. However, to optimise the cost of transportation, the CEOs may explore clubbing of the units from districts and sending to the manufacturers with due coordination with the manufacturers.

Strict compliance of the above direction of the Commission shall be ensured. The Table in **Annexure – 26** may be referred for the gist of storage conditions and responsibilities across different stages. As mandated by the Hon'ble Supreme Court, **the above protocols are applicable in all cases of completion of the symbol loading process in the VVPATs undertaken on or after 01.05.2024.**

A SAMPLE POSTER ON COMMISSIONING OF EVM (to be displayed in Commissioning Hall)

HOW TO COMMISSION?

Ballot Unit(s)	Control Unit	VVPAT
• Open the Ballot Screen of BU and place Ballot Paper with proper alignment. Seal the Ballot Screen with Address Tag. • Unmask the required number of Candidate Buttons of BU including NOTA. • Set the Thumb Wheel (01- for BU-1, 02 for BU-2 and so on) • Seal the Outer Cover of BU with Pink Paper Seals and Address Tags.	• Install New Power Pack in Power Pack Compartment of CU and seal with Address Tag.	• Install New Paper Roll in Paper Roll Compartment of VVPAT. • Install New Power Pack in Power Pack Compartment of VVPAT. • Loading of Serial Number, Name and Symbol of the candidates including NOTA in VVPAT using Symbol Loading Unit (SLU). • Sealing of Paper Roll Compartment of VVPAT with Address Tags.

HOW TO SET CANDIDATE

- Connect BU(s), CU and VVPAT for candidate setting in Control Unit.
- Switch ON the CU.
- Press 'Candidate Set' button of CU.
- Press last candidate button (NOTA Button) of BU to set candidate.
- Cast 1 vote to each candidate button including NOTA to check correctness.
- Switch OFF the CU before disconnecting cables.
- Seal the Candidate Set Section of CU with Address Tag after candidate setting.
- Put VVPAT knob in Transport mode (Horizontal position) before keeping in carrying case.

REPLACEMENT PROTOCOL

All 'ERROR' messages for BU, CU and VVPAT will be displayed on CU only. Please read message and act accordingly. In case BU or CU or VVPAT is not functioning, replace the respective unit only with reserve one. Share the list of replaced units with all the contesting candidates, if there is any replacement.

DON'T DO

- Don't install serial number, name and symbol of candidates in VVPAT without verifying with ballot paper.
- Don't set candidates in CU without connecting BU(s), CU and VVPAT.
- Don't forget to shred VVPAT slips (except test prints) printed during commissioning on daily basis.
- Don't forget to install new power packs in CU & VVPAT and new paper roll in VVPATs, in which mock poll of 1000 votes were conducted during commissioning.
- Don't keep VVPAT knob in Working Mode (Vertical position) after commissioning.

CHAPTER-7

DISPERSAL DAY



7.1. Intimation to the contesting candidates

Date and time of opening and closing of the AC/AS Strong Room shall be intimated in advance to all the contesting candidates/election agents in writing with acknowledgment, whenever EVMs are taken out of the AC/AS Strong Room for dispatch to polling stations.

7.2. Checking of EVMs by Presiding Officers on dispersal day

Ballot Unit(s)
• Address Tags of BU pertain to the assigned polling station and tally with ID mentioned on metallic plate/barcode sticker on the unit. • Pink Paper Seals of BU(s) are intact. • Ballot Paper is inserted properly. • Contesting Candidate Blue Buttons including NOTA button are unmasked. • Thumb wheel position is 01 for first BU (If more than 01 BU is used, Thumb wheel for 2nd BU is 02, for 3rd BU is 03 and so on).
Control Unit
• Address Tags of CU pertain to the assigned polling station and tally with ID mentioned on metallic plate/barcode sticker on the unit. • Pink Paper Seals of CU are intact. • Switch ON the CU (without connecting to BU and/or VVPAT) to check Battery status and number of contesting candidates. Thereafter, Switch OFF the CU.
VVPAT
• Address Tags of VVPAT pertain to the assigned polling station and tally with ID mentioned on metallic plate/barcode sticker on the unit. • Power Pack (Battery) is installed. • VVPAT knob is in horizontal position (i.e. Transportation mode). If VVPAT knob is in vertical position (i.e. Working mode), turn the knob to horizontal position.

7.3. Backpacks to carry EVMs as well as Backpacks to carry polling materials to aid hands free movement for polling parties in difficult terrain and to safeguard the machines.

- (a) Backpacks shall be provided to all polling teams deployed in difficult terrain (like hilly areas/ locations wherein movement of machines on foot is involved).

For this purpose, the Chief Electoral Officers (CEOs) shall consider the following:

- (i) The specification of backpacks to carry EVMs and polling materials is as under:

Technical Specification for			
	Control Unit (CU Bag)	Ballot Unit (BU Bag)	VVPAT Bag
Size	15" (Vertical) 12.4" (Horizontal) 10.6" (Breadth/Thickness)	22.6" (Vertical) 15" (Horizontal) 10.6" (Breadth/Thickness)	17.6" (Vertical) 17.6" (Horizontal) 12" (Breadth/Thickness)
Fabric Materials	High Quality eco friendly material: Specification outer shell Fabric: 1000D OXFORD COATING SOLVENT PU *2+ Polyster ULY GSM 210 DYEING METHOD JET DYEING Specification of inner Shell Fabric: Pungi (Polyster) 140 GSM W/R	High Quality eco friendly material: Specification outer shell Fabric: 1000D OXFORD COATING SOLVENT PU *2+ Polyster ULY GSM 210 DYEING METHOD JET DYEING Specification of inner Shell Fabric: Pungi (Polyster) 140 GSM W/R	High Quality eco friendly material: Specification outer shell Fabric: 1000D OXFORD COATING SOLVENT PU *2+ Polyster ULY GSM 210 DYEING METHOD JET DYEING Specification of inner Shell Fabric: Pungi (Polyster) 140 GSM W/R
Colour	Black	Black	Black
Bottom Bush/ Padded PVC	2.2" diameter (6 pieces per bag)	2.2" diameter (6 pieces per bag)	2.2" diameter (9 pieces per bag)
Shoulder straps	Base with fabric size 3.5" width x 1" width with adjustable nylon strip and buckles)	Base with fabric size 3.5" width x 1" with width adjustable nylon strip and buckles)	Base with fabric size 3.5" width x 1" with width adjustable nylon strip and buckles)
	On top with soft cushion inside- 30mm width capable of withstanding 20 kg weight	On top with soft cushion inside- 30mm width capable of withstanding 30 kg weight	On top with soft cushion inside- 30mm width capable of withstanding 30 kg weight
Zip	2 Heavy Duty Tony Runner Chain No 10 ZIP	2 Heavy Duty Tony Runner Chain No 10 ZIP	1 Heavy Duty Tony Runner Chain No 10 ZIP
	Zipper (Fastener) with 2 Nos. sliding tabs: Toothed edges of plastic with metal sliding tabs, (Heavy Duty).	Zipper (Fastener) with 2 Nos. Sliding tabs: Toothed edges of plastic with metal sliding tabs, (Heavy Duty).	Zipper (Fastener) with 2 Nos. Sliding tabs: Toothed edges of plastic with metal sliding tabs, (Heavy Duty).

Other Features	The length of the back strap is adjustable with good quality buckles	The length of the back strap is adjustable with good quality buckles	The length of the back strap is adjustable with good quality buckles
	The bag has interlocking nylon strip stitched with 100% nylon 40 TKT thread.	The bag has interlocking nylon strip stitched with 100% nylon 40 TKT thread.	The bag has interlocking nylon strip stitched with 100% nylon 40 TKT thread.
	Buckles are made from Poly Acetal Materials	Buckles are made from Poly Acetal Materials	Buckles are made from Poly Acetal Materials
	2 Chambers with a width of 10.6" for carrying 2 CU/Election Materials	2 Chambers with a width of 10.6" for carrying 2 CU/Election Materials	NA
	Waist Trap with foam Poly Acetal Materials	Waist Trap with foam Poly Acetal Materials	Waist Trap with foam Poly Acetal Materials
	4 buckles of 1" with adjustable nylon strip and buckles on the top of the bag as additional support	2 buckles of 1" with adjustable nylon strip and buckles on the top of the bag as additional support	2 buckles 1" with adjustable nylon strip and buckles on the top of the bag for safety when zip are fail
	12 mm thick thermo cool between the two chambers of the bag as well as at the inner lining of the bag	12 mm thick thermo cool between the two chambers of the bag as well as at the inner lining of the bag	12 mm thick thermo cool in the inner lining of the bag
	Multi colour ECI logo (6"x 6") customized embroidery	Multi colour ECI logo (6"x 6") customized embroidery	Multi colour ECI logo (6"x 6") customized embroidery
	Department Name embroidery	Department Name embroidery	Department Name embroidery

NOTE: The above specifications are minimum desirable. However, States may adopt the features with suitable modifications as per requirement.

(ii) The above specification is for guidance of the CEOs. However, CEOs may further improve upon them based on local situations and needs; in which case the following aspects are to be necessarily considered while designing the backpacks:

- The logo of ECI is necessarily to be imprinted on all backpacks.
- There will be provision of waist belt, straps, good quality buckles with lock, strong and smooth zips.
- Padded head straps may be added as optional from the middle portion of the VVPAT backpack especially for hilly terrain if needed.
- The length and width of shoulder straps for VVPATs should be adjustable.
- The back pack shall be water proof.
- In case of VVPAT backpack, extra padding for back support should be incorporated.

(iii) In case of **simultaneous elections**, the backpack for BU should have two pockets for carrying two

BUs. Similarly, the backpack for CU should have two pockets for carrying two CUs. However, two separate backpacks should be used for carrying VVPATs.

- (iv) **Tagging system for the identification** of AC/AS, including the details of polling station number is to be used. In case of simultaneous elections, two different colours of the tags should be used as given:

AC election- Pink colour and PC election- White colour.

BACKPACKS TO CARRY EVMs-INDICATIVE SAMPLES



BU



CU



VVPAT



Backpack for BU



Backpack for CU



Backpack for VVPAT



(v) Backpack for carrying polling materials in difficult terrain:

In order to provide hands-free movement while carrying polling materials in difficult terrain, the CEOs may consider to add outer pocket/chamber on backpack to keep polling materials for polling parties.

(vi) Necessary action for backpacks shall be initiated in advance.

7.4. Voting Compartment to be used in Polling Stations

To maintain secrecy of vote at the time of poll and uniformity on use of voting compartments, follow the following instructions for use of Voting Compartment at Polling Stations: -

- (a) **Voting Compartment will be only of corrugated plastic sheet (flex-board)** of steel grey color, which is opaque and reusable. The thickness of corrugated flex board for making Voting Compartment will be minimum 3 mm.
- (b) In three folds, each fold having dimension of **24"x24"x30"(Length x Width x Height)**.
- (c) **Self-adhesive stickers** on all the three sides of the voting compartment as per **Annexure-27**. The height of the table on which the voting compartment is placed should be **30"** as per **Annexure-28**.
- (d) If more than one BU is used for poll, increase the width of the voting compartment by 12" for each additional BU. Where additional BU is used, arrange them in the manner as per **Annexure-28**. While placing the EVM in the voting compartment, ensure that the secrecy of voting is not violated and ensure that it is not near a window or the door of the polling station, or visible on CCTV camera.
- (e) Route the inter-connecting cable of BU and VVPAT in such a way that it does not obstruct the movement of voters insider the polling station and they do not tread or trip over it, but the entire length of the **cable should be visible and under no circumstances be concealed under the cloth or under the table**.
- (f) Tape the connecting cables of BU, CU and VVPAT to the leg of the table with **"Transparent Adhesive Tape"** of half inch width in such a manner that the wires do not hang in the air so that the load of hanging wire does not impact the connecting switch of the BU and VVPAT.

7.5. Additional Direction:

- (i) Proper electricity arrangement at the polling stations.
- (ii) Place the Voting Compartment in such a way that while sufficient light is available inside the voting compartment, no direct lighting is placed over or in front of the voting compartment.

7.6. Brochure for Presiding Officer including Trouble Shooting Instructions etc. to be provided to polling parties

At the time of dispersal of polling parties, hand over a copy of Brochure for Presiding Officer on EVM (available on ECI website) including trouble shooting instructions and Dos and Don'ts for handling of EVM to the Presiding Officers.

7.7. SoP for P-2/P-3 dispersal and P+1 arrival of Polling parties: EVM-Intermediate Strong Room for Polling Team staying with EVMs at intermediate location before poll and after poll

- (a) Earmark Govt. building at the cluster point for polling parties and EVMs of P-2/P-3 dispatch

Polling Stations and RO will inform the same to all the contesting candidates in writing. Do not use Police Stations for such cluster points.

- (b) Earmark a room as strong room for storing EVMs of the P-2/P-3 PSs at these designated Govt. buildings. Keep all EVMs in the said strong room and seal in the presence of Sector Officers and videograph the entire process. Allow the contesting candidate to nominate their representative to watch the whole process, if they desire.
- (c) In case there is more than one assembly segment involved, make a sturdy partition for each AS of the said strong room in such a way that it can be properly secured by double lock system, seals/etc. Under no circumstance, mix the units of one AS with those of another AS in one strong room.
- (d) Maintain a logbook for opening and closing of the said strong room.
- (e) Follow the aforesaid process for P+1 arrival of polling parties.
- (f) Minimum half section CAPF will guard the intermediate strong room, where polled EVMs are stored.
- (g) A Nodal Officer may be appointed for Intermediate Strong Room(s) for arrangement, co-ordination and to facilitate polling parties etc.
- (h) In exceptional case, Police Station(s) for Intermediate strong room/cluster point may be considered, if there is no Govt. Building for the purpose, with the approval of the respective Chief Electoral Officer.
- (i) Videography by mobile for opening and closing of intermediate strong room(s) may be considered, if it is not possible to depute videographer.

Note:

1. Instruct the polling parties for not testing the VVPAT at the time of dispersal and before mock poll at polling station under any circumstance.
2. In case any BU or CU does not work properly during dispersal only concerned unit should be replaced from the reserve one.

7.8. Use of vehicles with GPS tracking/Mobile app-based tracking for movement of EVMs during dispersal and poll day

- (a) Monitor the end-to-end movement of all vehicles carrying EVMs including Reserve EVMs at all times using GPS/Mobile App-based tracking.
- (b) DEO is responsible for the effective end-to-end GPS/Mobile App-based tracking and monitoring.
- (c) ‘**EVM Control Room**’ to be set up at DEO level as well as CEO level for round-the-clock monitoring and tracking through GPS Monitors and other related IT infrastructure/applications.
- (d) Sector Officers shall not remove the EVMs from the authorized vehicles except where required for election purpose or for safe storage at designated places.
- (e) DEO shall notify the registration number and details of all vehicles carrying Reserve EVMs along with the name of the Sector Officers to all National and State Recognized Political Parties/Candidates and Observers in the district.
- (f) The General Observers shall monitor the compliance of these instructions and record an entry to this effect in the General Observers’ diary.

SAMPLE POSTER FOR DISPERSAL DAY
(to be displayed at Dispersal Centre and provided to Polling Parties)

WHAT TO CHECK?

Ballot Unit(s)	Control Unit	VVPAT
- Address Tags of BU to ensure BU(s) is pertaining to your assigned polling station. - Pink Paper Seals of BU are intact. - Ballot Paper is installed properly. - Ballot buttons upto NOTA (Candidate Blue Buttons) are unmasked. - Thumb wheel position in 01 for first BU (If more than 01 BU is used, Thumb wheel position for 2nd BU is 02 and 3rd BU is 03 and so on).	- Address Tags of CU to ensure CU is pertaining to your assigned polling station. - Pink Paper Seals of CU are intact. - Switch ON the CU (without connecting to BU and/or VVPAT) to check Battery status and number of contesting candidates. Thereafter, Switch OFF the CU.	- Address Tags of VVPAT to ensure VVPAT is pertaining to your assigned polling station. - Power Pack (Battery) is installed. - VVPAT knob is horizontal (i.e. Transportation mode). If VVPAT knob is vertical (i.e. working mode), keep the knob horizontal.

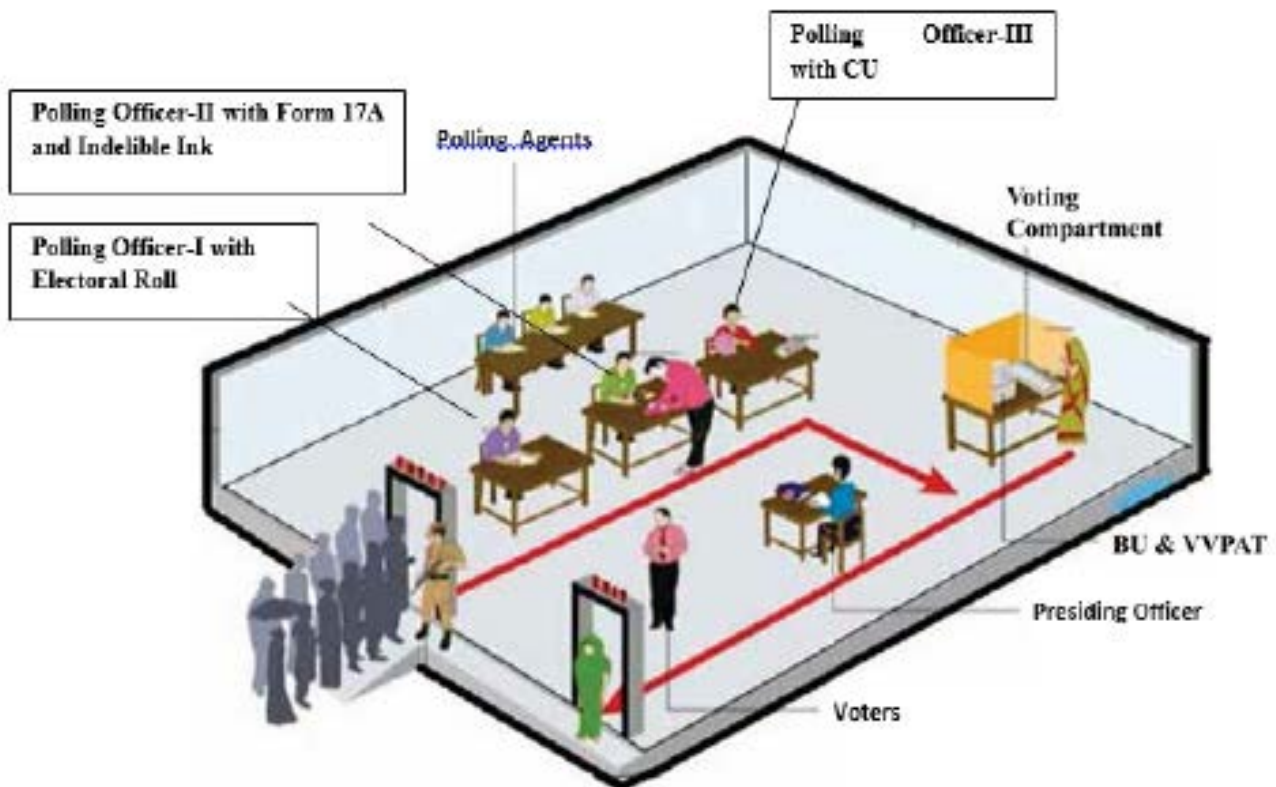
DON'T DO

- Don't connect Ballot Unit (BU), Control Unit (CU) and VVPAT during dispersal.
- Don't keep BU, CU and VVPAT outside their respective carrying cases after checking.
- Don't keep VVPAT knob vertical (working mode) while transporting.
- Don't take away EVM and VVPAT to any unauthorised place like residence, hotel etc.
- Don't remove any seal from BU, CU and VVPAT.
- Don't use vehicle other than vehicle provided for dispersal.
- Don't stay at any place other than designated place.
- Don't set up Voting Compartment near open window or door.
- Don't set up Voting Compartment just below the highly illuminated bulb/light.

CHAPTER-8

POLL DAY

8.1. Layout of Polling Station



8.2. Set up of EVMs in Polling Station



8.3. Responsibilities of DEO, RO/ARO, Presiding Officers and Sector Officers on Poll Day

In order to ensure that the Presiding Officers and other polling staff complies with secrecy of votes, the following instructions shall be strictly adhered to:

(a) Supply of Dummy Ballot Paper to Presiding Officers

- (i) Supply a printed sample of Ballot Unit of EVM pasted on a cardboard (real size) to all the Presiding Officers along with the other polling materials at the time of dispatch.
- (ii) While printing such model ballot, ensure that only dummy name and dummy symbols that are not in use, are used and not any real names or symbols and print in colour so that 'blue button', 'green light' and 'red light' etc. are clearly represented.

(b) Responsibilities of Presiding Officers:

Presiding Officers are responsible for the conduct of poll in the polling stations and they must have a sound knowledge of the voting processes.

- (i) Wherever any voter asks for help or expresses inability to vote using EVM, explain to the voter the voting process using the card board model of the EVM ballot in such a manner that the voter is able to understand. This shall be done outside the voting compartment only in the presence of polling agents.
- (ii) Ensure inspection of BU in the presence of polling agents from time to time when there is no voter inside the voting compartment.
- (iii) Enquire all the complaints about the conduct of the polling staff at the polling station. The Observers are instructed to take serious note of such complaints and conduct or cause enquiry in to such allegations and submit reports to the Commission.
- (iv) If any voter alleges about the wrong printing of particulars of a candidate and/or symbol of that candidate on VVPAT paper slip printed by the printer on pressing of concerned blue (candidate) button on the Ballot Unit to which the printer is connected, provide him/her a 'Form of Declaration' (**Annexure-29**) and take action in accordance with Rule 49MA of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961.
- (v) Deposit EVM and Election Materials etc. at Collection Centre under security.

(c) Responsibilities of Polling Officer-I

Before the first voter signs in Form 17A (Register of Voters), the Polling Officer-I shall check with the Presiding Officer and record in **INK** in Form 17A that

- (i) **'Total in the Control Unit checked and found to be Zero.'**
- (ii) **'Mock poll VVPAT slips have been removed from the VVPAT drop box and VVPAT drop box is empty and sealed'.**

(d) Responsibilities of Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates and movement of Reserve EVMs on Poll Day

- (i) As far as possible, reserve EVMs shall be provided to Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrate on the Poll Day itself.
- (ii) In case Reserve EVMs are provided to Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates before poll day, the reserve EVMs shall be kept at Government building with proper security. In absence of Govt. building, reserve EVMs may be kept at police station in exceptional circumstance only with written approval of the Chief Electoral Officer.
- (iii) All EVMs provided to polling parties and Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates shall be under cover of Armed police at all times.

- (iv) Reserve EVMs and non-functional un-pollled EVMs (replaced during mock-poll on poll day) will be carried by the Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates with proper labeling like 'RESERVE', 'MOCK POLL REPLACED'.
- (v) Non-functional unit replaced before start of actual poll (mock poll) should not be left in the polling station with the Presiding Officer and deposited by the respective Sector Officer.
- (vi) The place of storage of reserve EVMs shall be identified and earmarked in advance and intimated to all contesting candidates/their agents in writing with acknowledgment.
- (vii) Categories C (Un-pollled non-functional EVMs-replaced during mock poll on poll day) and D (Unused Reserved) EVMs will be deposited at the same time when all polled EVMs (Category-A) and polled non-functional (Category-B) are stored in the polled strong room under written intimation to candidates and proper videography in separate room other than the polled strong room.
- (viii) Category-C and Category-D EVMs will be stored in EVM Repaired Strong Room and Reserve Unit Strong Room respectively not in the building of Polled Strong Room (having Category-A and Category-B EVMs).
- (ix) 1/2 Section Security to warehouse/strong rooms, where Categories C&D EVMs are stored.
- (x) Sector Officers shall submit a detailed account of reserve EVMs in prescribed format at the time of deposition of reserve EVMs after close of poll on the same day.
- (xi) Names and mobile numbers of the Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates and the polling station covered by them shall be shared with all the contesting candidates.

8.4. Standard Operating Procedure for Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates:

The following SoP for Sector Officers on Responsibilities of Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates and movement of Reserve EVMs shall be provided to Sector Officers/Zonal Magistrates during training as well as on dispersal day.

8.4.1. General Instruction

- A sticker containing "ON DUTY- Sector Officer/Zonal Magistrate" shall be pasted on the front (window-screen) and backsides of the vehicles having reserve EVM on dispersal and Poll Day.
- Have a copy of route map of polling stations allotted to the respective Sector Officer/Zonal Magistrate.

8.4.2. Collection of Reserve EVMs

- Reach the earmarked Collection Centre at scheduled time fixed by the Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer for receiving reserve EVMs and extra power packs of CU and VVPAT for poll day replacement.
- Check the unique IDs of reserve EVMs provided.
- Obtain a copy of Certificate (**Annexure-31**) from RO/ARO.
- Ensure stickers 'Reserve' are pasted on the carrying cases of EVMs and also collect stickers 'Mock Poll Replaced' for pasting on carrying case of replaced unit(s) of EVM, if replaced during mock poll.

8.4.3. Movement of Reserve EVMs and Intermediate Storage

- Use only vehicles/other transports provided by the Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer.
- On poll day, keep reserve EVMs in the designated vehicles/transports only.
- In case of P-3/P-2/P-1 Day, keep reserve EVMs only in Intermediate Strong Room earmarked by the Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer.

- Ensure security person with vehicle/transport.

8.4.4. Protocol for Replacement of EVM

(All 'ERROR' messages for BU, CU and VVPAT will be displayed on CU only. Please read message and act accordingly)

During Mock Poll

- BU(s) not functioning: replace the particular BU only with reserve BUs.
- CU not functioning: replace CU only with reserve CUs.
- VVPAT not functioning: replace VVPAT only with reserve VVPATs.
- Paste prescribed sticker 'Mock Poll Replaced' on Non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT replaced during mock poll.
- Replaced non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT during mock poll shall be kept with Sector Officer/Zonal Magistrate and deposited by the Sector Officer/Zonal Magistrate at Reception Centre/other place earmarked by RO/ARO. In no case, non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT replaced during mock poll shall be kept in the polling station.

NOTE

- Provide adhesive stickers with inscription 'MOCK POLL REPLACED' to Sector Officers for affixing on carrying case of non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT replaced during mock poll.
- Paste 'MOCK POLL REPLACED' sticker on carrying case of non-functional unit(s).
- Specification of sticker: Dimension: 15 cm x 10 cm
Color: Pink for AC and White for PC elections.

During Actual Poll

- BU or CU not functioning: replace entire set i.e. BU(s), CU and VVPAT. (Inform the Presiding Officer that mock poll is to be conducted)

Procedure of mock poll in case of replacement of entire set of EVM during actual Poll:

- Conduct Mock Poll in the presence of polling agents present there.
- Place BU(s) and VVPAT in Voting Compartment. These should not be moved after mock poll.
- Place CU on Table of Presiding Officer/Polling Officer (In-charge of CU).
- Connect cable of BU with VVPAT and cable of VVPAT with CU.
- Unlock Paper Roll knob (to Working Position) of VVPAT.
- Show that VVPAT drop box (VVPAT slips compartment) is empty.
- Switch ON the CU.
- Demonstrate no vote in CU by pressing Total button of the CU. If any vote is in CU, clear the data of CU through CRC process (Close-Result-Clear).
- Cast **one vote** for each candidate button including NOTA.
- After mock poll votes, press CLOSE button of CU.
- Thereafter, press RESULT button of CU to ascertain mock poll result and tally with manual record.
- Remove mock poll VVPAT slips from VVPAT drop box and tally with CU result.
- Press CLEAR button of CU to clear mock poll result from CU and show to polling agents.

- (xiv) Stamp on back side of mock poll VVPAT slips with stamp 'MOCK POLL SLIP'.
- (xv) Keep mock poll VVPAT slips in Black envelope and then seal the envelope with Pink Paper Seal. Mention '*VVPAT slips of Mock Poll done due to replacement of entire set of EVM during actual poll*' on envelope.
- (xvi) Switch OFF the CU and seal the result section of CU with Green Paper Seal, Special Tag and Address Tag.
- (xvii) Show empty drop box of VVPAT to polling agents and then seal the drop box of VVPAT with Address Tag.
- (xviii) Fill a fresh Mock Poll Certificate Part-I of Presiding Officer's Report- **Annexure-30** carefully.
- VVPAT not functioning: replace VVPAT only.
(Inform the Presiding Officer that no mock poll is required to be conducted in such case)
- CU shows Error 'Replace Power Pack of CU': Replace Power Pack of CU only.
(Inform the Presiding Officer that no mock poll is required to be conducted in such case)
In case the Power Pack of CU does not function properly or show low battery, replace Power Pack of CU. For this purpose Presiding Officer shall replace the Power Pack of CU in presence of polling agents and Sector Officer and again seal the Battery Section of CU with Address Tag and obtain their signatures. Presiding Officer shall submit a report in format prescribed in Part-II of Presiding Officer's Report.
- CU shows Error 'Replace Power Pack of VVPAT': Replace Power Pack of VVPAT only.
(Inform the Presiding Officer that no mock poll is required to be conducted in such case)
- Replaced non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT during actual poll shall be kept with Presiding Officer and deposited by Presiding Officer at Reception Centre.

8.4.5. Deposition of Reserve and Mock Poll non-functional EVM along with left over Power Packs of CU and VVPAT

- Immediately after completion of poll, on Poll Day itself deposit reserve and mock poll non-functional EVMs in the Reception Centre or other place earmarked by the RO/ARO.
- In case of P+1 movement, keep reserve and mock poll non-functional EVMs in Intermediate Strong Room earmarked by the Returning Officer/ARO and deposit in the Reception Centre or other place earmarked by the RO/ARO, as instructed.

8.4.6. DON'T FOR POLLING PARTIES AND SECTOR OFFICERS

- Don't use vehicle/other transport other than vehicle/other transport provided by RO/ARO.
- Don't use provided vehicle/other transport without signage "ON DUTY- Sector Officer/Zonal Magistrate" on front and back side of the vehicle/transport.
- Don't stay at any private place like hotel, home etc. Always stay in designated place.
- Don't leave vehicle unattended under any circumstances.
- Don't keep reserve and mock poll non-functional EVMs without prescribed stickers in vehicle/transport.
- Don't keep EVMs in any private places. Always keep at places earmarked by RO/ARO.

NOTE: In case of any doubt, immediately contact the RO/ARO.

8.5. Mock Poll on Poll Day

- (a) Start Mock Poll 90 minutes before scheduled poll time, if 2 or more polling agents are present.
- (b) Wait for 15 minutes, if one or no polling agent is present, and then start mock poll.
- (c) Place BU(s) and VVPAT in Voting Compartment. These should not be moved after mock poll.

- (d) Place CU on Table of Presiding Officer/Polling Officer (In-charge of CU).
- (e) Connect cable of BU with VVPAT and cable of VVPAT with CU.
- (f) Unlock Paper Roll knob (to Working Position) of VVPAT.
- (g) Show that VVPAT drop box (VVPAT slips compartment) is empty.
- (h) Switch ON the CU.
- (i) Demonstrate no vote in CU by pressing Total button of the CU. If any vote is in CU, clear the data of CU through CRC process (Close-Result-Clear).
- (j) Cast at least 50 votes and manually record number of votes given to each candidate button (ensure votes are recorded for each of the contesting candidates including NOTA).
- (k) After mock poll votes, press CLOSE button of CU.
- (l) Thereafter, press RESULT button of CU to ascertain mock poll result and tally with manual record.
- (m) Remove mock poll VVPAT slips from VVPAT drop box and tally with CU result.
- (n) Press CLEAR button of CU to clear mock poll result from CU and show to polling agents.
- (o) Stamp on back side of mock poll VVPAT slips with stamp 'MOCK POLL SLIP'.
- (p) Keep mock poll VVPAT slips in Black envelope and then seal the envelope with Pink Paper Seal.
- (q) Switch OFF the CU and seal the result section of CU with Green Paper Seal, Special Tag and Address Tag.
- (r) Show empty drop box of VVPAT to polling agents and then seal the drop box of VVPAT with Address Tag.
- (s) Fill Mock Poll Certificate Part-I of Presiding Officer's Report- **Annexure-30** carefully.

Recording of Poll Start and Poll End Date and Time:

The Presiding Officer, at the end of Mock Poll at the Polling Station, shall check and note the date and time shown in the display of the CU and also the actual date and time as well as any discrepancy between the two, if any, in the Mock Poll Certificate (Part-I of **Annexure-30**) and also in the Presiding Officer Diary.

- (t) Switch ON the CU for Actual Poll and press "TOTAL" button to confirm Zero votes.

CRITICAL MISTAKES TO AVOID

- Not pressing CLOSE button on CU after mock poll.
- Not matching the mock-poll result of the CU with the mock poll VVPAT slips.
- Not removing the mock poll VVPAT slips from VVPAT.
- Non-deletion of mock poll data from the CU after mock poll.
- Keeping VVPAT near an open window or directly under a bulb or halogen lamp.

8.6. Various types of seals and tags used for sealing EVM



Pink Paper Seal for sealing black envelope containing mock poll VVPAT seals



Common Address Tag for CU and VVPAT



Special Tag for sealing CU



Green Paper Seal for sealing CU

8.7. Sealing of EVMs on Poll Day at polling station by Presiding Officer

8.7.1. At the polling stations on Poll Day after mock poll

(i) Sealing of black envelope having mock poll VVPAT slips with Pink Paper Seal



After the mock poll, Presiding Officer removes all the printed mock poll VVPAT slips from the drop box of the VVPAT, stamps the printed mock poll VVPAT slips on their back side with rubber stamp having inscription '**MOCK POLL SLIP**' before keeping and sealing these slips in the thick black envelope supplied for the purpose. The envelope shall be sealed with the seal of the Presiding Officer and Pink Paper Seal.

The following shall be written on the mock poll envelope:

VVPAT MOCK POLL SLIPS
Name of Election:
No. and Name of AC/AS(PC):
No. and Name of Polling Station:
VVPAT ID:
Date of Poll:

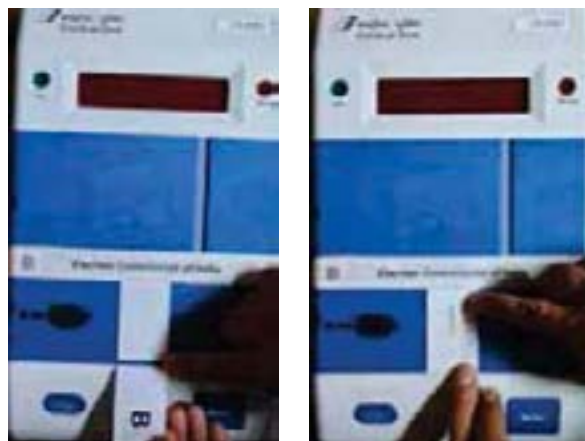
(ii) Fixing of Green Paper Seal in Control Unit after mock poll and before starting actual poll

Fixing Green Paper Seal and closing of inner compartment

After mock poll and clearing mock poll data, switch off the Control Unit for sealing Result Section of the CU. Affix Green Paper Seal on the inner side of door of Result Section as shown in the above figure and close the door in such a manner that the two ends of the paper seal project from the sides of the inner compartment.

(iii) Sealing of inner compartment of Result Section with Special Tag

Seal the inner door of the Result Section by passing a thread through hole provided on the left side using Special Tag showing the particulars of the election with the seal of the Presiding Officer.

(iv) Sealing the outer door of the Result Section of CU with thread seal using Address Tag and Green Paper Seal

After sealing inner door of Result Section of CU with Special Tag, close the outer door of the Result Section ensuring that loose ends of the Green Paper Seal protrude out from both the sides of the closed outer door. Then the Presiding Officer shall seal the outer door by passing a thread through hole provide on the left side using Address Tag showing the particulars of the election with the seal of the Presiding Officer.

Thereafter, remove the wax paper from 'A' side of the Green Paper Seal and paste on the outer door of the Result Section. Then remove the wax paper from 'B' side and paste on top of the underlying 'A' side of the Green Paper Seal in such a way that the serial no. of the seal is visible on the top.

(v) Sealing of drop box of VVPAT with Address Tags



Thereafter, seal the drop box of VVPAT with the thread and Address Tags before actual poll starts.

NOTE: all seals used on the poll day for sealing of EVMs shall be signed by the Presiding Officer and Polling Agents appointed by the candidates.

8.7.2. Handling of Contingencies during poll

- (a) **Replacement of units during actual poll:** Before any sort of replacement SWITCH OFF CU and take action as referred at 8.4.4.
- (b) **Replacement of Power Pack of Control Unit:** In case the Power Pack of CU does not function properly, Presiding Officer shall replace the Power Pack of CU in presence of Polling Agents and Sector Officer and again seal the Battery Compartment of CU with thread and Address Tag and obtain their signatures. Presiding Officer shall submit a report in Format prescribed by the Commission (Part-II of the Presiding Officer's Report **Annexure-30**).
- (c) **If VVPAT has not printed the paper slip or the printed paper slip remains uncut, then**
 - (i) Do not try to remove/cut hanging slip from the paper roll. No effort should be made to make it fall into the drop box. It should be allowed to remain hanging as it means that the vote has not been recorded in Control Unit and as it is not to be counted at the time of counting of the printed-paper slips. The details of such an occurrence should be clearly recorded in the Presiding Officer's diary in the following format:-
 - a. The date and time of the occurrence.
 - b. The name of the voter and his serial number in the part in the electoral roll, who was allowed to cast his vote after replacement of VVPAT.
 - c. Whether the voter cast his vote after replacement of VVPAT or went away without casting his vote.
 - d. The Total number of votes cast before the occurrence.
 - (ii) The last voter is allowed to cast his vote after the replacement of VVPAT.
- (d) **Wrong Printing Complaint:**

If any voter alleges about the wrong printing of particulars of a candidate and/or symbol of that candidate on VVPAT paper slip printed by the printer on pressing of concerned blue (candidate) button on the Ballot Unit to which the printer is connected, the Presiding Officer of the polling station should provide him/her a 'Form of Declaration' (**Annexure-29**) to lodge a complaint and follow the procedure prescribed under Rule-49MA of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, which reads as under:

"49MA. Procedure in case of complaint about particulars printed on paper slips.

- (1) *Where printer for paper trail is used, if an elector after having recorded his vote under rule 49M alleges that the paper slip generated by the printer has shown the name or symbol of a candidate other than the one he voted for, the presiding officer shall obtain a written declaration from the elector as to the allegation, after warning the elector about the consequence of making a false declaration.*

- (2) *If the elector gives the written declaration referred to in sub-rule (1), the presiding officer shall make a second entry related to that elector in Form 17A, and permit the elector to record a test vote in the voting machine in his presence and in the presence of the candidates or polling agents who may be present in the polling station, and observe the paper slip generated by the printer.*
- (3) *If the allegation is found true, the presiding officer shall report the facts immediately to the returning officer; stop further recording of votes in that voting machine and act as per the direction that may be given by the returning officer.*
- (4) *If, however, the allegation is found to be false and the paper slip so generated under sub-rule (1) matches with the test vote recorded by the elector under sub-rule (2), then the presiding officer shall-*
 - (i) *Make a remark to that effect against the second entry relating to that elector in Form 17A mentioning the serial number and name of the candidate for whom such test vote has been recorded;*
 - (ii) *obtain the signature or thumb impression of that elector against such remarks; and*
 - (iii) *make necessary entries regarding such test vote in item 5 in Part-I of Form 17C.”*

8.8. Close of Poll

- (a) Close the poll at the time fixed for the purpose, even if it had commenced somewhat later than the hour appointed for the commencement of poll owing to some unavoidable reason, and the last voter who was in the queue at the time fixed for close of poll has voted.
- (b) Presiding Officer will ensure that after the last voter has voted, the ‘CLOSE’ button is pressed on the Control Unit. **Note the total number of votes recorded in the EVM in Item No. 6 of Part-I of Form-17C.**
- (c) Make note of the Poll end date and time displayed on the CU in the Presiding Officer’s diary.
- (d) After prescribed Forms have been carefully and duly filled for the election, disconnect the Ballot Unit(s) and VVPAT from the Control Unit and seal them in their respective carrying cases with thread and Address Tags with particulars of elections as mentioned below. In the case of simultaneous election, the papers should be prepared and sealed separately.
- (e) Sealing of carrying cases of EVM
 - First **switch off** the CU and then disconnect BU(s), CU and VVPAT. Put back BU(s) and CU in their respective carrying cases and seal by putting thread seal with Address Tags.
 - Presiding Officer will **remove the power pack (battery) from VVPAT** in the presence of polling agents. Only after removal of power pack from VVPAT, seal the carrying case of VVPAT in the presence of the polling agents. The removed power pack of the VVPAT shall be deposited at the reception centre. These power packs will not be stored in strong room.
 - Seal each carrying case at both ends by passing a thread through the two holes provided for the purpose on both sides of the carrying case and putting thread seal with Address Tags.
 - Presiding Officer shall put his/her signature on address tags and also obtain the signatures of polling agents.
 - Deposit all the sealed EVMs and VVPATs and election papers to the Returning Officer, at the reception centre, as per prescribed procedure.

8.9. Presiding Officer’s Report Format (Annexure-30) to be obtained on Poll Day

- (a) **Part-I** (Mock Poll Certificate)
- (b) **Part-II** (Replacement of Power Pack of Control Unit): To be filled whenever Power Pack of the Control Unit is replaced.
- (c) **Part-III** (Pressing of Close Button after completion of Poll certificate): To be filled after completion of poll.

(d) **Part-IV** (EVM replacement Report, if replaced during Mock Poll)

(e) **Part-V** (EVM replacement Report, if replaced during Actual Poll)

8.10. Collection of Presiding Officer's Report

- i. Part-I, Part-II and Part-III of the Presiding Officer's Report shall be kept in an envelope. Details to be printed on envelope:

Name of Elections:(to be pre-printed) No. and name of AC/AS:(to be pre-printed) No. and name of PC:.....(to be pre-printed) Polling Station No.....
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The Presiding Officer shall deposit the said envelopes alongwith EVM and other election material at Reception Centre.

- ii. Part-IV and Part-V of the Presiding Officer's Report shall be collected by the Sector Officer, whenever any replacement is done. Sector Officer shall submit the said Reports to the Returning Officer.

SAMPLE POSTER FOR POLL DAY (to be displayed inside Polling Station)

MOCK POLL 90 MINUTES BEFORE ACTUAL POLL	
- Start Mock Poll 90 minutes before scheduled poll time, if 2 or more polling agents are present. - Wait for 15 minutes, if one or no polling agent is present, and then start mock poll. - Place BU(s) and VVPAT in Voting Compartment. These should not be moved after mock poll. - Place CU on Table of Presiding Officer/Polling Officer (In-charge of CU). - Connect cable of BU with VVPAT and cable of VVPAT with CU. - Unlock Paper Roll knob (to Working Position) of VVPAT. - Show that VVPAT drop box (VVPAT slips compartment) is empty. - Switch ON the CU. - Demonstrate no vote in CU by pressing Total button of the CU. If any vote is in CU, clear the data of CU through CRC process (Close-Result-Clear). - Cast at least 50 votes and manually record number of votes given to each candidate button (ensure votes are recorded for each of the contesting candidates including NOTA).	- After mock poll votes, press CLOSE button of CU. - Thereafter, press RESULT button of CU to ascertain mock poll result and tally with manual record. - Remove mock poll VVPAT slips from VVPAT drop box and tally with CU result. - Press CLEAR button of CU to clear mock poll result from CU and show to polling agents. - Stamp on back side of mock poll VVPAT slips with stamp 'MOCK POLL SLIP'. - Keep mock poll VVPAT slips in Black envelope and then seal the envelope with Pink Paper Seal. - Switch OFF the CU and seal the result section of CU with Green Paper Seal, Special Tag and Address Tag. - Show empty drop box of VVPAT to polling agents and then seal the drop box of VVPAT with Address Tag. - Fill Mock Poll Certificate (Part-I of Presiding Officer's Report) carefully.
SEALING OF CU & VVPAT	START OF ACTUAL POLL
- Switch OFF the CU before sealing. - Seal Inner and Outer doors of the CU with Green Paper Seal, Special Tag and Address Tag.	- Switch ON the CU. - Press TOTAL button of CU to ensure Zero vote and show to polling agents. - Before the first voter signs in Form 17A (Register of Voters), the Polling Officer-I shall check with the Presiding Officer and record in INK in Form 17A that 'Total in the Control Unit checked and found to be Zero and mock poll VVPAT slips have been removed from the VVPAT drop box/VVPAT drop box is empty and sealed'.

CLOSING OF POLL
• Press CLOSE button of CU. • Press TOTAL button of CU to note total polled votes in CU and also Poll Start Time (PST) and Poll End Time (PET). • Switch OFF the CU before disconnecting the cable of BU from VVPAT and VVPAT cable from CU. • Remove Power Pack (Battery) from VVPAT. • Keep BU, CU and VVPAT in their respective carrying cases and seal each carrying case with Address Tags.
REPLACEMENT PROTOCOL All 'Error' messages for BU, CU and VVPAT will be displayed on CU only. Please read message and act accordingly
MOCK POLL • In case BU or CU or VVPAT not functioning, replace the respective unit only. • Replaced non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT during mock poll shall be kept with Sector Officer and deposited by Sector Officer. ACTUAL POLL • BU or CU not functioning: replace entire set i.e. BU(s), CU and VVPAT. (Mock poll is to be conducted by casting 01 vote to each candidate button including NOTA) • VVPAT not functioning: replace VVPAT only. (No mock poll is required) • CU shows Error 'Replace Power Pack of CU': Replace Power Pack of CU only. (No mock poll is required) • CU shows Error 'Replace Power Pack of VVPAT': Replace Power Pack of VVPAT only. (No mock poll is required) • Replaced non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT during actual poll shall be kept with Presiding Officer and deposited by Presiding Officer at Reception Centre.
WHAT NOT TO DO?
MOCK POLL • Don't start mock poll, if one or no polling agent is present. Wait for 15 minutes and then start mock poll. • Don't stop mock poll without casting atleast 50 votes. • Don't start actual poll without clearing mock poll data from CU and without removing mock VVPAT slips from the drop box of VVPAT. • Don't keep mock VVPAT slips unstamped. • Don't Switch OFF and Switch ON CU while mock poll is going on. • Don't disconnect and connect cables while mock poll is going on.
ACTUAL POLL • Don't Switch OFF and Switch ON CU while actual poll is going on. • Don't disconnect and connect cables while actual poll is going on. • Don't conduct the mock poll when only VVPAT or Power Pack of BU or CU or VVPAT is replaced.
CLOSING OF POLL • Don't press CLOSE button of CU before notified poll close time or completion of poll. • Don't disconnect cables without Switching OFF the CU. • Don't leave Power Pack of VVPAT in VVPAT after completion of poll. • Don't leave carrying cases without sealing and obtaining signatures of Polling Agents after poll. • Don't use any other vehicle other than authorised vehicle for depositing polling materials at Collection Centre.

CHAPTER-9

STORAGE AND SECURITY OF EVM FROM POST-POLL TO COUNTING DAY

9.1. The Four categories of EVMs and VVPATs after Poll:

- (a) **Category ‘A’** – Polled EVMs
- (b) **Category ‘B’** – Non-functional Polled EVMs (Replaced during actual poll)
- (c) **Category ‘C’** – Non-functional Un-polled EVMs (Replaced during mock poll)
- (d) **Category ‘D’** – Unused Reserve EVMs

Three categories of strong rooms:

- (a) Polled Strong Room (Store category ‘A’ & ‘B’)
- (b) Repair Strong Room (Store category ‘C’), not in the vicinity of AC/AS strong room
- (c) Reserve Strong Room (Store category ‘D’), not in the vicinity of AC/AS strong room

9.2. Common Instructions for Safe Storage and Safety of all 04 Categories of EVMs after poll:

- (a) Advance identification of storage space & earmark as per Category A, B, C & D and intimation to all contesting candidates in writing with acknowledgement.
- (b) Under any circumstances don’t store C & D category machines in Polled Strong Room having category A & B machines for ensuring that unused machines are not blocked with the polled machines till the Election Petition (EP) period is over.
- (c) Armed Police cover for all Polling parties or authorized officials at all times.
- (d) After the Polls, also follow the same protocol for all categories of EVMs.
- (e) After the Polls, safely deposit all categories of EVMs at the pre-designated receipt centre on the same day.
- (f) Do not keep any election related material in EVMs Polled Strong Room other than Form-17C, Presiding Officer’s Declaration and Envelope containing mock poll slips or as specifically prescribed by the Commission.
- (g) Ensure security arrangements for all categories of machines as per ECI instructions.

9.3. Post-Poll Storage (Polled EVMs storage)- After poll till counting day

9.3.1. Storage protocol for Polled EVMs (Category-A and Category-B)

- (a) After completion of poll, escort back the complete set of machines (BU, CU & VVPAT) of a particular polling station to Collection/Reception Centre and store in the Polled strong room in the presence of the candidates/their authorised representatives, under videography.
- (b) Store Polled (Category-A) and Non-functional Polled EVMs (Category-B) in the same strong room as per procedure.
- (c) Earmark all polling stations on the specified parts of the floor space of the strong room in the form of squares in advance for stacking the EVM(s) of a particular polling station in the respective square. In any case, EVMs of a particular polling station, should not be stored in separate strong room i.e. all units used at a particular polling station should be kept together in the square/rack earmarked for that polling station.



- (d) If it is not feasible to accommodate all EVMs in one Strong Room, follow the protocol mentioned below:
- Keep polled EVMs (including non-functional polled) in multiple strong rooms, adjacent to each other, and outside each strong room paste a notice indicating the particulars of the elections, AC/AS name and No. and serial number of polling stations whose EVMs are kept inside.
 - Fabricated steel/iron/wooden multi-layer storage rack can be used for storing polled EVMs (including non-functional polled) as per ECI specifications, wherever floor space is less.



- (e) Ensure that more than 1 AC's machines are not stored in the same strong room after completion of poll and after counting of votes till the completion of the EP period.
- (f) In case EVMs of more than 1 AC/AS need to be kept in a big hall due to non-availability of separate strong rooms, then separate temporary strong room shall be made for every AC/AS within the big hall and each such strong room should have separate double lock system.
- (g) Safely keep the machines in demarcated space or the racks for safe storage as per ECI guidelines with prior intimation to the candidate & under proper Videography.

9.3.2. Security and Safety arrangements for Polled EVMs (Category-A and Category-B)



- (a) Single Entry/ Exit with all other doors/windows sealed with brick masonry/ concrete.
- (b) Double Lock System. Here double lock system means either 2 separate locks on the single entry/ exit door or separate locks on two different doors of the same entry/exit.
- (c) All the keys of Lock-1 with RO and all the keys of Lock-2 with ARO. In case of Parliamentary Constituency election, if some Assembly Segments are in other district(s), the all keys of Lock-1 with ARO and all the keys of Lock-2 with SDM/Tehsildar concerned.
- (d) Minimum One Platoon of Armed Police for 24X7 coverage.
- (e) Two tier security arrangements round the clock. Innermost perimeter by CAPF and outer perimeter by State Armed Police.
- (f) CCTV Cameras with DVR and Uninterrupted Power Supply. CCTV Camera should cover sealed Door of Polled Strong Room, security and corridor etc.
- (g) Operative Control Room adjacent to the Strong Room.
- (h) Log book for each entry, exit and duty roster for security personnel.
- (i) Separate Log book for authorized officials (including Observers, DEOs or SPs) crossing the second security ring i.e. the middle perimeter under Videography.
- (j) Videography at the time of the opening and closing of strong room.
- (k) Fire- extinguishers inside and outside of strong room. Adequate fire alarm system.
- (l) No entry for any vehicle including VIPs & officials.

9.3.3. Other Protocol for Polled EVMs (Category-A and Category-B)

- (a) Intimate all contesting Candidates, atleast 24 hrs. in advance, in writing with acknowledgment, for deputing their representatives for watching the security arrangements of strong room and allow them to stay outside the inner perimeter. If entrance of the Strong Room is not visible, arrange CCTV display for them with uninterrupted power supply.
- (b) Make proper arrangements like drinking water, shamiana/tent etc. for the candidate/their representatives.
- (c) Circulate the phone nos. of CEO, Addl. CEOs, DEC in-charge in the ECI and the DEO/SP/ COP/ ROs concerned for emergency.
- (d) Constant Videography of all the entry points (doors etc.) of strong room(s) using the web cams.
- (e) Visit of RO to the storage campus (up to the inner perimeter only) twice a day in the morning and evening to check the log book and Videography and send a report to the DEO on the status every day.
- (f) DEO should undertake regular or frequent visits as possible and at least once in 3-4 days.
- (g) DEOs/DCs and SPs are responsible for security of strong room within the district and meticulous implementation of the protocol. Copy of the Manual to be circulated to all candidates, DEOs, SPs, ROs and CAPF commandant.
- (h) **Opening and Closing of EVM Polled Strong Room in case of exigencies:** In case of grave exigencies like flood, fire etc., the DEO/RO may open the Polled Strong Room in the presence of candidates/their representatives already stationed there under videography. The DEO/RO shall

inform the CEO and all the contesting candidates as soon as possible on the same day. The CEO shall immediately send report to the Commission with his comment and take post facto approval.

- (i) The above instructions will also apply mutatis mutandis to the storage of the voting machines during the interval between the original count and the recount, if any.

9.4. Post-Poll Storage of Category-C and Category-D EVMs

- (a) Store EVMs of Category-C and Category-D in separate “Repair Strong Room” and “Reserve Strong Room” respectively in other location. These categories of EVMs may also be kept in the District Strong Room separately.
- (b) Store unused Reserve EVMs (Category-D) in a separate room other than vicinity of Polled Strong room so that these are made available for the purpose of any Re-Polls.
- (c) Paste ‘Reserve EVMs’/‘Non-functional during Mock Poll’ stickers on the carrying cases of such category of BUs, CUs and VVPATs.
- (d) Sector Officers shall submit a detailed account of the Reserve EVMs in **Annexure-31** at the time of deposition of the Reserve EVMs/VVPATs after the close of poll on the same day.
- (e) The RO shall furnish a Certificate in the prescribed format (**Annexure-32**).
- (f) The RO/ARO shall ensure the replacement of non-functional EVMs in EVM Management System (EMS) also.
- (g) **In case of State Legislative Assembly Election**
 - (i) Store Category-C EVMs of all Assembly Constituencies in respective District Headquarters.
 - (ii) Store Category-D EVMs of all Assembly Constituencies in a single warehouse with proper categorization of AC with temporary partition.
- (h) **In case of election(s) to the Parliamentary Constituency (ies)/Lok Sabha**
 - (i) Store Category-C EVMs of all Assembly Segments at District warehouse.
 - (ii) Store Category-D EVMs of all Assembly Segments in a single warehouse with proper categorization of AS within Parliamentary Constituency.
- (i) Categories C & D EVM are deposited at the same time when all polled EVMs (Category-A) and polled non-functional EVMs (Category-B) are stored in the strong room under written intimation to candidates and proper videography. Candidates may depute their representatives.
- (j) Minimum 1/2 Section Armed security should be deployed 24x7 to warehouse/strong room, where Categories C & D EVMs are stored.

9.5. SoP on handling of damaged/broken EVMs during election process.

- (a) With regard to handling of damaged/broken EVMs, after dispersal to mock poll on poll day and during actual poll on poll day, by miscreants or any other reason, the following SoP shall be followed:
 - (i) After dispersal to Mock poll on poll day: EVM damaged after dispersal to mock poll on poll day shall be stored in the strong room having non-functional un-polled EVMs (Category C).
 - (ii) During actual poll on poll day/before counting: Handling of EVM having polled data damaged/broken during actual poll on poll day

- Such EVM shall be kept in the strong room having polled EVMs (Category A) and non-functional polled EVMs (Category B), if the polled votes can be retrieved/paper slips are intact to obtain result during counting of votes.
 - Such EVM shall be kept in the strong room having non-functional un-polled EVMs (Category C), if the polled votes cannot be retrieved/paper slips are not intact.
- (b) The damaged/broken machines shall be marked as damaged in EVM Management System (EMS) by the DEO.
- (c) In all such cases an FIR shall be filed under the relevant Sections of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, as under, and a detailed report with a copy of FIR shall be sent to the Commission:
- (i) Section 129 (Officers, etc., at elections not to act for candidates or to influence voting)
 - (ii) Section 132 (Penalty for misconduct at the polling station)
 - (iii) Section 134 B (Prohibition of going armed to or near a polling station)
 - (iv) Section 135 (Removal of ballot papers from polling station)
 - (v) Section 135A (Offence of booth capturing)
 - (vi) Section 136 (Other offences and penalties therefor)
- (d) In addition to the aforesaid offences under the Representation of the People Act, 1951, Section 171 (Undue influence at elections), Section 351 (Punishment for criminal intimidation), 324 (Mischief), etc. of BNS shall also be suitably considered along with any other applicable provisions/statutes while filing FIR in all such cases.
- (e) The Chief Electoral Officer concerned shall follow up the FIR case with the Police Department concerned, on a regular basis.
- (f) The damaged/broken machine mentioned at para a (ii) above shall be inspected only on the order of the competent court as Rule 93 (1A) of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961, which specifies that the control units sealed under the provisions of rule 57C and kept in the custody of the District Election Officer shall not be opened and shall not be inspected by or produced before, any person or authority except under the orders of a competent court.
- (g) The damaged / broken machine mentioned at para a (i) and a(ii) (bullet point 2) above shall be provided for investigation purpose, if required. However, such EVM shall be in the custody of District Election Officer concerned.

9.6. Use of EVMs in case of Re-poll:

- (a) Draw EVMs from the unused reserve list and inform their numbers to the candidates/ agents in writing.
- (b) The reserve strong room shall be opened/closed in the presence of candidates/their representatives under videography.
- (c) Ensure that the address tag on the EVMs clearly mentions that EVMs are for use in the re-poll indicating the date and Polling Station number.
- (d) Paste “Re-poll EVM” pre-printed sticker on the EVMs and on their carrying cases.

- (e) After re-poll, re-open the strong room in presence of the candidates/ their agents and observer for storage of the re-poll EVMs.
- (f) Place re-poll EVMs together with the old EVMs which were used earlier in the original poll. Paste “TO BE COUNTED” sticker with bold print at the time of placing the ‘Re-poll EVM’ in the strong room.
- (g) Paste ‘NOT TO BE COUNTED’ sticker with bold print on the old EVMs/VVPATs, to remove any confusion at the time of counting.
- (h) Enter the unique ID number of the EVMs used in re-poll in EMS.
- (i) Specification of sticker:

Dimension: 15 cm x 10 cm

Color: Pink for AC and White for PC elections.

CHAPTER-10

COUNTING DAY



10.1. General Instructions

- (i) Polled Strong Room shall be opened in the presence of candidates/their authorised representatives, ECI Observer, RO/ARO, under videography.
- (ii) At the time of counting, bring only CUs to the Counting Hall. In case of polling station(s) where the re-poll was held, the CU on which sticker “TO BE COUNTED” is pasted shall be brought to the Counting Hall.
- (iii) The movement of EVMs to the counting hall should be in the most secure manner in a barricaded passage/secured passage. The movement of EVMs from the Strong Room to the Counting Hall shall be under CCTV coverage.
- (iv) Verify the unique ID of the CU, the Pink Paper Seal and the green paper seal and show to the Counting Agents before starting the counting.
- (v) Press ‘TOTAL’ button of CU to ascertain total votes polled in CU and compare/match with total votes polled in EVM as mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C.
- (vi) Verify the poll start date & time and poll end date & time displayed on the CU and show to the Counting Agents.
- (vii) Before taking signature of candidates/their agents/counting agents in Part II of Form 17C, in space between Counting Supervisor signature and signature of candidates/their agents/ counting agents, write in pen – “We, hereby certify that CU No(s)..... is/are the same which were used in the Polling Station No.....”.

10.2 Procedure in case of discrepancy in the date & time of start and end of poll in Control Unit

- (a) Compare the difference with the date & time noted in the mock poll certificate.
- (b) If the difference does not match with the date & time of start and end of poll as mentioned in Mock Poll Certificate or Presiding Officer Diary, keep the EVM (Control Unit) aside and refer the matter to the Commission.
- (c) The date & time of start and end of poll at the time of counting matches with the date and time of start and end of poll mentioned in mock poll certificate, explain the discrepancy to the candidates and their representatives.
- (d) Count the votes polled in the EVM (Control Unit) in the usual manner.

10.3 Procedure in case the close button is not pressed at the end of the poll-

Take the following action during counting of votes, in the presence of candidates/their authorized agents, under videography:

- (a) Press 'TOTAL' button of the CU to see total votes polled in the CU. If total votes polled in the CU tally with total votes polled in CU mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C, Counting Supervisor should press the "Close" button of the Control Unit(s) and then press "Result" button for getting result data.
- (b) If total votes polled in the CU don't tally with total votes polled in CU mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C, keep the CU back inside its carrying case and keep under Returning Officer's/ ARO's (in case of PC election) custody in the counting hall. Count the votes in other machines as usual. Action shall be taken as mentioned in para 10.5, 10.8 and 10.10.

10.4 Procedure in case Control Unit does not display result at the time of Counting.

- (a) First install new power pack in CU to obtain Result. Even then, if CU does not display result, keep the CU inside its carrying case and keep under the Returning Officer's custody in the counting hall. Counting of votes in other machines should continue as usual.
- (b) Corresponding VVPAT shall be counted as per para 10.8 and 10.10.
- (c) A report regarding counting of printed ballot slips of VVPAT should be sent to the Commission in the following format through Chief Electoral Officer for information.

S.No.	No. and Name of AC/ AS (in case of PC)	Polling Station No.	Unique ID of VVPAT	Unique ID of CU for which VVPAT paper slips counted

10.5 Issues regarding counting of VVPAT slips: non-deletion of mock poll data from the Control Unit or non-removal of mock poll slips from VVPAT or total votes polled in CU does not match with the record of votes in Form 17C-

10.5.1 The following cases may arise on poll day or during scrutiny of documents on P+1 day or during the round-wise counting of votes from EVMs:

- (i) Mock poll is not erased from the Control Unit but VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll are removed;
- (ii) Neither mock poll is erased from the Control Unit nor VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll are removed;
- (iii) Total votes polled in Control Unit during counting do not match with the total number of votes recorded as per EVM as mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C.
- (iv) Mock Poll result is erased from Control Unit but mock poll VVPAT paper slips are not removed.

These are indication that the Close-Result-Clear (CRC) protocol after mock poll was not correctly done or VVPAT Slips are not removed after Mock Poll or there is human error in noting down the total votes recorded in the EVM as mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C, in respect of the particular polling station at the close of poll.

10.5.2 Procedure to be followed:-

- (a) The list of all such polling stations covered under para (i) and (ii) of 10.5.1. shall be shared with

the contesting candidates in the counting hall just before the commencement of counting of votes and subsequent at the time of counting and in case of para (iii) of 10.5.1., during counting of votes, as the case may be.

- (b) In all such cases, the CU shall be kept aside i.e. these polling stations will not be taken up for counting during the regular round-wise counting of the Control Units. The Table allocated to such polling stations shall be kept vacant during the relevant round of counting.
- (c) After the completion of all regular rounds of counting through Control Units, the VVPAT slips of all such polling station(s), whose Control Units were kept aside, shall be counted at VVPAT Counting Booth (VCB).
- (d) In respect of case mentioned at para (i) of 10.5.1., the VVPAT slips of the respective polling station shall be counted to arrive at correct count of candidate wise votes polled.
- (e) In respect of case mentioned at para (ii) of 10.5.1., the VVPAT slips of the respective polling station shall be counted and the candidate-wise votes from mock poll certificate shall be deducted to arrive at correct count of candidate wise votes polled.
- (f) In respect of case mentioned at para (iii) of 10.5.1., the action may be taken as mentioned at (d) or (e) above, depending upon whether the VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll are removed or not respectively.
- (g) In respect of case mentioned at para (iv) of 10.5.1., candidate-wise result may be ascertained from the Control Unit.
- (h) Candidate-wise votes obtained from VVPAT slips count of each such polling station shall be treated as a separate round of counting. Candidate-wise votes obtained from VVPAT slips count of all these polling stations shall be added to the candidate-wise tally and the final result compiled.

10.5.3 If there is any difficulty to arrive at correct count of candidate wise votes polled, the matter shall be referred to the Commission for further directions.

10.5.4 Since, in the aforesaid cases mentioned at para (i) to (iii) of 10.5.1., the Control Unit(s) will be discarded/not used for counting of votes, these polling stations shall be excluded from the random selection of 05 polling stations for Mandatory Verification of VVPAT paper slips count. If the polling station mentioned at para (iv) of 10.5.1. is selected during mandatory verification of VVPAT slips count or mismatch between CU Count and VVPAT slips count is noticed due to non-removal of mock poll VVPAT paper slips, the candidate-wise mock poll data mentioned in Mock Poll Certificate may be deducted candidate-wise to tally the votes during mandatory verification.

10.5.5 In all cases where mock poll is either not erased from the Control Unit or VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll are not removed (fully or partially) or total votes polled in CU does not match with the record of votes polled in EVM as mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C, disciplinary action shall be taken against the Presiding Officer and Polling Officer-I of the polling station concerned.

10.6 Candidate Demanding VVPAT Paper Slips Counting under Rule 56D

- (a) After announcement of result sheet entries, any candidate, or in his absence, his election agent or any of his counting agents may apply in writing to the RO for counting of the printed VVPAT paper slips of any polling station or polling stations. If such application is received, the RO should pass a speaking order on whether the VVPAT paper slips should be counted or not with the reason thereof. If the RO decides to allow the counting of the VVPAT paper slips

of any or all polling stations, such decision of the RO must be recorded in writing along with the reasons thereof. The RO should give due consideration to the following:

- (i) Whether the total number of votes polled in that polling station is greater or lesser than the margin of votes between winning candidate and candidate demanding the counting.
 - (ii) Whether EVM had a problem and was replaced at that polling station during poll
 - (iii) Whether there was any complaint about VVPAT not printing or complaints by any voter under Rule 49MA of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961 in that polling station during the poll.
- (b) A report regarding counting of printed slips of VVPAT should be sent to the Commission in the following format through Chief Electoral Officer concerned for information.

S. No.	No. and Name of AC/AS (in case of PC)	S. no. of the Polling Station for which counting requested	Whether request accepted (Yes/No)	Unique ID of VVPAT in case request accepted	Unique ID of CU for which VVPAT paper slips counted under Rule 56D of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961	Discrepancy if any (Yes/No)	If yes, details thereof

10.7 **Mandatory Verification of VVPAT Paper Slips:**

- (a) Mandatory verification of VVPAT paper slips of randomly selected 05 (five) polling stations must be conducted in all General and Bye-Elections to the House of the People and State Legislative Assemblies, **in addition** to the provisions of Rule 56D of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961, after the completion of the last round of counting of votes recorded in the EVMs and as per sequence of VVPAT slips count mentioned at para 10.8, as under:
- (i) In case of General and Bye elections to State Legislative Assemblies, verification of VVPAT paper slips of randomly selected **05 (five) polling stations per Assembly Constituency.**
 - (ii) In case of General and Bye elections to the House of the People, verification of VVPAT paper slips of randomly selected **05 (five) polling stations of each Assembly Segment of the Parliamentary Constituency concerned.**
- (b) For this mandatory verification of VVPAT paper slips, the following procedure to be followed:
- (i) The random selection of 05 (five) polling stations per Assembly Constituency/Segment to be done by Draw of lots, by the Returning Officer/ARO concerned, in the presence of candidates/their agents and the General Observer appointed by the Commission for that Constituency.
 - (ii) The draw of lots must be conducted immediately after the completion of the last round of counting of votes, in the designated Counting Hall for the particular Assembly Constituency/Assembly Segment.
 - (iii) A written intimation regarding the conduct of draw of lots for the random selection of 05 (five) polling stations for verification of VVPAT Slips should be given by the Returning Officer to the Candidates/their election agents well in advance.

- (iv) The following procedure to be followed for the conduct of draw of lots:
- Use White colour paper cards of postcard size for conducting the draw of lots.
 - Total number of such paper cards must be equal to total number of polling stations in the Assembly Constituency/Segment.
 - Do not include the polling stations where VVPAT paper slips have already been counted due to non-display of result from the Control Unit(s) or non-deletion of mock poll or non-removal of mock poll VVPAT slips or under Rule 56(D) of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961 or whatsoever the reason in the draw of lots for mandatory verification of VVPAT slips count.
 - The paper cards to have pre-printed Assembly Constituency/Assembly Segment number, AC/AS name and date of polling on the top, and the polling station number in the Centre.
 - Each digit of the polling station number should be at least 1”x 1”(1 inch by 1 inch) size and printed in black ink.
 - The paper cards to be used for draw of lots should be four-folded in such a way that polling station number is not visible.
 - Show each paper card to the candidates/their agents before folding and dropping in the container.
 - Keep the paper cards in a big container and shake well before picking up one-by-one 5 (five) slips by the Returning Officer/ARO (in case of PC election).
- (v) The verification of VVPAT paper slips should be done in a VVPAT Counting Booth (VCB), specially prepared for this purpose inside the Counting Hall. The booth should be enclosed in a wire mesh just like a bank cashier’s cabin so that no VVPAT paper slip can be accessed by any unauthorized person. One of the Counting tables in the Counting Hall can be converted into the VCB and can be used for normal counting of round-wise EVM votes before the count of VVPAT slips as per random selection after the completion of round- wise EVM counting.
- (vi) Conduct the Verification count of the VVPAT paper slip of the randomly selected 5(five) polling stations sequentially i.e. **one after another**.
- (vii) Strictly conduct the verification count of the VVPAT paper slips of randomly selected 05 (five) polling stations in accordance with the instructions of the Commission on counting of printed paper slips.
- (viii) The Returning Officer and the Assistant Returning Officer, as the case may be, should personally supervise the counting of VVPAT paper slips at the VCB. The Observer concerned should maintain close and direct oversight on the entire exercise and ensure strict compliance of the Commission’s instructions.
- (ix) In case there is any mismatch between electronic count of the Control Unit and VVPAT slips manual count, recounting of the VVPAT slips of that particular EVM to be done till it tallies either with the EVM count or one of the previous VVPAT slips counts. Para 10.5.4 may also be seen in this regard.

- (x) After completing the process as specified in para 10.7 (ix) above, if there is any discrepancy between EVM count and VVPAT paper slips count, as per Rule 56(D)(4)(b) of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, the VVPAT paper slips count should prevail. Hence, if there is any discrepancy between the count of votes displayed on the Control Unit and the count of printed paper slips in respect of that polling station, amend the result sheet as per the printed paper slips count.
- (xi) The above process must be fully video recorded.
- (xii) After completion of the above process, the Returning Officer should give a certificate in the annexed format (**Annexure-33**) separately for each polling station to the Chief Electoral Officer concerned. The CEO should compile the reports for the entire State/UT and submit a consolidated summarized report to the Commission within 7 days from the end of counting process.
- (xiii) The Observers appointed by the Commission should also submit their report to the Commission in the annexed format (**Annexure-34**)

10.8 Sequence of VVPAT Slips Count

After completion of all round of counting of votes recorded in EVMs, sequence of VVPAT slips count should be as under:

- (a) Count the VVPAT slips of polling station(s) for which result is not displayed on the Display Panel of the Control Unit.
- (b) Count the VVPAT slips of polling station(s) due to improper conduct of mock poll procedure by non-clearance of mock poll data/slips or mismatch of votes polled in CU and mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C.
- (c) Counting of VVPAT slips under Rule 56D of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, if any.
- (d) Mandatory verification of VVPAT slips of randomly selected 05 polling stations per Assembly Constituency/each Assembly Segment of Parliamentary Constituency.

Note:

- (i) Further, count the VVPAT paper slips one by one not simultaneously.
- (ii) Every VVPAT paper slips count to be considered as a separate round.
- (iii) In respect of step c & d, amend the result sheet as per the printed paper slips count, if the VVPAT paper counts differ from electronic count (CUs), in terms of Rule 56D of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961.

10.9 Arrangements for Counting of VVPAT Paper Slips:

- (a) Returning Officer should earmark one of the Counting Tables inside the Counting Hall as VVPAT Counting Booth (VCB) for Counting of VVPAT Paper Slips.
- (b) VCB should have minimum length 6 ft., breadth 6 ft. and height 8 ft.
- (c) All four sides and ceiling should be covered with narrow wire mesh and a circular hole of 5 cm radius at suitable height for the counting agents' transactions.
- (d) Installation of CCTV on ceiling just above the counting table for monitoring and recording purpose.
- (e) Seating arrangements for at least 4 persons inside the VCB.

10.10 Procedure to Count VVPAT Paper Slips:

The following procedures to be strictly followed:

Step-1:

- (a) For keeping VVPAT Paper Slips taken out from the Drop Box of the VVPAT, a sufficiently sized container with lid of dimensions 14 inch X 10 inch X 5 inch (length x breadth x height), to easily accommodate around 1400 Printed Paper Slips, to be kept on the table of VCB. This Container should be made of sturdy transparent material, Sample images of the Container are available in **Annexure-35**.
- (b) For keeping VVPAT paper slips of the respective candidates, a Pigeonhole Framework should be prepared in advance according to the number of candidates including NOTA, with one additional pigeonhole for keeping self-test slips of the VVPAT, and to be kept on the table of VCB. The following should be considered:
 - (i) The number of Pigeonholes in the Framework must be equal to the number of contesting candidates plus 2 (two) (i.e. one for keeping NOTA slips and other for test slips).
 - (ii) The size of each compartment (Pigeonhole) must be at least 6 inch X 4 inch X 4 inch (length x breadth x height).
 - (iii) The pigeonhole structure should be made of sturdy transparent material, having a fixed base, to prevent any VVPAT paper slip from slipping underneath.
 - (iv) The symbol of each contesting candidate as per the Ballot Paper should be affixed on the wall of the pigeonhole allotted to the particular candidates. The symbol should be printed in black and white on a plain paper of minimum size 4inch X 3 inch. Sample images of the Pigeonhole Framework are placed in **Annexure-35**.
- (c) At least 100 Rubber bands for making bundles of 25 VVPAT paper slips.

Step-2

- (a) Bring the VVPAT unit(s) of the respective polling station(s) to the VCB one by one.
- (b) In case a VVPAT unit was replaced during poll at that polling station, bring all the VVPAT units used at that polling station to the VCB.

Step-3

- (a) Take out the printed paper slips from VVPAT used at the polling station, before beginning the counting of VVPAT paper slips for that polling station. In case more than one VVPAT were used, count slips of each VVPATs separately, one by one and enter the result of each VVPAT in the **Annexure-36** (separate for each VVPAT). Thereafter, prepare the Final Result sheet by combining all results of that particular polling station and attach the same to Part-II of Form-17C.

Before taking out the VVPAT Paper Slips from the drop box, cross check the address tag(s) of the drop box to ascertain that the VVPAT pertains to the respective polling station. The following procedures should be followed:

- (i) Keep the VVPAT Paper Slips taken out from the Drop Box of the VVPAT first in the container as per specification at Step 1(a).
- (ii) After taking out the VVPAT paper slips from Drop Box, the Counting Supervisor must ensure that no VVPAT paper slip is left inside the VVPAT drop box and show the empty drop box to the counting agents.

- (iii) In case a VVPAT unit was replaced, it may so happen that an uncut fully or partially VVPAT paper slip is hanging and has not got cut and dropped in the drop box and still connected to the paper roll. This uncut VVPAT paper slip should not be torn and counted because the vote is not recorded electronically in the CU unless the VVPAT paper slip is cut. In such an event, the last voter whose VVPAT paper slip was not cut would have been given an opportunity to cast his vote after replacement of VVPAT and the VVPAT paper slip of the vote cast by him will be in the next VVPAT used in that polling station.
- (iv) The drop box of the VVPAT should also have VVPAT slips of self-test report. These are easily identified, as they do not have either the name or the symbol of any candidate. These self-test report slips are to be preserved along with the VVPAT paper slips as part of the record but they are not to be counted.

Step-4

- (a) Segregate the VVPAT paper slips one-by-one and put in respective pigeon holes after showing each slip to the Counting Agents. The paper slips bearing self-tests report should also be segregated and put in a separate pigeonhole provided for the purpose.
- (b) Prepare bundles of 25 VVPAT paper slips of respective candidates for counting purpose.
- (c) Counting staff should then count VVPAT Paper Slips.
- (d) Prepare result of the VVPAT paper slips count in the format as per **Annexure-36** and attach to Part-II of Form 17-C (**Annexure-37**).
- (e) Announce the result of the count of VVPAT paper slips in the counting hall and show it to the Counting Agents.
- (f) As per Rule 56D (4) (b) of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, if there is any discrepancy between EVM count and paper slip count, the paper slip count should prevail. Hence, if there is discrepancy between the counts of votes displayed on the Control Unit and the count of printed paper slips in respect of that Polling Station, amend the result sheet as per the printed paper slips count.

Step-5

- (a) After completion of counting of VVPAT paper slips, keep the bundle of the VVPAT Paper Slips back in the Drop Box of the respective VVPAT and seal the door of the Drop Box using address tags.
- (b) Allow the candidate(s)/their agents to affix their signature with party abbreviation on the Address Tags.

10.11 Sealing of EVMs after counting of votes

After completion of counting, keep all Control Units, after removing power packs from CUs, whether result has been retrieved from it or not back inside its carrying case and seal the carrying cases once again. The Returning Officer should put their signatures on the seal. Allow all candidates and their election agents to put their signature on the seal. Then keep the Control Unit in the strong room(s).



NOTE: All seals used on the counting day for sealing of EVMs & VVPAT slips taken out from VVPATs shall be signed by the RO/ARO and candidate/Counting agents.

10.12 Removal of VVPAT slips from VVPATs after completion of Counting of Votes –

After the result is announced, the VVPAT paper slips will be taken out from the VVPAT (drop box), irrespective of whether the slips were counted or not, as per the following procedure:

- (i) Thorough checking of officials deputed for the removal of VVPAT slips and their sealing must be ensured. All pockets need to be emptied before entering the Sealing Room/Strong Room and thorough checking of officials leaving the sealing room should be done in addition to DFMD/Metal Detector Checking.
- (ii) The VVPAT paper slips shall be taken out from the drop box of VVPAT and kept polling station wise in a paper envelope made of thick black paper; it shall be sealed using red wax with the bilingual secret seal of the Commission provided to the Returning Officer. If more than one VVPAT was used in a particular polling station, the VVPAT slips taken out from each VVPAT slips should be kept in the separate envelope. Following shall be written on the envelopes:

- (a) Name of Election
- (b) Number and Name of Parliamentary/Assembly Constituency
- (c) Particular of polling station:
- (d) Unique Serial Number of the Control Unit
- (e) Unique Serial Number of VVPAT unit
- (f) Date of poll

- (iii) Candidates and their authorised agents shall be allowed to witness the process and their signatures shall also be obtained on every envelope.
- (iv) All the envelopes of a particular Assembly Constituency/Assembly Segment must be kept in a separate big trunk. The trunk must be sealed using red wax with the bilingual secret seal of the Commission provided to the Returning Officer. Following shall be written on the trunk:

- VVPAT SLIPs OF POLL DAY**
- (a) Name of Election
 - (b) Number and Name of Parliamentary/Assembly Constituency
 - (c) Date of poll

- (v) Similarly, mock poll VVPAT slips envelopes shall also be kept in a separate trunk.
- (vi) The said trunk(s) shall be kept with all the statutory documents relating to that election and shall be disposed of as mentioned in the Rule 94 of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961. If any Election Petition is pending, the same shall be preserved till the final disposal of the election petition.
- (vii) Once the VVPAT paper slips have been taken out, the VVPAT must be kept in a designated warehouse. VVPAT should not be kept in the same strong room where EVMs are stored, so that even if any election petition is filed for the constituency, the VVPAT units can be taken out for future use in subsequent elections, if required, without opening the strong room having polled EVMs (BUs and CUs).
- (viii) The entire process should be conducted under high quality CCTV recording/videography and under the supervision of RO/ARO concerned. CCTV recording/videography shall be made in such a way that the entire process must be clearly visible. Two copies of CCTV recording/

videography shall be made. One copy of the same shall be kept in the strong room having all the statutory documents relating to that election and the trunk and one copy in the custody of the District Election Officer concerned.

- (ix) RO/ARO shall be responsible for any lapses on the compliance of the aforesaid direction of the Commission.
- (x) It should again be ensured that power pack has been taken out from the VVPAT before keeping the units in the designated warehouse.
- (xi) In no case, Paper Roll Compartment shall be opened to remove paper roll from the VVPATs i.e. Paper Roll Compartment of the VVPATs shall be intact.

10.13 Storage of EVMs (BUs and CUs) and VVPAT slips after counting of votes:

10.13.1 After completing counting of votes, keep the EVMs (BUs and CUs) in the District Strong Room and trunk containing printed paper slips of VVPATs in the strong rooms having statutory document. Do not open the Strong rooms till the completion of Election Petition (EP) period i.e. till EP list is received from High Court concerned.

- (a) Sub-rules (1A) and (2)(cc) of Rule 92 of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961- keep all voting machines and the printed paper slips sealed under the provisions of rule 57C of the said Rule in the custody of DEO concerned.
- (b) DEOs are the custodian of EVMs.
- (c) A minimum of one section State Armed Police shall be deployed till the Election Petition period is over.

10.13.2.Storage of EVMs after Counting of Votes:

- (a) After completion of counting of votes, seal CU as per existing instruction of the Commission after removal of power pack from CU. Thereafter, shift EVMs to District Strong Room. In District Strong Room, EVMs and VVPATs should not be kept together. VVPATs (having no VVPAT slips) should be stored separately in the District Strong Room so that VVPAT can be used, if required, even during Election Petition Period.
- (b) Inform all the contesting candidates/their agents well in advance in writing with acknowledgment about the location of EVM Strong Room. Allow them to put their seals on the double lock system of the strong room.
- (c) Guidelines to follow if the strong room is at different place than the counting centre:
 - (i) Allow the contesting candidates/their agents to follow the vehicles carrying EVMs and give advance intimation in writing with acknowledgment.
 - (ii) Provide proper armed escort for the vehicles carrying EVMs after counting of votes with videography.
- (d) Do not keep EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) of more than 1 Assembly Constituencies/ Segments in the same strong room till completion of Election Petition. In case EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) of more than 1 AC/AS need to be kept in a big hall, then separate temporary strong room shall be made for every AC/AS within the big hall and each such strong room should have separate double lock system.

- (e) In case of simultaneous elections, store EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) pertaining to AC and AS in separate strong rooms i.e. do not keep EVMs pertaining to AC with EVMs pertaining to AS of PC in the same strong room.
- (f) Following guidelines to be followed in case of not keeping of EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) pertaining of 1 AC/AS in a single room:
 - (i) Keep EVMs in two strong rooms, adjacent to each other within a building and paste notice indicating the particular of elections, AC/AS name and No. and serial number of polling stations outside of all such strong rooms.
 - (ii) Fabricated steel/iron/wooden multi-layer storage rack for EVMs.

10.14 Guidelines on retention period of EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) under Rule 94(aa) of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961 after using in elections and for using the same in subsequent elections:

- (a) Do not touch any EVM (Ballot Units and Control Units) used in an election which are in the custody of the DEO, under the standard protocol of security, till confirmation of Election Petition (EP) position from the High Court concerned, after the completion of the period for filing Election Petition i.e. 45 days from the date of declaration of the result.
- (b) Immediately after completion of EP period, obtain the details of the EP/Court Cases pertaining to the election from the High Court/Court concerned.
- (c) After ascertaining the position of EP/court cases from the court concerned,
 - (i) Within 10 days, send all the non-functional EVMs pertaining to actual poll (along with list containing unique ID of BU/CU) to BEL/ECIL, which are not involved in any EP/ court cases.
 - (ii) Do not open the Strong Room in which the non-functional EVMs pertaining to any EP/ court case are kept. After final disposal of the EP/Court case, send the non-functional EVMs for repairs to the respective factories within one month.
- (d) If there is no election petition filed or no other court cases are pending, after the aforesaid period, use EVMs for any future election or any other purpose like movement, physical verification of EVMs etc.
- (e) Take following action if EP filed: -
 - (i) If EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) are the subject of the EP, the EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) used at all Polling Stations in the constituency continue to be in the safe custody of the DEO, till the EP is finally disposed of by the Courts.
 - (ii) After disposal of election petition/court case, the CEO shall take the following action:
 - Ascertain the position of appeal from the Supreme Court.
 - If no appeal is filed within the stipulated time period, the DEO shall be permitted to open the warehouse, if needed.
 - Petitioners/respondents of the EP/Court case shall be invited through a Notice regarding opening of the strong room.
 - (iii) If EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) are not subject of EP, move an application to the court concerned for taking out the EVMs from the strong room for any future

election or any other purpose. In case, the Hon'ble High Court permits for taking out the EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) for use in elections, there is no need to ascertain about appeal filed in the Hon'ble Supreme Court. The procedure mentioned below shall be followed in such case.

- (iv) The procedure for segregating the EVMs not involved in any EP/court case from the EVMs involved in EP/Court case stored at one place: -
 - Give a notice informing the opening of Strong Room having EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) involved in EP/Court Case to the petitioners/respondents of the EP/Court Case and the representatives of all political parties in writing at least 72 hours in advance, requesting them to remain present at the time of opening of strong room.
 - Open the strong room in the presence of the DEO, Petitioners/respondents of the EP/Court case and representatives of Political Parties.
 - Segregate and take out the EVMs (Ballot Units and Control Units) not involved in any EP/Court Case from the EVMs involved in EP/Court Case from the strong room under videography and provide a list of EVMs taken out to the petitioner/respondent of the EP/ court case and take acknowledgement.
- (f) If any other Court Case is pending, like, booth capturing, etc., in which any EVM is involved, keep the EVM concerned or the EVM(s) used at such Polling Station(s) concerned till the final disposal of the said case. After the final disposal of the election petitions or other court cases, as the case may be, referred to above, use the EVMs for subsequent elections.

10.15 Storage of VVPAT Paper Slips after expiry of period of filing of Election Petitions

- (a) In the case of elections, where **no election petition has been filed or no other court cases are pending**, after the aforesaid period VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll and actual poll shall be disposed of as per relevant provision mentioned in the Rule 94 of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961. These VVPAT paper slips shall be disposed of as per following procedure:
 - (i) VVPAT paper slips shall be disposed of by using Paper Shredding Machine within seven days of the order of District Election Officer.
 - (ii) The above shredding shall be done in the presence of a Gazetted Officer duly nominated by the District Election Officer concerned in the format attached as **Annexure-38**.
 - (iii) The District Election Officers shall submit a certificate in the format attached as **Annexure-39**, to the Chief Electoral Officer concerned in this regard within 15 days
 - (iv) The Chief Electoral Officer shall submit a consolidated certificate in the format attached as **Annexure-40** to the Commission within 30 days.
- (b) In case of any election **where election petition has been filed**, the VVPAT slips shall be preserved till the final disposal of the election petition. Thereafter, the slips will be disposed of as per the process mentioned in para 10.15 (a).

10.16 Disposal of unusable/expired Power Packs of EVMs

For disposal of the power packs, ECI instruction, dated 26/10/2022 shall be followed.

SAMPLE OF POSTER TO BE DISPLAYED ON COUNTING DAY AT THE COUNTING HALL

START OF COUNTING OF VOTES FROM CONTROL UNIT
General Instructions • Start EVM counting after 30 minutes of start of postal ballot counting. At the time of counting bring only Control Units (CUs) in Counting Hall. • Verify the unique ID of the CU, the Pink Paper Seal and the green paper seal and intactness of seals and show to the counting agents before ascertaining the result from CU. • Press TOTAL button of CU to ascertain total votes polled in CU and compare/match with total votes polled in EVM mentioned in Part-I of Form-17C. • Press RESULT button of CU and show result display on CU to the counting agents. • Before taking signature of candidates/their agents/counting agents, in space between counting supervisor's signature and signature of candidates/their agents/counting agents in Part II of Form 17C, write in pen – <i>“We, hereby certify that CU No(s)..... is/are the same which were used in the Polling Station No.....”</i>
Procedure in case of discrepancy in the date & time of start and end of poll • Compare the difference with the date & time noted in the mock poll certificate or Presiding Officer's Diary. • If the difference does not match, refer the matter to the Commission. • If the difference matches, count the votes polled in the usual manner.
Procedure in case the close button is not pressed at the end of the poll • Press TOTAL button to see total votes polled in this CU and compare with the total votes polled in EVM mentioned in Part-I of Form-1 7C. • If tallies, the Counting Supervisor should press the “Close” button of the Control Unit(s) so that “Result” button can be pressed for getting result data. • If does not tally, keep the CU back inside its carrying case and then under Returning Officer's/ ARO's (in case of PC election) custody. • VVPAT slips of the respective polling station(s) shall be counted after completion of counting of votes from all CUs.
In case Control Unit does not display result • Install new power pack in CU to obtain Result. • Even then CU does not display result, keep the CU aside and count the VVPAT slips of the corresponding VVPAT, after completion of counting of votes from all the Control Units.
Issues regarding counting of VVPAT slips: non-deletion of mock poll data from the Control Unit or non-removal of mock poll slips from VVPAT or total votes polled in CU does not match the record of votes in Part-I of Form 17C • Keep the CU back inside its carrying case and then keep it under Returning Officer's custody. • After completion of counting of votes from all CUs, count VVPAT slips of such polling station(s). • Where mock poll data has been cleared but mock poll VVPAT slips have not been removed from VVPAT, in such case result shall be ascertained from Control Unit. • If there is any discrepancy or difficulty to arrive at correct count of candidate wise votes polled, the matter shall be referred to the Commission for further direction.

Candidate Demanding VVPAT PAPER SLIPS COUNTING under Rule 56D

- Candidate/Counting agents can demand only in writing.
- RO to pass speaking order to count or not to count VVPAT slips considering the following guidelines:
 - Whether the total number of votes polled in that polling station is greater or lesser than the margin of votes between winning candidate and candidate demanding the counting.
 - Whether EVM had a problem and was replaced at that polling station during poll
 - Whether there was any complaint about VVPAT not printing or complaints by any voter under Rule 49MA in that polling station during the poll.

MANDATORY VERIFICATION OF VVPAT PAPER SLIPS:

- In case of General and Bye elections to State Legislative Assemblies, verification of VVPAT paper slips of randomly selected **05 (five) polling stations per Assembly Constituency**.
- In case of General and Bye elections to the House of the People, verification of VVPAT paper slips of randomly selected **05(five) polling stations of each Assembly Segment of the Parliamentary Constituency concerned**.
- Do not include the polling stations where VVPAT paper slips have been counted due to non display of result from the Control Unit(s) or non-deletion of mock poll data from CU or non-removal of mock poll slips from VVPAT or total votes polled in CU does not match with the record of votes mentioned in Part-I of Form 17C or under Rule 56(D) of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961 or whatsoever the reason in the draw of lots for mandatory verification of VVPAT slips count.

SEQUENCE OF VVPAT SLIPS COUNT

- Count the VVPAT slips of polling station(s) for which result is not displayed on the Display Panel of the Control Unit.
- Count the VVPAT slips of polling station(s) having cases of non-deletion of mock poll data from CU or non-removal of mock poll slips from VVPAT or total votes polled in CU does not match with the record of votes mentioned in Part-I of Form 17C.
- Counting of VVPAT slips under Rule 56D of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, if any.
- Mandatory verification of VVPAT slips of randomly selected 05 polling stations per Assembly Constituency/each Assembly Segment of Parliamentary Constituency.
- Further, count the VVPAT paper slips one by one not simultaneously.

NOTE: If there is any discrepancy between EVM count and VVPAT paper slips count, as per Rule 56(D)(4)(b) of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, the VVPAT paper slips count should prevail.

SEALING OF EVMs AND VVPATs AFTER COUNTING OF VOTES

- Remove Power Pack from Control Units before re-sealing.
- Remove VVPAT slips from VVPATs and seal in black envelope and store as per existing direction of the ECI.
- Paper Roll shall **not** be removed from the VVPAT. Paper Roll compartment shall be intact.
- Remove Power Pack from VVPATs, if any.

CHAPTER-11

EVM CHECKING AND VERIFICATION (CHECKING AND VERIFICATION OF BURNT MEMORY/MICROCONTROLLER OF EVM UNITS)

Administrative Standard Operating Procedure (Administrative-SoP) for Checking & Verification of Burnt Memory/Microcontroller of EVM [Ballot Unit (BU), Control Unit (CU) & VVPAT]-Post Announcement of Results

The process of checking and verification of burnt memory/microcontroller of EVM shall be referred to as 'EVM Checking & Verification' process or 'EVM C&V' process, in short.

11.1. Overall Responsibility:

- (a) District Election Officer (DEO) shall be responsible for overall process.
- (b) DEO shall ensure strict adherence and compliance of the instructions.
- (c) DEO shall appoint an officer not below the rank of Deputy DEO as an EVM C&V Supervising Officer to personally supervise the entire process.

11.2 Application for checking & verification of burnt memory/microcontrollers of EVMs (EVM C&V Process):

- (a) Candidates who are at Sl.No.2 or Sl.No.3 ('eligible candidates') behind the highest polled candidate, may request for checking and verification of burnt memory/microcontrollers for any tampering or modification in 5% of EVMs, that is, the Ballot Unit, Control Unit and VVPAT per Assembly Constituency (AC)/Assembly Segment (AS) of a Parliamentary Constituency.
- (b) For example, for an AC/AS that has used 400 BUs (2 BUs were used in all polling stations), 200 CUs and 200 VVPATs in a poll, the following clarifications may be noted w.r.t. the selection of EVM for C&V activity:
 - (i) The EVM C&V activity shall be restricted to a maximum of 20 BUs, 10 CUs and 10 VVPATs.
 - (ii) If both the eligible candidates choose to request for 5% EVM C&V, then each of them may be allowed to select 2.5% of the Ballot Unit, Control Unit and VVPAT each pertaining to AC/AS for the said checking and verification i.e. each eligible candidate shall be allowed to select maximum of 10 BUs, 5 CUs and 5 VVPATs.
 - (iii) EVMs shall be subjected to C&V as a set i.e. a combination of BU(s), CU and VVPAT, as used in the actual elections.
 - (iv) Apart from EVM Checking and Verification (EVM C&V) of burnt memory/ micro-controller, the eligible candidate(s) may also opt to conduct a mock poll on the selected EVM units.
 - (v) The eligible candidates may also opt to upload the data loaded on the Symbol Loading Units (SLU) used for election in the mock poll. In this regard, it is highlighted that the VVPAT already have loaded data of actual candidates' symbols. However, the applicant can opt for use of already loaded symbols of VVPAT or request to reload the symbols loaded on the Symbol Loading Units (SLU) afresh in VVPAT for the mock poll.
 - (vi) At the start of the EVM C&V activity, if any selected unit(s) of EVM is found non-functional, i.e. those units that have gone non-functional during the post-counting storage, the eligible candidate(s) shall be permitted to select another EVM unit(s) to replace non-functional unit(s) of EVM to be subjected to the EVM C&V.

- (c) For the purpose of conducting EVM C&V activity, the eligible candidates may submit a written application to the respective DEO, in prescribed EVM-C&V Form (**Annexure-41**) within a period of seven days from the date of declaration of the result. To remove any doubts, if the date of declaration of the result is January 1st, then the applications should be made between January 1st and January 7th, both dates inclusive.
- (d) Candidates shall clearly mention the list of units selected for EVM C&V either in the form of polling station numbers or unique serial number of the Ballot Unit, Control Unit and VVPAT (already made available to the candidates polling-station wise before polling), which were used for polling (except the units declared non-functional during poll and replaced or declared non-functional during counting of votes) and attach with EVM-C&V Form.
- (e) **Charges for EVM C&V activity:** The charge for EVM C&V activity to be paid by the applicant candidate is fixed at Rs. 23,600/-(inclusive of GST @ 18%) per set of EVM in case of C&V check through diagnostic check only. In case C&V check includes mock poll the rate will be Rs. 47,200/-(inclusive GST @ 18%) per set of EVM.
- (f) The *proof of payment* (online/office payment challan) of the applicable charges for EVM C&V activity as per para (e) above to the State/UT treasury under the appropriate head as applicable/decided by the CEO concerned, shall be submitted along with the written request. Applications received without the proof of payment for EVM C&V activity shall be rejected in writing and with acknowledgement.
- (g) It is clarified that expenditure on EVM C&V activity shall not be construed as expenditure of candidate, and thus shall not be part of the limits, as prescribed in Section 76 to 78 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951.

11.3 **Action to be taken on the Application(s):**

- (a) DEO shall communicate the details of applications received AC/AS-wise to the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) as per DEO EVM-C&V Application Summary (**Annexure-42**), on the last day prescribed for submitting such applications. Even if no application is received, a 'NIL' report shall be sent to the respective CEO.
- (b) CEO shall consolidate all district-wise applications and forward the same to the BEL/ECIL within 15 days of the declaration of result in CEO EVM-C&V Application Summary (**Annexure-43**), under intimation to the Commission.

11.4 **Schedule of Checking & Verification:**

- (a) **Election petitions:** After completion of Election Petition (EP) period (i.e. 45 days from the date of declaration of result as provided in Section 81 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951), a written confirmation on the status of filing of EPs shall be obtained by the Chief Electoral Officer from the Hon'ble High Court concerned.
- (b) In case there are no EPs filed, then the checking and verification process shall be carried out as mentioned below at (f) and (g). If EVMs (BUs, CUs and VVPATs) are required for future elections (e.g. FLC etc.) before EVM C&V activities, the DEO concerned shall keep selected units separately for EVM C&V activities. Apart from the selected units, 10 additional sets of EVMs (used in poll) from the respective Assembly Constituency/Segment shall be kept for replacement purpose during C&V activities. The applicant candidate shall be requested in writing to select from those 10 sets of EVMs. If applicant candidate is not willing to select from those 10 sets of EVMs, the DEO shall select them and intimate to the applicant candidates in writing.

- (c) In case EP has been filed, then checking and verification process shall **not** be carried out until a specific Court order permitting to conduct the EVM C&V activity is obtained.
 - (i) For this purpose, the candidate(s) applying for EVM C&V shall approach the Court where Election Petition has been filed to obtain the required Court order permitting DEO/RO to conduct EVM C&V activity during pendency of Election Petition.
 - (ii) After obtaining the competent court order, the applicant candidate(s) shall provide a copy of the order to DEO for taking further necessary action on the application on EVM C&V.
 - (iii) The DEO shall intimate the same to the respective CEO. Subsequently, EVM C&V activity shall be taken up as mentioned below at (f) and (g).
- (d) Based on the report of the DEOs concerned, CEO shall communicate the EP status w.r.t. CEO EVM-C&V Application Summary (**Annexure-43**) submitted earlier, to the respective manufacturers under intimation to the Commission within 10 days of confirmation of EP status from the Hon'ble High Court concerned, mentioning the DEO-wise non-EP/clear Units that may be taken up for the EVM C&V process.
- (e) Based on the EP status received from the CEOs, the manufacturers, i.e. BEL/ECIL shall provide within 2 weeks:
 - (i) State/UT-wise and district-wise checking and verification schedule, duly prepared in consultation with the respective CEO, along with the details of the authorised engineers to be deputed for the aforesaid process.
 - (ii) The manufacturers shall also nominate a District in-charge engineer for the purpose of signing the certificate to be issued upon completion of the EVM C&V process.
 - (iii) The above details shall be provided to the CEOs under intimation to the Commission.
- (f) The district-wise EVM C&V schedule shall be provided by the manufacturers to the CEOs and the DEOs concerned, under intimation to the Commission, at least 10 (ten) days in advance of the schedule.
- (g) As far as possible, based on the number of applications received the PSUs shall provide a district-wise EVM C&V schedule in such a way that the EVM C&V process is started at the earliest but not later than 4 weeks from the communication about EP status received from the CEOs concerned.
- (h) CEO shall do the necessary coordination between the manufacturers and the DEOs for conducting the EVM C&V process as per the above timelines.
- (i) DEO shall intimate in writing, the schedule and venue fixed for EVM C&V process, with acknowledgement to all eligible candidates, including the candidate(s), who have made the application, at least 5 days in advance and invite them for witnessing the EVM C&V process. Necessary acknowledgement of the same shall be kept.
- (j) The applicant candidate(s) shall be permitted to nominate one representative for each C&V station.

11.5 Arrangements at checking & verification premises ('EVM C&V Hall'):

- (a) EVM C&V Hall shall be earmarked properly. It shall be spacious, well lit, well ventilated and dust free, with proper security i.e. fully barricaded and sanitised by police. Necessary boards/banners shall be put up outside the Hall.
- (b) The requirement of C&V station/tables shall be assessed in advance in consultation with the manufacturer and arrangements made accordingly.

- (c) DEO/ EVM C&V Supervising Officer shall issue entry pass to the persons authorised to enter the hall. Entry to the Hall shall be permitted only on production of entry pass thus issued.
- (d) The checking and verification activity shall be conducted from 10:00 AM to 7:00 PM, including on holidays.
- (e) Necessary strong rooms/partitioning shall be provided near the C&V Hall in the same building, to store the units that have been picked/selected for C&V activity and the units that have undergone the C&V (*C&V Strong Room 1 and C&V Strong Room 2*). The door of such rooms shall have double lock system and be under CCTV coverage and necessary security.
- (f) BEL/ECIL engineers shall be allowed to take with them the list of equipment/devices as approved for checking & verification.
- (g) Other electronic devices including cell phones, cameras, spy pens etc. shall not be allowed inside the Hall and kept at the collection centre made outside the hall.
- (h) Installation of CCTV cameras for monitoring of the activities inside the Hall. Apart from that CCTV shall also be installed for C&V tables for proper recording of all the activities conducted on the tables.
- (i) Proper arrangements like drinking water, toilets (separate for male & female), first-aid kit, fire extinguishers etc. shall be provided.
- (j) Single entry & exit to hall secured by armed police force of minimum 1 section. Maintenance of duty roster shall be done properly.
- (k) Proper frisking of every person/officer/engineer with recording in the logbook for every entry and exit shall be properly maintained.

11.6. Opening of Strong-room(s):

- (a) DEO shall intimate in writing with acknowledgement to all the candidates (not only to the eligible candidates) regarding opening/closing of strongroom, for the purpose of taking out EVMs for C&V, at least 2 days in advance.
- (b) Strong-room shall be opened/closed in the presence of candidates/their representatives present under videography as per the applicable extant protocols.
- (c) The selected units for C&V process shall be marked in EMS as 'C&V unit' through DEO login.
- (d) Where the candidate has opted to load the symbols afresh in the VVPAT, the SLU used for actual poll shall be taken out from the strong room following the due procedure.

11.7. Participation of applicant candidates/representatives:

With due intimation to all the candidates, the checking process shall be conducted in the EVM C&V Hall under the supervision of the District in-charge engineer of the manufacturers and the DEO/EVM Checking & Verification Supervising Officer concerned. At the designated time, EVM C&V process shall not be started if the applicant candidate(s)/representative(s) is/are not present. The authorities shall wait for up to one hour after the designated time of start of the EVM C&V process for the applicant concerned to be available in the C&V hall. Beyond one hour, if the applicant/representative still does not come to witness the process, the EVM C&V process shall be held without further waiting.

11.8. Completion of checking and verification process:

- (a) Upon completion of EVM C&V process, District in-charge engineer shall issue a certificate of authenticity/intactness of the burnt memory/ microcontroller of the units to the DEO in the format given in Technical SoP. A copy of the Certificate is to be provided to the applicant(s) by the DEO.
- (b) Outcome of the EVM C&V process shall be submitted by the DEO to the CEO concerned on the next day of the completion of the activity.
- (c) All the units tested shall be stored back in their respective strong room/warehouse, with due security and in compliance of the extant protocols of opening and closing of the strong rooms.
- (d) In case of any unit not passing the checking and verification, the same should be intimated to the Commission along with detailed report of the DEO and District in-charge engineer for further necessary action. Such unit(s) shall be kept separately with proper identification sticker 'C&V NOT PASSED' in grey colour pasted on the unit and the carrying case.

11.9. Mechanism for payment to Manufacturers/Refund to applicant:

- (a) CEOs shall ensure that EVM C&V fees collections (under appropriate heads as applicable) and subsequent payment/refund activities given above are carried out smoothly in a prompt manner, as far as possible within 30 days from the date of completion of EVM C&V activity.
- (b) The details of application fees collected by the DEOs of a State/UT shall be maintained with the CEO concerned. Upon completion of the EVM C&V process, the CEO shall ensure that the applicable payments for the EVM C&V activity are made to the PSUs concerned.
- (c) Further, based on the reports of the DEO, in case any EVM is found to be tampered or modified, the corresponding charges collected will be refunded to the applicant concerned and in such case expenditure will be borne by the Central Government or State Government depending on elections.

11.10. Overall important timelines:

The summary of important timelines, with a sample reference date of declaration of results, is as under:

S. No.	Event / Action / Activity	To be carried out by, as applicable	Sample Dates / Period
1.	Declaration of results. First date for making EVM C&V application	-	January 1
2.	Last date for making EVM C&V application	Eligible candidates	January 7
3.	Communication regarding filing of EVM C&V applications to ECI through CEO	DEO	Daily basis
4.	Date for the DEO to communicate consolidated details of applications to ECI through CEO	DEO	January 7
5.	Last date for CEO to send the consolidated list to BEL/ECIL, under intimation to the Commission	CEO	January 15
6.	Confirmation on the status of filing of EPs to be obtained from the Hon'ble High Court concerned	CEO	Completion of EP period
7.	Communicate to the manufacturers the non-EP AC/AS-wise details of units, to be taken up for EVM C&V process, under intimation to ECI.	CEO	Within 10 days of confirmation of EP status

8.	Provide district-wise EVM C&V schedule, in such a way that there is a gap of at least ten days between the communication of the schedule to the State/DEO and actual conduct of the C&V process.	Manufacturers	Within 2 weeks of receipt of EP status from the CEOs
9.	Intimation of the EVM C&V schedule and venue to the applicant and all candidates	DEO	At least 5 days prior to the start of the C&V process
10.	Start of the EVM C&V process	Manufacturers and DEOs	At the earliest but not later than 4 weeks from the communication of EP status from the CEOs
11.	Summary of the C&V process to be submitted to the respective CEO	DEO	The next day of the completion of the C&V process
12.	Payment/refund activities	CEO	Within 30 days of the completion of the C&V process

11.11. Retention of records of EVM C&V activity:

- (a) All records including applications, daily reports/forms/formats, registers, CCTV recording, mock VVPAT slips etc. shall be kept under the custody of the District Election Officer concerned for a period of 3 months from the date of completion of EVM C&V activity.
- (b) These records shall not to be construed as election papers under the provisions of Section 93 & 94 of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961.

Technical SoP for Checking and Verification of burnt memory/ micro-controller of EVM units

11.12. Infrastructure requirement and arrangements for Checking and Verification of EVM units [BU(s), CU and VVPAT]:

11.12.1. The following arrangements shall be made for checking and verification of burnt memory/ micro-controller:

- (a) Infrastructure Requirement (to be arranged by DEO in consultation with the BEL/ECIL):
 - (i) Checking and Verification rooms/halls of adequate sizes for accommodating tables required for conducting checking and verification of EVM.
 - (ii) A demarcated sitting area for candidates/their representatives.
 - (iii) Clear passageway for bringing the EVMs to the Checking and Verification area.
- (b) Video/CCTV setup to record the EVM C&V activities.
- (c) Test Setup requirement.
 - The following items shall be used for Checking and Verification of BU/CU/VVPAT (to be arranged by DEO):
 - (i) EVM Power Packs- Every CU requires an EVM power pack and every 5th BU (in case of more than 4 BUs) requires an EVM power pack
 - (ii) VVPAT Power Pack – Every VVPAT requires a VVPAT power pack
 - (iii) VVPAT Paper Roll – Every VVPAT requires a VVPAT paper roll

- The following shall be used by engineers for Checking and Verification of BU/CU/VVPAT (to be arranged by manufacturers):
 - (i) Green stickers
 - (ii) Red stickers
 - (iii) Grey stickers

11.12.2. Additional arrangements shall be made for conduct of mock poll if opted for by candidate(s):

- (a) Video/CCTV setup to record mock poll: The Video camera/CCTV shall be set up for clearly capturing the key pressed by engineers/candidates/their representatives on Ballot Unit and the print of VVPAT slip during the mock poll.
- (b) Test Setup requirement.
 - The following items shall be used for mock poll (to be arranged by DEO):
 - (i) Sealing threads, address tags for sealing of CU and VVPAT
 - (ii) Container with lid for collecting and keeping VVPAT slips
 - (iii) Pigeonhole framework with required number of pigeonholes (one for each candidate, one for NOTA and one for self-test slips)
 - (iv) Rubber bands for bundling VVPAT slips
 - (v) VVPAT Counting Booth (VCB)

PART-I

(Checking and Verification of EVM units)

11.13. The detailed process of establishing through self-diagnosis and mutual authentication of EVM units that the burnt memory/ microcontroller of EVM units (BU/CU/VVPAT) are not tampered or modified is described in the following sections:

11.13.1. Self-Diagnosis and Mutual-authentication of EVM units:

The following steps will be taken by authorized engineers during ‘Checking and Verification of EVM’ units:

- (i) Verify unique serial number of units brought in for Checking and Verification to ensure that the EVM units are the ones that are selected by the candidates/their representatives.
- (ii) Insert new power packs in CU and VVPAT and in BU(s) if there are more than four BUs in the configuration.
- (iii) Insert new paper roll in VVPAT.
- (iv) Connect the selected units of BU(s), CU and VVPAT for each selected polling station and form an EVM set. The same number of BU(s) will be connected as were used in the actual poll.
- (v) Such sets shall be subjected to Diagnostic Checking as given below.
 - (a) **Self-Diagnosis:** The CU shall be switched ON. This will power on BU(s) and VVPAT as well and all units will start performing their power-on self-diagnostic test (POST).

- (b) **Mutual authentication:** After POST completes, the CU communicates with connected units and discovers how many BU(s) and VVPAT are connected to it. After discovery, mutual authentication of EVM units takes place. Upon successful mutual authentication the CU displays self-diagnostic messages to convey whether the BU, CU and VVPAT are working properly or not.
- (vi) If the EVM set passes the diagnostic tests, CU will display “EVM IS READY”. Only the units which pass the diagnostic tests can be checked and verified through further testing. Such units shall be labelled as ‘DIAGNOSTIC TESTS PASSED’ with GREEN STICKER.
- (vii) If BU/VVPAT is not discovered by CU or the EVM set does not pass the self-diagnostic tests of BU/CU/VVPAT (due to not switching ON or showing other error messages etc.) then the units are not field verifiable. Such units shall be labelled with Red Sticker as “Non-functional during Diagnostic check” and shall be handed over to the DEO for sending to manufacturers for repair in due course of time as per standard protocol.
- (viii) The candidate/their representative shall be permitted by DEO to select other corresponding unit(s) or the whole set of EVM as the case may be, from the same AC/AS to replace the non-functional unit(s).
- (ix) After diagnostic check, the engineers shall switch off the CU and disconnect the units.
- (x) The engineers shall remove the seals and tags in all the diagnostic passed units and remove the paper slips, if any, from VVPAT and handed these over to DEO.

11.13.2. Report/Certificate of C&V:

- (i) Engineers shall submit a Report in **Annexure-44** at the end of every day of Checking and Verification activity to the DEO.
- (ii) Based on the outcome of self-diagnosis and mutual authentication, the authorized engineer(s) shall issue a certificate in **Annexure-45**.

PART-II

11.14. Mock Poll on EVM units

11.14.1. Provision for Mock poll:

In case any candidate/ authorised representative has made a request to conduct a mock poll on the EVM units, authorized BEL/ECIL Engineers, as the case may be, will conduct a mock poll for the EVM Units which passed self-diagnosis and mutual authentication tests (EVM units with GREEN stickers).

11.14.2. General instructions for Mock poll:

- (a) Configuration for Mock Poll: A Set of EVM consists of Ballot Unit(s), Control Unit and VVPAT. Mock poll on EVMs shall be carried out as per the actual configuration used in the respective AC/ AS on poll day. In case, the units selected by candidates/their representatives are not part of a full EVM set, then in order to complete the EVM set, the remaining units shall be provided by DEO from the same AC/AS.
- (b) In mock poll, the applicant candidate(s)/representative(s) can cast any number of votes as desired, subject to a maximum limit of 1400 votes, in any sequence or pattern. If the applicant candidates/ representatives desire not to cast votes themselves, then the engineers of BEL/ECIL will cast the required mock votes as requested by the applicant candidate(s)/representative(s). However, if the

- applicant candidate/ representative does not inform about the number of mock votes to be cast, then the engineers of BEL/ECIL will cast 500 mock votes for mock poll.
- (c) Counting of VVPAT slips shall be done in the VVPAT Counting Booth (VCB) to avoid misplacement of mock poll VVPAT slips due to large numbers. For counting of VVPAT slips, transparent container(s), pigeon holes and rubber bands shall also be arranged by DEO.
 - (d) Mock Poll VVPAT slips shall be counted by the engineers of BEL/ECIL. However, DEO shall deploy adequate number of officials well versed in VVPAT slips counting to assist the engineers of BEL/ECIL, to ensure efficiency.

11.14.3. Steps involved in Mock Poll:

- (a) Connect selected units of BU(s), CU and VVPAT for each selected polling station and form an EVM set.
- (b) Switch ON the CU.
- (c) Display the actual Poll data present in the Control Unit to the candidates and other authorized persons present by pressing the RESULT button on CU. The data/figure, as indicated in the EVM will be noted at **Annexure-46**, which will be signed by the officers of ECI i.e. District Election Officer, the engineer(s) and the successful candidates/their authorised representative present and the applicant candidate(s)/their representatives.
- (d) Erase the actual Poll data present in the Control Unit by pressing the CLEAR button on CU.
- (e) Before the start of mock poll, a preliminary poll shall be conducted by the engineer to demonstrate that the VVPAT slip printed by the VVPAT corresponds to the vote cast on the Ballot Unit(s) by casting one vote to each candidate in the Ballot unit(s). Close the preliminary poll and tally the CU result with the VVPAT slip count to establish the fidelity of the EVM set.
- (f) After the preliminary poll, press “CLEAR” button on CU to clear preliminary poll votes.
- (g) Press the “TOTAL” button on CU before starting the actual mock poll to display that total polled votes are zero.
- (h) Seal the CU result compartment with address tag.
- (i) VVPAT slips of preliminary poll shall be kept in a marked envelope and handed over to DEO.
- (j) Also show before start of mock poll that there is no VVPAT slip in the VVPAT slip drop box.
- (k) Seal the VVPAT slip drop box with address tag.
- (l) The “BALLOT” button on Control Unit shall be pressed only by the engineers during the mock poll. Candidates/their representative may be allowed to cast mock votes, on the Ballot Unit.
- (m) During the mock poll, at every half an hour, the “TOTAL” button shall be pressed on CU by the engineer to keep a track of the total votes polled so that the exact number of votes is polled as requested.
- (n) The Mock poll for each EVM set shall be started and completed on the same day before midnight.
- (o) During the mock poll, the candidates/their representatives shall verify that the VVPAT slip printed on VVPAT corresponds to the vote cast on the Ballot Unit(s) after casting every vote. If any discrepancy is claimed by candidates/their representatives, the same should immediately be

brought to the notice of DEO. The mock poll shall be stopped and the claim of candidates/their representatives should be verified by DEO with CCTV footage/video recording.

- (p) If any error occurs in BU(s)/CU/VVPAT during the mock poll due to sporadic reasons such as connector/cable/switch intermittency, sensor issues, etc. then the candidates/their representatives shall be allowed to select the respective replacement units (BU/CU/VVPAT as applicable) for mock poll which will undergo checking from step 2 (**Self-diagnosis and mutual authentication of EVM units**) onwards. Mock poll shall be redone after replacing non-functional BU/CU/VVPAT. The non-functional EVM unit shall be labelled with Red Sticker as “MOCK POLL NON-FUNCTIONAL”.
- (q) **Counting of mock poll VVPAT slips and Tallying with CU Result by engineers**
 - (i) After completion of mock voting, press “CLOSE” button on CU.
 - (ii) Thereafter, press “RESULT” button on CU to obtain candidate wise mock poll votes.
 - (iii) Count VVPAT slips in the VVPAT Counting Booth (VCB) as per the existing procedure prescribed by Election Commission of India.
 - (iv) Tally the mock poll result of CU with the VVPAT slip count.
 - (v) After tallying, the mock poll VVPAT slips shall be kept in a marked envelope and handed over to DEO.

11.14.4. Report/Certificate for Mock Poll:

Upon completion of the mock poll of an EVM set, engineers shall submit a Report in **Annexure-47** to the DEO.

PART-III			
LEGAL PERSPECTIVE OF EVMs ALONGWITH PRECAUTIONS, DOCUMENTATION AND RESPONSIBILITIES			
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CHAPTER-12

ROLE OF DIFFERENT FUNCTIONARIES

FLOW CHART: Use of EVMs in Election

District Election Officer

(Testing, Checking & Allocation of EVMs Assembly Constituency/Segment-wise, Training & Awareness)

- Custodian of EVMs
- First Level Checking (FLC) of EVMs done at DEO level by the manufacturers in presence of the representatives of recognized political parties.
- Training and Awareness of EVMs
- First Randomization of EVMs done after FLC using EMS to allocate Assembly Constituency/ Segment wise in presence of the representatives of recognized political parties.

Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer

(Commissioning of EVMs & Allocation Polling Station-wise)

- Store first randomized EVMs in Strong Room.
- Second Randomization of EVMs done after finalization of list of contesting candidates using EMS in presence of candidates/their representatives and the General Observer.
- Commissioning of EVMs in presence of candidates/their representatives and the General Observer.
- Handing over SLU(s) to the DEO concerned after completion of commissioning of EVMs.
- On day of dispersal of polling parties, strong rooms are opened and EVMs with election materials handed over to polling parties in the presence of candidates/their representatives and the General Observer.

Polling Parties

(Conduct of Poll)

- After receiving EVMs and other polling materials, polling parties move to their designated polling stations under security.
- Before actual poll, Mock poll is conducted by Presiding Officer in the polling stations in the presence of the polling agents appointed by the candidates.
- After mock poll, data of mock poll is cleared and result section of EVM and drop box of VVPAT are sealed with paper and thread seals.
- After completion of poll, Close button of EVM (CU) is pressed. Thereafter, the Total button of CU is pressed and the total number of votes polled is recorded in the Part-I of Form 17C, and copy of the same is handed over to polling agents of candidates present at the polling station at close of poll. BU, CU and VVPAT are sealed in their respective carrying case.
- Polled EVMs are escorted back to strong room and polling agents are allowed to follow vehicle having polled EVMs.
- Polled EVMs are stored under 24x7 CCTV and Armed security at RO/ARO level.

Returning Officer/Assistant Returning Officer

(Counting of Votes)

- On counting day, strong rooms are opened in the presence of candidates/their agents and ECI Observer.
- Counting of votes is done in the presence of candidates/their agents/counting agents.
- After counting of votes, Control Units of EVMs are sealed and BUs and CUs are stored in strong room.
- VVPAT slips are taken out and kept in sealed black envelopes and preserved as per Rule 94 of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961.

District Election Officer

(Retention of polled data in EVM & checking and verification of EVM)

- Receipt of application for checking and verification of EVM.
- Period of filing Election Petition (EP) is 45-days from the date of declaration of result.
- Data retention period for EVMs involved in EP is till the final disposal of EP including Appeal, if any.
- DEO can clear polled data from EVM where no EP is filed, after verifying the position from High Court after period of filing EP is over.
- Conduct of checking and verification of EVM, if any.
- Returning of SLU(s) to the manufacturer concerned.
- DEO can clear polled data from EVMs involved in any EP (where EVM is not in question), only after obtaining permission from the High Court concerned.

SoP for EVM NODAL OFFICER

EVM Nodal Officer will be In-charge and responsible for all matters related to EVM. He/she works under the CEO of the State and co-ordinate with ECI, manufacturers of EVMs (M/s Bharat Electronics Limited and M/s Electronics Corporation of India Limited) and manufacturers of various consumables related to EVMs (BEL and ECIL for EVM related various consumables like Power Packs for EVMs, Paper Rolls for VVPATs and India Security Press for Common Address Tags, Pink Paper Seals, Green Paper Seals) and local vendors for Special Tags etc.

(From C+45 days to First Level Checking)

S. No.	Particulars	Time Line
1	Ascertaining the position of Election Petition for High Court concerned (Written as well as personally)	Next day of completion of Election Petition period (i.e. C+45 days.
a)	Confirm whether Election Petition(s) is related to EVM and Counting of Votes or not.	Within 7 days of getting confirmation of EP status
b)	Marking of Election Petition status in EVM Management System (EMS) with relevant documents.	On the same day of getting confirmation of EP status.
c)	If EVM is NOT the subject matter of Election Petition(s), ensure filing an application before the High Court concerned for releasing the EVMs for further use.	Within 10 days of getting confirmation of EP status
d)	Whenever, EVMs are released from EP, the EVMs should be marked in EMS as “Available for use”.	On the same day of getting confirmation from the Court.

2	Sending of non-functional EVMs pertaining to commissioning, dispersal, poll and counting etc., which are not involved in any Election Petition/ Court cases, to manufacturer concerned (BEL/ECIL).	Within 10 days of getting confirmation of EP status/ Court clearance status
3	Regularly check Physical Aspects of the EVM Warehouse to ensure compliance of ECI Instructions including Security & Safety arrangements	
a)	Monthly Inspection Report	15 th day of every month (except April, July, October and January)
b)	Quarterly Inspection Report (Inspection to be carried out during March, June, September and December)	15 th day of April, July, October and January
4	Monitoring of movement of EVMs related to your State or EVM vehicle passing through your State. a) Factory to State b) State to Factory c) Inter-state movement d) Intra-state movement	Daily basis (Instant issue of instruction to different Offices in the State to co-operate in safe, secure and error-free transportation)
5	First Level Checking (FLC) of EVMs	
a)	Ensure required quantity of EVMs to be deployed.	At least 30 days before start of FLC
b)	Ensure FLC workshop for District Election Officers and FLC Supervisor in consultation with ECI.	At least 20 days before start of FLC
c)	Fixation of FLC schedule in consultation with BEL/ECIL and intimation to ECI.	At least 20 days before start of FLC
d)	Ensure availability of required Power Packs for EVMs and Pink Paper Seals to be used during FLC and also to send procurement orders of all consumables related to EVMs including Indelible Ink.	At least 15 days before start of FLC
e)	Randomization of FLC engineers and intimation to BEL/ECIL and DEOs concerned.	At least 10 days before start of FLC
f)	Intimation of FLC schedule to ECI for deputing EVM Nodal Officer(s) of other States/UTs.	At least 10 days before start of FLC
g)	Sharing of webcasting link to ECI.	One day before FLC
h)	Collection of FLC-Preparedness Certificates from DEOs concerned and intimation to ECI.	At least 2 days before start of FLC in a particular district
i)	Visit to districts to oversee FLC and FLC quality.	During FLC
j)	Monitoring of FLC process through webcasting.	On daily basis
k)	After completion of FLC in districts, obtaining FLC completion certificates from DEOs concerned and intimation to ECI.	Next day of completion of FLC
NON-ELECTION PERIOD		
<i>(From completion of First Level Checking to Announcement of Election)</i>		
1	Sending of FLC rejected EVMs to BEL/ECIL under intimation to ECI.	Within 7 days of completion of FLC
2	Ensure taking out of 10% (maximum 10% of total polling stations) for EVM training and awareness purpose with Yellow Stickers. Also ensure marking these units as “Awareness” units in EMS.	Immediate after completion of FLC

a)	Ensure storage of training and awareness EVMs in a separate designated warehouse.	Immediate after completion of FLC
b)	Ensure and monitor setting up of EVM Demonstration Centres (EDC) at DEO and RO HQs/Revenue Sub-Division Offices.	Daily basis
c)	Ensure and monitor Mobile Demonstration Van (MDV) to cover all polling stations for awareness purpose.	Daily basis
d)	Submission of progress report to ECI.	Weekly basis
e)	Comprehensive plan for Training and Awareness Program for EVM.	Within 5 days of completion of FLC
f)	Ensure NO physical display through EDC and MDV after announcement of election by the ECI.	Announcement of election day
ELECTION PERIOD		
<i>(From Announcement of Election to Election Petition Period i.e. C+45 days)</i>		
1	First Randomization of EVMs through EMS	
a)	Ensure timely completion of First Randomization of EVMs.	Within 2-3 days of announcement of election
b)	Ensure identification of AC Strong room and mapping the same in EMS.	Well before First Randomization
c)	Ensure compliance of ECI SoP on storage and security. Obtain Strong Room Safety Certificate from DEO and SP.	Within 2-3 days of announcement of election
d)	Co-ordination with ECI-EMS Team for technical support.	Need base
2	Second Randomization of EVMs through EMS	
a)	Ensure timely completion of 2 nd randomization	Within 2 days of finalization of list of contesting candidates and before commissioning.
b)	Ensure updation of polling stations before 2 nd Randomization.	Within 2 days of finalization of list of contesting candidates and before commissioning.
c)	Co-ordination with ECI-EMS Team for technical support.	Need base
3	Commissioning of EVMs	
a)	Ensure preparedness of commissioning of EVMs as per ECI instructions.	2 days before starting of commissioning
b)	Check issue of NOTICE by RO to candidates.	2 days before starting of commissioning
c)	Ensuring safe keeping of SLU as prescribed.	From commissioning to Election Petition period
d)	Sending report on replacement of non-functional EVMs.	Daily basis
4	Dispersal Day	
a)	Co-ordination with District EVM Nodal Officer and ensure proper dispersal of polling parties and send the dispersal report of EVMs to ECI.	Same day of dispersal day as well as on poll day
b)	Ensure movement of EVMs through GPS/Mobile app based tracking	Same day of dispersal day as well as on poll day
5	Poll Day	
a)	Closely monitor the mock poll and ensure mock poll replacement report to be sent to ECI timely.	Poll day by 9.00 AM

b)	Closely monitor the Actual Poll replacements and reports to be sent to ECI timely.	(11.00 AM, 1.00 PM, 3 PM and 5 PM)
c)	Set up Rapid Response Teams towards media reporting and timely respond to misinformed and baseless aspersions cast on the credibility of EVMs.	
d)	Closely monitor the End of Poll and send the required reports in the prescribed formats to ECI timely.	Final Report by 9.00 AM on the next day of poll
e)	Ensure updation of replacement of EVM during Mock Poll, Actual Poll in EMS.	Next day of Poll Day
f)	Ensure the Storage of Polled and Un-Polled EVMs as per ECI Instructions.	Next day of Poll Day
6	Counting Day	
a)	Ensure timely sending of Counting Reports to ECI (VVPAT slips count report).	After completion of Counting of Votes
b)	Ensure VVPAT slips are removed from all VVPATs after completion of counting of votes.	
c)	Ensure compliance of storage and security of EVMs at DEO level in EVM Strong Rooms, and metal trunk containing VVPAT slips along with statutory documents in strong room meant for keeping statutory documents.	
d)	Ensure VVPATs are not stored in the strong room with EVMs during EP Period.	
7	Post Counting Day	
a)	Monitoring of EVM checking and verification application	On daily basis
b)	Consolidate list of EVM C&V application	The next day of last date for making EVM C&V application
c)	Status of filing of Election Petitions	Completion of EP period
d)	Intimation of EVM C&V schedule	
e)	Summary of the C&V process	The next day of the completion of C&V process
Note: Above SoP is only illustrative based on important activities related to EVMs. However, EVM Nodal Officer shall go through the latest EVM Manual and instructions on EVMs issued from time to time. Non-compliance of any instructions on EVMs shall be viewed seriously by the ECI and EVM Nodal Officer shall be responsible for any lapse on his part.		
DON'TS FOR EVM NODAL OFFICER		
• Don't interact with any Media, Political Parties etc. without consent of the Chief Electoral Officer. • Don't send any field report without any observation and comment/remark/recommendation. • Don't withhold any information and incidence related to EVMs. • Don't send any request for exemption from meeting, field visit etc. without unavoidable reason. • Don't hesitate to call ECI Officer concerned for any clarification or doubt. • Don't seek any direction of the ECI on EVM matter, where there is clear cut instructions or directions of the ECI. • Don't be fully dependent on technical person on operation of EMS. • Don't forget to ensure daily shredding of VVPAT paper slips generated till P-1 day. • Don't have non-serious approach to any EVM related matter.		

CHAPTER-13

STANDARD SCHEDULE: UPCOMING/POLL GOING STATES

PROCESS	TENTATIVE TIME SCHEDULE
Allocation of EVMs by ECI (To meet the requirement, if any)	P-200
Ordering of consumable items/LOI	P-200
FLC start	P-120 (Assembly Election) P-180 (Lok Sabha Election)
FLC completion	P-50
Dispatch of FLC not ok EVMs to BEL/ECIL	FLC completion+7 days
1 st Randomization of EVMs	P-21
2 nd Randomization of EVMs	P-14
Handing over non-functional EVMs (except polled non-functional) to BEL/ECIL	C+10
Handing over polled non-functional EVMs (if no Election Petition) to BEL/ECIL	EP confirmation + 10 days

P= Poll Day (as per previous election)

C= Counting Day

Standard Schedule for bye-election

PROCESS	TENTATIVE TIME SCHEDULE
Assessment of EVMs by CEO (200% of Polling Stations)	V+1
Ordering of consumable items/LOI	V+1
FLC start	V+15
FLC completion	V+30

V= Vacancy Date

CHAPTER-14

LEGAL PROVISION FOR THE USE OF EVMs

The Electronic Voting Machines were used for the first time during the General Election to the Kerala Legislative Assembly held from Parur Assembly Constituency in May 1982 at 50 polling stations. Thereafter, these machines were used in ten other constituencies in 1982-83.

After 1983, the EVMs could not be used, as in the Election Appeal arising out of the election petition relating to the use of the machines in the election from Parur Assembly Constituency in Kerala, the Supreme Court ruled that there should be specific provision in the law providing for use of EVMs in elections.

There upon, the Election Commission of India recommended to the Government of India to amend the law suitably to provide legal sanction for the use of EVMs.

In December 1988, a new section 61A was inserted in the Representation of the People Act 1951, empowering the Election Commission of India to use Electronic Voting Machines in elections, which reads as under-

“61A. Voting machines at elections-Notwithstanding anything contained in this Act or the rules made there under, the giving and recording of votes by voting machines in such manner as may be prescribed, may be adopted in such constituency or constituencies as the Election Commission may, having regard to the circumstances of each case, specify.”

Explanation- For the purpose of this section, “voting machine” means any machine or apparatus whether operated electronically or otherwise used for giving or recording of votes and any reference to a ballot box or ballot paper in this Act or the rules made thereunder shall, save as otherwise provided, be construed as including a reference to such voting machine wherever such voting machine is used at any election.

The Supreme Court upheld the validity of the above provision in All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam Vs. Chief Election Commissioner and others [2002(UJ)(1)387]

NOTE: In case of any discrepancy kindly refer Manual of Election Laws

The Representation of the People Act 1951

58. Fresh poll in the case of destruction, etc., of ballot boxes:-

- (1) If at any election,-
 - (a) any ballot box used at a polling station or at a place fixed for the poll is unlawfully taken out of the custody of the presiding officer or the returning officer, or is accidentally or intentionally destroyed or lost, or is damaged or tampered with, to such an extent, that the result of the poll at that polling station or place cannot be ascertained; or
 - (b) any voting machine develops a mechanical failure during the course of the recording of votes; or
 - (c) any such error or irregularity in procedure as is likely to vitiate the poll is committed at a polling station or at a place fixed for the poll, the returning officer shall forthwith report the matter to the ECI.
- (2) There upon the Election Commission shall, after taking all material Circumstances into account, either-
 - (a) declare the poll at that polling station or place to be void, appoint a day, and fix the hours, for taking a fresh poll at that polling station or place and notify the day so appointed and the hours so fixed in such manner as it may deem fit, or
 - (b) if satisfied that the result of a fresh poll at that polling station or place will not, in any way,

affect the result of the election or that the mechanical failure of the voting machine or the error or irregularity in procedure is not material, issue such direction to the returning officer as it may deem proper for the further conduct and completion of the election.

The provisions of this Act and of any rules or orders made there under shall apply to every such fresh poll as they apply to the original poll.

135A. Offence of booth capturing:-

- (1) Whoever commits an offence of booth capturing shall be punishable with imprisonment for a term which [shall not be less than one year but which may extend to three years and with fine, and where such offence is committed by a person in the service of the Government, he shall be punishable with imprisonment for a term which shall be less than three years but which may extend to five years and with fine].

Explanation- For the purpose of [this sub-section and section 20B], “booth capturing” includes, among other things, all or any of the following activities, namely:-

- (a) seizure of a polling station or a place fixed for the poll by any person or persons, making polling authorities surrender the ballot papers or voting machines and doing of any other act which affects the orderly conduct of elections;
 - (b) taking possession of a polling station or a place fixed for the poll by any person or persons and allowing only his or their own supporters to exercise their right to vote and [prevent others from free exercise for their right to vote];
 - (c) [coercing or intimidating or threatening directly or indirectly] any elector and preventing him from going to the polling station or a place fixed for the poll to cast his vote;
 - (d) seizure of a place for counting of votes by any person or persons, making the counting authorities surrender the ballot papers or voting machines and the doing of anything which affects the orderly counting of votes;
 - (e) doing by any person in the service of Government, of all or any of the aforesaid activities or aiding or conniving at, any such activity in the furtherance of the prospects of the election of a candidate].
- (2) An offence punishable under sub-section (1) shall be cognizable.

169. Power to make rule-

- (1) The Central Government may, after consulting the Election Commission, by notification in the Official Gazette, make rules for carrying out the purposes of this Act.
- (2) In particular, and without prejudice to the generality of the foregoing power, such rules may provide for all or any of the following matters, namely-
- [(a) the form of affidavit under sub-section (2) of section 33A;
 - [(aa)] the duties of presiding officers and polling officers at polling stations;
 - [(aaa)] the form of contribution report;]
 - (b) the checking of voters by reference to the electoral roll;
 - [(bb) the manner of allocation of equitable sharing of time on the cable television network and other electronic media;];
 - (c) the manner in which voters are to be given both generally and in the case of illiterate voters or voters under physical or other disability;

- (d) the manner in which votes are to be given by a presiding officer, polling officer, polling agent or any other person, who being an elector for a constituency is authorized or appointed for duty at a polling station at which he is not entitled to vote;
 - (e) the procedure to be followed in respect of the tender of vote by a person representing himself to be an elector after another person has voted as such elector;
 - [(ee) the manner of giving and recording of votes by means of voting machines and the procedure as to voting to be followed at polling stations where such machines are used;]
 - (f) the procedure as to voting to be followed at elections held in accordance with the system of proportional representation by means of the single transferable vote;
 - (g) the scrutiny and counting of votes including cases in which a recount of the votes may be made before the declaration of the result of the election;
 - [(gg) the procedure as to counting of votes recorded by means of voting machine;]
 - (h) the safe custody of [ballot boxes, voting machines], ballot papers and other election papers, the period which such papers shall be preserved and the inspection and production of such papers;
 - [(hh) the material to be supplied by the Government to the candidates of recognized political parties at any election to be held for the purpose of constituting the House of the People or the Legislative Assembly of a State;]
 - (i) any other matter required to be prescribed by this Act.
- (3) Every rule made under this Act shall be laid as soon as may be after it is made before each House of Parliament while it is in session for a total period of thirty days which may be comprised in one session or [in two or more successive sessions, and if, before the expiry of the session immediately following the session or the successive sessions aforesaid, both Houses agree in making any modification in the rule or both Houses agree that the rule should not be made.] the rule shall thereafter have effect only in such modified form or be of no effect, as the case may be, so however, that any such modification or annulment shall be without prejudice to the validity of anything previously done under that rule.].

Conduct of Elections Rules 1961 (Statutory Rules and Order) with Conduct of Elections (Amendment) Rules 2013

49A. Design of Electronic Voting Machines-

Every electronic voting machine [hereinafter referred to as the voting machine) shall have a control unit and a balloting unit and shall be of such design as may be approved by the Election Commission.

Provided that a printer with a drop box of such design as may be approved by the Election Commission may also be attached to a voting machine for printing a paper trail of the vote, in such constituency or constituencies or parts thereof as the Election Commission may direct.

49B. Preparation of voting machine by the returning officer:-

- (1) The balloting unit of the voting machine shall contain such particular and in such language or languages as the Election Commission may specify.
- (2) The names of the candidates shall be arranged on the balloting unit in the same order in which they appear in the list of the contesting candidates.
- (3) If two or more candidates bear the same name, they shall be distinguished by the addition of their occupation or residence or in some other manner.

- (4) Subject to the foregoing provisions of this rule, the returning officer shall-
- (a) fix the label containing the names and symbol of the contesting candidates in the balloting unit and secure that unit with his seal and the seals of such of the contesting candidates or their election agents present as are desirous of affixing the same;
 - (b) set the number of contesting candidates and close the candidate set section in the control unit and secure it with his seal and the seals of such of the contesting candidates or their election agents present as are desirous of affixing the same;
 - (c) **where the printer for paper trail is used under the provision to rule 49A, set the printer as per the number of contesting candidates set in the control unit by-**
 - (i) loading in the printer the serial number and names of candidates and symbols allotted to them as given on the balloting units under clause(a);
 - (ii) loading paper in the printer; and
 - (iii) sealing the printer in such manner as may be directed by the Election Commission.

49C. Arrangements at the polling stations-

- (1) Outside each polling station there shall be displayed prominently-
 - (a) a notice specifying the polling area, the electors of which are entitled to vote at the polling station and, when the polling area has more than one polling station, the particulars of the electors so entitled; and
 - (b) a copy of the list of contesting candidates.
- (2) At each polling station there shall be set up one or more voting compartment in which the electors can record their votes free from observation.
- (3) the returning officer shall provide at each polling station one voting machine and copies of relevant part of the electoral roll and such other election material as may be necessary for taking the poll.
- (4) Without prejudice to the provisions of sub-rule (3), the returning officer may, with the previous approval of the Election Commission, provide one common voting machine for two or more polling stations located in the same premises.

49E. Preparation of voting machines for poll-

- (1) The control unit and balloting unit of every voting machine used at polling station **and the printer for paper trail where used**, shall bear a label marked with-
 - (a) the serial number, if any, and the name of the constituency;
 - (b) the serial number and name of polling station or stations as the case may be;
 - (c) the serial number of the unit; and
 - (d) the date of poll.
- (2) Immediately before the commencement of the poll, the presiding officer shall demonstrate to the polling agents and other persons present that no vote has been already recorded in the voting machine and it bears the label referred to in sub-rule (1) and **where the printer for paper trail is used that the drop box of the printer is empty**.
- (3) A paper seal be used for securing the control unit of the voting machine, and the presiding officer

shall affix his own signature on the paper seal and obtain thereon the signature of such of the polling agents present as the desirous of affixing the same.

- (4) The presiding officer shall thereafter fix the paper seal so signed in the space meant therefore in the control unit of the voting machine and shall secure and seal the same.
- (5) The seal used for securing the control unit shall be fixed in such manner that after the unit has been sealed, it is not possible to press the “result button” without breaking the seal.
- (6) The control unit shall be closed and secured and placed in full view of the presiding officer and the polling agents and the balloting unit placed in the voting compartment.
- (7) Where the printer for paper trail is used, the printer shall also be kept along with the balloting unit in the voting compartment and shall be connected to the EVM in the manner as directed by the Election Commission.

49L. Procedure for voting by voting machines-

- (1) Before permitting an elector to vote, the polling officer shall-
 - (a) record the electoral roll number of the elector as entered in the marked copy of the electoral roll in a register of voters in Form 17A.
 - (b) obtain the signature or the thumb impression of the elector on the said register of voters; and
 - (c) mark the name of elector in the marked copy of the electoral roll to indicate that he has been allowed to vote;
 - (d) give details of the document produced by the elector in proof of his/her identification.

Provided that no elector shall be allowed to vote unless he has his signature or thumb impression on the register of voters.

- (2) Notwithstanding anything contained in sub-rule (2) of rule 2, it shall be necessary for any presiding officer or polling officer or any other officer to attest the thumb impression of the elector on the register of voters.

49M. Maintenance of secrecy of voting by electors within the polling stations and voting procedures.

- (1) Every elector who has been permitted to vote under rule 49L shall maintain secrecy of voting within the polling station and for the purpose observe the voting procedure hereinafter laid down.
- (2) Immediately on being permitted to vote the elector shall proceed to the presiding officer or the polling officer in-charge of the control unit of the voting machine who shall, by pressing the appropriate button on the control unit, activate the balloting unit, for recording of elector's vote.
- (3) The elector shall thereafter forthwith
 - (a) proceed to the voting compartment.
 - (b) record his vote by pressing button on the balloting unit against the name and symbol of the candidate for whom he intends to vote; and
 - (c) come out the voting compartment and leave the polling station.

Provided that where printer for paper trail is used, upon casting the vote by pressing the button under clause (b), the elector shall be able to view through the transparent window of the printer, kept along the balloting unit inside the voting compartment, the printed paper slip showing the serial no., name and the symbol of the candidate for whom he has cast his vote before such paper slip gets cut and drops in the drop box of the printer.

- (4) Every elector shall vote without undue delay.
- (5) No elector shall be allowed to enter the voting compartment when another elector is inside it.
- (6) If an elector who has been permitted to vote under rule 49L or rule 49P refuse after warning given by the presiding officer to observe the procedure laid down in sub-rule (3) of the said rules, the presiding officer or a polling officer under the direction of the presiding officer shall not allow such elector to vote.
- (7) Where an elector is not allowed to vote under sub-rule (6), a remark to the effect that voting procedure has been violated shall be made against the elector's name in the register of voters in Form 17A by the presiding officer under his signature.

49MA. Procedure in case of complaint about particulars printed on paper slips.

- (1) Where printer for paper tail is used, if an elector after having recorded his vote under rule 49M alleges that the paper slip generated by the printer has shown the name or symbol of a candidate other than the one he voted for, the presiding officer shall obtain a written declaration from the elector as to the allegation, after warning the elector about the consequence of making a false declaration.
- (2) If the elector gives the written declaration referred to in sub-rule (1), the presiding officer shall make a second entry related to that elector in Form 17A, and permit the elector to record a test vote in the voting machine in his presence and in the presence of the candidates or polling agents who may be present in the polling station, and observe the paper slip generated by the printer.
- (3) If the allegation is found true, the presiding officer shall report the facts immediately to the returning officer, stop further recording of votes in that voting machine and act as per the direction that may be given by the returning officer.
- (4) If, however, the allegation is found to be false and the paper slip so generated under sub-rule (1) matches with the test vote recorded by the elector under sub-rule (2), then the presiding officer shall-
 - (i) Make a remark to that effect against the second entry relating to that elector in Form 17A mentioning the serial number and name of the candidate for whom such test vote has been recorded;
 - (ii) obtain the signature or thumb impression of that elector against such remarks; and
 - (iii) make necessary entries regarding such test vote in item 5 in Part-I of Form 17C.

49N. Recording of votes of blind or infirm electors-

- (1) If the presiding officer is satisfied that owing to blindness or other physical infirmities an elector is unable to recognize the symbol on the balloting unit of the voting machine or unable to record his vote by pressing the appropriate button there on without assistance the presiding officer shall permit the elector to take with him a companion of not less than eighteen years of age to the voting compartment for recording the vote on his behalf and in accordance with his wishes.

Provided that no person shall be permitted to act as the companion of more than one elector at any polling station on the same day;

Provided further that before any person is permitted to act as the companion of an elector on any day under this rule that person shall be required to declare that he will keep secret the vote recorded by him on behalf of the elector and that he has not already acted as the companion of any other elector at any other polling station on that day.

- (2) The presiding officer shall keep a record in Form 14A of all cases under this rule.

49Q. Presiding Officer's entry in the voting compartment during poll-

- (1) The presiding officer may whenever he considers it necessary to do so, enter the voting compartment during poll and take such steps as may be necessary to ensure that the balloting unit is not tampered or interfered with any way.
- (2) If the presiding officer has reason to suspect that an elector who has entered the voting compartment is tampering or otherwise interfering with the balloting unit or has remained inside the voting compartment for unduly long period, he shall enter the voting compartment and take such steps as may be necessary to ensure the smooth and orderly progress of the poll.
- (3) Whenever the presiding officer enters the voting compartment under this rule, he shall permits the polling agents present to accompany him if they so desire.

49R. Closing of Poll-

- (1) The presiding officer shall close a polling station at the hour fixed in that behalf under section 56 and shall not thereafter admit any elector into the polling station;

Provided that all electors present at the polling station before it is closed shall be allowed to cast their votes.
- (2) If any question arises whether an elector was present at the polling station before it was closed it shall be decided by the presiding officer and his decision shall be final.

49S. Account of votes recorded-

- (1) The presiding officer shall at the close of the poll prepare an account of votes recorded in Form 17C and enclose it in a separate cover with the words 'Account of Votes Recorded' superscribed thereon.
- (2) The presiding officer shall furnish to every polling agent present at the close of the poll a true copy of the entries made in Form 17C after obtaining a receipt from the said polling agent therefore and shall attest it as a true copy.

49T. Sealing of voting machine after poll-

- (1) As soon as practicable after the closing of the poll, the presiding officer shall close the control unit to ensure that no further votes can be recorded and shall detach the balloting unit from the control unit **and from the printer, where printer is also used, so that the paper slips contained in the drop box of the printer shall remain intact.**
- (2) The control unit and the balloting unit **and the printer, where it is used**, shall thereafter be sealed, and secured separately in such manner as the Election Commission may direct and the seal used for securing them shall be so affixed that it will not be possible to open the units without breaking the seals.
- (3) The polling agents present at the polling station, who desire to affix their seals, shall also be permitted to do so.

49U. Sealing of other packets-

- (1) The presiding officer shall then make into separate packet
 - (a) the marked copy of the electoral roll;
 - (b) the register of voters in From 17A;

- (c) the cover containing the tendered ballot papers and the list in Form 17B;
 - (d) the list of challenged votes; and
 - (e) any other papers directed by the Election Commission to be kept in a sealed packet.
- (2) Each packet shall be sealed with the seal of the presiding officer and with the seal either of the candidate or his election agent or of his polling agent who may be present at the polling station and may desire to affix his seal thereon.

49V. Transmission of voting machines, etc., to the returning officer-

- (1) The presiding officer shall then deliver or cause to be delivered to the returning officer at such place the returning officer may direct-
- (a) the voting machine;
 - (b) the account of votes recorded in Form 17C;
 - (c) the sealed packets referred to in rule 49U; and
 - (d) all other papers used at the poll.
- (2) The returning officer shall make adequate arrangements for the safe transport of the voting machine, packets and other papers for their safe custody until the commencement of the counting of votes.

49W. Procedure on adjournment of poll-

- (1) If the poll at any polling station is adjourned under sub-section (1) of section 57, the provision of rules 49S to 49V shall, as far as practicable, apply as if the poll was closed at the hour fixed in that behalf under section 56.
- (2) When an adjourned poll is recommended under sub-section (2) of section 57, the electors who have already voted at the poll so adjourned shall not be allowed to vote again.
- (3) The returning officer shall provide the presiding officer of the polling station at which such adjourned poll is held, with the sealed packet containing the marked copy of the electoral roll, register of voters in Form 17A and a new voting machine.
- (4) The presiding officer shall open the sealed packet in the presence of the polling agents present and use the marked copy of the electoral roll for marking the names of the electors who are allowed to vote at the adjourned poll.
- (5) The provision of rule 28 and rule 49A to 49V shall apply in relation to the conduct of an adjourned poll before it was so adjourned.

49X. Closing of voting machine in case of booth capturing-

Where the presiding officer is of opinion that booth capturing is taking place at a polling station or at a place fixed for the poll, he shall immediately close the control unit of the voting machine to ensure that no further votes can be recorded and shall detach the balloting unit from the control unit.

66A. Counting of votes where electronic voting machines have been used-

In relation to the counting of votes at a polling station, where voting machine has been used the provisions of rules 50 to 54 and in lieu of rules 55, 56 and 57, the following rules shall respectively apply, namely:-

55C. Scrutiny and inspection of voting machines-

- (1) The returning officer may have the control units of the voting machines used at more than one polling station taken up for scrutiny and inspection and votes recorded in such units counted simultaneously.
- (2) Before the votes recorded in any control unit of voting machine are counted under sub-rule (1), the candidate or his election agent or his counting agents present at the counting table shall be allowed to inspect the paper seal and such other vital seals as might have been affixed on the unit and to satisfy themselves that the seals are intact.
- (3) The returning officer shall satisfy himself that none of the voting machines has in fact been tampered with.
- (4) If the returning officer is satisfied that any voting machine has in fact been tampered with, he shall not count the votes recorded in that machine and shall follow the procedure laid down in section 58, or section 58A or section 64A, as may be applicable in respect of the polling station or stations where that machine was used.

56C. Counting of votes-

- (1) After the returning officer is satisfied that a voting machine has in fact not been tampered with, he shall have the votes recorded therein counted by pressing the appropriate button marked "Result" provided in the control unit whereby the total votes polled and votes polled by each candidate shall be displayed in respect of each such candidate on the display panel provided for the purpose in the unit.
- (2) As the votes polled by each candidate are displayed on the control unit, the returning officer shall have-
 - (a) the number of such votes recorded separately in respect of each candidate in Part-II on Form 17C;

Provided that the test vote recorded, if any, for a candidate, as per item 5 in Part I of Form 17C, shall be subtracted from the number of votes recorded for such candidate as displayed on the control unit.

- (b) Part II of Form 17C completed in other respect and signed by the counting supervisor and also by the candidates or their election agents or their counting agents present; and
- (c) corresponding entries made in a result sheet in Form 20 and the particulars so entered in the result sheet announced.

56D. Scrutiny of paper trail-

- (1) Where printer for paper trail is used, after the entries in the result sheet are announced, any candidate, or in his absence, his election agent or any of his counting agents may apply in writing to the returning officer to count the printed paper slips in the drop box of the printer in respect of any polling station or polling stations.
- (2) On such application being made, the returning officer shall, subject to such general or special guidelines, as may be issued by the Election Commission, decide the matter and may allow the application in whole or in part or may reject in whole, if it appears to him to be frivolous or unreasonable.
- (3) Every decision of the returning officer under sub-rule (2) shall be in writing and shall contain the reason thereof.

- (4) If the returning officer decides under sub-rule (2) to allow counting of the paper slips either wholly or in part or parts, he shall-
 - (a) do the counting in the manner as may be directed by the Election Commission;
 - (b) if there is any discrepancy between the votes displayed on the control unit and the counting of the paper slips, amend the result sheet in Form 20 as per the paper slips count;
 - (c) announce the amendment so made by him; and
 - (d) complete and sign the result sheet.

57C. Sealing of voting machines-

- (1) After the result of voting recorded in a control unit has been ascertained candidate wise and entered in Part II of Form 17C and Form 20 under rule 56C, the returning officer shall reseal the unit with his seal and the seals of such of the candidates or their election agents present who may desire to affix the seals thereon so however that the result of voting recorded in the unit is not obliterated and the unit retains the memory of such result **and where printer for paper trail is used, the returning officer shall seal the paper slips in such manner, as may directed by the Election Commission.**
- (2) The control unit **and the paper slips** so sealed shall be kept in specially prepared boxes on which the returning officer shall record the following particulars, namely-
 - (a) the name of constituency;
 - (b) the particular of polling station or stations where the control unit has been used;
 - (c) serial number of the control unit **and printer wherever used;**
 - (d) date of poll; and
 - (e) date of counting.
- (ii) the provisions of rules 60 to 66 shall, so far as may be, apply in relation to voting by voting machines and any reference in those rules to-
 - (a) ballot paper shall be construed as including a reference to such voting machine;
 - (b) any rule shall be construed as a reference to the corresponding rule in Chapter II of Part IV or, as the case may be, to rule 55C or 56C or 57C.

92. Custody of ballot boxes and papers relating to election-

- (1A) All voting machines used at an election shall be kept in the custody of the concerned district election officer.
- (2) The district election officer shall keep in safe custody.
- (cc) **the printed paper slips sealed under the provisions of rule 57C.**
- (dd) **The packets containing registers of voters in Form 17A.**

93. Production and inspection of election papers-

- (1) While in the custody of the district election officer or, as the case may be, the returning officer-
 - (a) the packets of unused ballot papers with counterfoils attached thereto;
 - (b) the packets of used ballot papers whether valid, tendered or rejected;

- (c) the packets of the counterfoils of used ballot papers;
 - (cc) the printed paper slips sealed under the provisions of rule 57C;**
 - (d) the packets of the marked copy of the electoral roll or, as the case may be, the list maintained under sub-section (1) or sub-section (2) of section 152; and
 - (dd) the packets containing registers of voters in Form-17A;
 - (e) the packets of the declaration by electors and the attestation of their signatures;
- shall not be opened and their contents shall not be inspected by, or produced before, any person or authority except under the order of a competent court.

[(1A)The control units sealed under the provisions of rule 57C and kept in the custody of the district election officer shall not be opened and shall not be inspected by, or produced before, any person or authority except under the orders of a competent court.]

- (2) Subject to such conditions and to the payment of such fee as the Election Commission may direct-
 - (a) all other papers relating to the election shall be open to public inspection; and
 - (b) copies thereof shall on application be furnished.
- (3) copies of the returns by the returning officer forwarded under rule 64, or as the case may be under clause (b) of sub-rule (1) of rule 84 shall be furnished by the returning officer, district election officer, chief electoral officer or the Election Commission on payment of a fee of two rupees for each copy.

94. Disposal of election papers-

Subject to any direction to the contrary given by the Election Commission or by a competent court or tribunal-

- (a) the packets of unused ballot papers shall be retained for a period of six months and shall thereafter be destroyed in such manner as the Election Commission may direct.
- (aa) the voting machine kept in the custody of the district election officer under sub-rule (1A) of rule 92 shall be retained intact for such period as the Election Commission may direct and shall not be used at any subsequent election without the previous approval of the Election Commission.
- (b) the other packets referred to in sub-rule(1) of rule 93 shall be retained for a period of one year and shall thereafter be destroyed.

Provided that packets containing the counterfoils of used ballot papers and the printed paper slips, if any, shall not be destroyed except with the previous approval of the Election Commission.

- (c) all other papers relating to the election shall be retained for such period as the Election Commission may direct.

95. Power of the Election Commission to issue direction-

Subject to the other provisions of these rules, the Election Commission may issue such direction as it may consider necessary to facilitate the proper use and operation of the voting machines.

[For provision regarding use of VVPAT system please refer to the Conduct of Elections (Amendment) Rules 2013]

CHAPTER-15

EVM MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (EMS)

EVM Management System (EMS) 2.0 is a Cloud native application developed for managing inventory of EVMs owned by the Election Commission of India (ECI). The system offers transparency by recording all EVMs related activities and ensures no manual intervention at any level from manufacturers to polling station.

The EMS 2.0 is designed and developed using state-of-the-art Micro Services and distributed computer architecture. The system is modular in nature, secure, highly scalable and has quick and fast response features.

This application comprises of both Web and Mobile Versions (Android and iOS based mobile application), ECI, Chief Electoral Officers, District Election Officers, Warehouse in-charges, Returning Officers, Assistant Returning Officers and Manufacturers of EVMs (Bharat Electronics Limited and Electronics Corporation of India Limited) are the stakeholders of this application.

It allows tracking inventories of Ballot Units, Control Units and VVPATs with their locations. It also allows of warehouses and election related activities viz. FLC process, Randomization.

EMS 2.0 application has following modules

- User Management
- WH & SR Management
- Order Management
- Unit Management
- Support
- EVM Consumable Management
- Other Aggregate Services
- EVM Checking and Verification

User Management

User Management module allows user creation, updating/editing user details, resetting of passwords as per the role and permission provided to the User. ECI Admin can create CEO level users; CEO can create one CEO office and DEO level users; DEO can create DEO office, warehouse in-charges and Temporary users. Updating/editing user details and resetting of passwords can be done by the ECI Admin, CEO and DEO for the users created by them.

WH & SR Management

Warehouse and Strong Room Management module allows the DEOs to create warehouses and strong room in the respective district. It also facilitate DEOs to conduct monthly and quarterly inspection of the warehouse and upload inspection reports in EMS 2.0.

Order Management

This module allows ECI to create orders for Inter-State shifting of EVMs and shifting from factories to the States/UTs. It also allows the CEOs to create inter-district shifting within State/UT and DEOs can create order for shifting EVMs within district or to the factories. Status of execution of the created order can also be monitored in EMS 2.0. While allocating orders, the system has the facility to shows the distances for the nearby warehouses.

Unit Management

This module helps in managing the life cycle of the EVMs as well as various election related activities viz. scheduling of election, randomization of EVMs and marking of units for Training and Awareness and Election Petition etc.

Support

This module is developed to provide support to the end users, if they find any difficulty in use of any of the functionalities of EMS 2.0. It has the facility for peer to peer and higher level communication.

EVM Consumable Management

This module provides a dashboard for managing the inventory of consumable items being used with the EVMs at various election related processes.

Other Aggregate Services

Under the Other Aggregate Services user has the facility of Global Search of the Unit ID with its current location and history, FLC status and status of FLC non-functional units at a Glance. A dashboard for the manufacturers is also available in this module to have a status and make wise abstract status of EVMs available at factory premises and in the States/Uts.

Reports

Various reports are made available in the EMS 2.0 for its users at the level of ECI Admin, CEO, DEO, WH Manager and Manufacturers to check the status of work allocated and to identify pending issues.

EVM Checking and Verification

This Module allows to mark EVMs as EVM for checking and verification, replacement of non-functional EVM found during EVM C&V, and uploading supporting documents etc.

EMS 2.0 Application for Android and iOS

Most of the functions available in the web-version of EMS 2.0 are also available in the mobile application of EMS 2.0. In addition, mobile application also provide facility to scan the barcode/QR codes of unit ID and Pink Paper Slips affixed to Control Units during FLC.

CHAPTER-16

CHECKLIST AND PRECAUTIONS

16.1. Examples of Critical Mistakes to be avoided

(i) First Level Checking of EVMs

- Non-updation of FLC-OK or FLC-Reject status in EMS through Mobile-App on day to day basis.
- FLC of EVMs without using Dummy Ballot Paper on BU.
- Non-Uploading of 16 candidates (including NOTA) Dummy Symbols in the 1% VVPATs which are used for testing with 4-BUs having 64 dummy symbols (including NOTA)
- Irregularity on use of Dummy Symbols.
- Non shredding of VVPAT slips on daily basis.

(ii) Commissioning of EVMs

- Non-checking of candidate symbols uploaded in VVPAT during commissioning.
- Not connecting VVPAT with CU at the time of candidate setting in CU.
- Non shredding of VVPAT slips on daily basis.

(iii) Transportation of VVPATs

- Not Locking paper roll when transporting the VVPAT from one place to another

(iv) Dispersal

- Checking of VVPAT by connecting it to CU and BU at the time of dispersal.

(v) Mock-Poll on Poll Day

- Not pressing the CLOSE button of CU after mock-poll.
- Not matching the mock-poll result of the CU with the VVPAT Paper Slips.
- Not removing the mock-poll paper slips from VVPAT
- Non-deletion of mock-poll data from the Control Unit.
- When setting up the EVMs in the polling station, the VVPAT should be positioned so as to avoid direct light from falling on it.
- Do not position the VVPAT near an open window or directly under a bulb or halogen lamp.

(vi) During Poll

- Conducting mock poll, in case of replacement of VVPAT only as Mock poll is not required to be conducted in case of only VVPAT being replaced.
- In case of non-functioning of CU or BU replacing only CU or BU. In such case both BU and CU along with VVPAT shall be replaced.
- Non-pressing of CLOSE Button after completion of Poll.
- Damaging any seal of BU/CU/VVPAT.

(vii) General

- Do not repeatedly switch ON and OFF the VVPAT as it will deplete the battery as well as paper roll.
- Switch OFF the CU when connecting or disconnecting the BU(s), CU and VVPAT and do not pull the cable for disconnecting.
- VVPAT status will be displayed on the CU Display Panel.

16.2 A Para-wise Checklist of Don'ts

1. GENERAL
Don't allow the units to be handled by any unauthorised personnel/staff
Don't move/keep/store EVM in any unauthorised place.
Don't shift any EVM without making entry in EMS.
Don't leave any EVMs without 24X7 security.
Don't damage any seal of the BU, CU & VVPAT.
Don't burn any VVPAT slip.
Don't leave VVPAT Paper Lock in vertical position during transportation.
Don't position the EVM near an open window or any direct light/high- illumination source in the polling Station.
Don't forget to put paper lock position in vertical position before switching ON the CU.
Don't move/shift the units anywhere during the period from – Commissioning to the Counting Day – except EVMs required for use in poll.
Don't switch ON CU before VVPAT paper roll knob is in unlocked condition (vertical position).
Don't remove cables without pressing the clips on the connectors.
Don't insert cables by pressing the clips on the connectors.
Don't switch OFF CU unless all 7 slips are printed and cut.
Don't connect or disconnect EVM cables when CU switch is ON.
Don't switch ON/OFF CU repeatedly.
Don't leave EVMs unattended.
2. DURING STORAGE OF EVMs
Don't open and close EVM warehouse without intimation and participation of the representatives of National and State Recognised Political Parties
Don't keep other material whether election related or not (except the documents/materials prescribed by the Commission) with EVM.
Don't forget to install fire extinguisher at FLC centre, Warehouse, Strong Room.
Don't store EVM at any place below the Tehsil Headquarters-level
Don't keep various models of EVM in same room/hall of the warehouse
Don't keep/mix EVM of other election management bodies (viz. State Election Commission etc.) with ECI EVM
Don't forget to disconnect electricity inside room/hall having EVM
Don't forget to seal all other doors/windows (except entry/exit door) using brick-masonry or concrete
Don't make EVMs warehouse in the Educational Institute.

Don't open the strong room/warehouse having EVM pertaining to Election Petition for any purpose without approval of the Court concerned
Don't forget videography of opening and closing of warehouse/strong room
Don't forget to maintain Log Book for each entry and exit.
Don't forget to maintain Duty Roster of security personnel.
3. TRANSPORTATION
Don't transport EVM without GPS/Mobile app-based tracking.
Don't transport EVM in un-containerized vehicles
Don't transport EVM without armed security
Don't transport VVPAT in unlock position of the paper roll knob (vertical position)
Don't forget to invite the representatives of National and State Recognised Political Parties while sending or receiving EVMs from warehouse/ strong room.
Don't forget to coordinate with the DEOs concerned in case of Factory to State, State to Factory, Inter-State and Intra-State transportation of EVMs.
4. FIRST LEVEL CHECKING
Don't allow to take any electronic device inside FLC Hall except those items permitted by ECI.
Don't forget to install Door Frame Metal Detector (DFMD) at FLC centre.
Don't allow any person inside the FLC hall without proper frisking.
Don't forget to dispatch the FLC rejected Units to the factory for repairs after completion of FLC.
Don't forget to mark FLC OK, FLC rejected unit in EMS on a daily basis.
Don't forget to conduct mock poll in 5% randomly selected EVMs (1200 votes in 1% EVMs, 1000 votes in 2% EVMs and 500 votes in 2% EVMs)
Don't forget to paste pink paper seal on CU
Don't use real election symbol during FLC and Training & Awareness
Don't leave VVPATs slips generated during FLC / T&A without shredding on daily basis.
Don't forget to install fire extinguisher at FLC centre, Warehouse, Strong room.
Don't forget to intimate in writing FLC schedule to National and State Recognised Political parties at District Headquarters as well as State Headquarters
Don't appoint FLC Supervisor below the rank of Deputy District Election Officer
Don't forget to submit FLC Preparedness Certificate before starting FLC
Don't allow other equipment inside the FLC hall except those mentioned in FLC SoP
Don't forget to barricade and sanitize FLC area by police.
Don't allow entry to FLC hall without production of Identity Card issued by the DEO.
Don't forget frisking of every person/officer/engineer at every entry and exit.
Don't forget install TV/Monitor display with HDMI input for each SLU under use in FLC hall.
Don't forget to paste FLC SoP in FLC Hall.
Don't allow any person/official except authorized staff and engineers of Bharat Electronics Limited and Electronics Corporation of India Limited, as the case may be, to conduct FLC
Don't keep FLC OK and FLC Reject EVM in the same strong room
Don't forget to share list of FLC OK units to National and State Recognised Political Parties after completion of FLC with proper acknowledgment

Don't pre-signed on FLC OK (Green) and FLC Reject (Red) stickers before confirming FLC OK or FLC Reject
5. TRAINING & AWARENESS
Don't forget to mark those EVM in EMS as 'Training/Awareness'
Don't forget to paste a yellow colour sticker mentioning Training /Awareness on T&A EVMs.
Don't take out T&A EVMs more than 10% of total number of PS in the district.
Don't use units without FLC OK sticker for T&A.
Don't use real election symbol during training, Awareness, FLC of EVMs.
Don't forget to share list of EVM and VVPAT taken out for T&A to National and State Recognised Political Parties after completion of FLC with proper acknowledgment
Don't keep T&A units in FLC Strong Room or vicinity of FLC OK Strong Room. Keep them in separate designated warehouse/nearby training areas.
Don't forget to share the information of the designated warehouse to keep T&A EVMs
Don't forget to destroy VVPAT slips generated during Training and Awareness on daily basis
Don't operate EVM Demonstration Centre(s) set up at DEO, RO Headquarters/ Revenue Sub-Division Offices after announcement of election by the ECI.
Don't forget to re-introduce T&A EVMs as Poll Day Reserve after de-novo FLC, randomizations, candidate setting etc.
6. RANDOMIZATIONS
Don't forget to intimate in writing 1 st Randomization schedule to National and State Recognised Political parties with proper acknowledgment
Don't allocate EVM AC-wise unevenly during 1 st Randomization
Don't allocate Ballot Units more than Control Units during 1 st Randomization
Don't forget to receipt EVM AC-wise by scanning after 1 st Randomization
Don't forget to share list of 1 st Randomized EVM (AC-wise) with National and State Recognised Political Parties with proper acknowledgment
Don't forget to intimate in writing 2 nd Randomization schedule to all the contesting candidates/their agents with proper acknowledgment
Don't forget to share list of 1 st Randomized EVM (AC-wise) with the respective contesting candidates/their agents with proper acknowledgment
Don't miss out to update polling stations before 2 nd Randomization
Don't forget to share list of 2 nd Randomized EVM with all the contesting candidates/their agents with proper acknowledgment
7. DURING COMMISSIONING
Don't forget to intimate in writing schedule of Commissioning of EVMs to all the contesting candidates/their agents with proper acknowledgment
Don't leave VVPATs slips generated during commissioning without shredding on a daily basis.
Don't forget to check correct loading of Serial Numbers, Names of Candidate and their Symbols in VVPATs
Don't forget to install new powerpack in CU and VVPAT and paper roll in VVPAT, in which mock poll of 1000 votes on 5% randomly selected EVMs is conducted.
Don't keep VVPAT knob in Working mode (Vertical position) after commissioning
Don't set candidates in CU without connecting BU(s) and VVPAT.
Don't forget to share lists of EVMs to be used in polling stations (polling station-wise) and reserve EVMs and VVPATs with contesting candidates

8. DURING DISPERSAL TO POLLING STATIONS
Don't forget to ensure EVM/VVPAT is related to the particular polling station for which it has been allotted.
Don't take away any EVM to any unauthorised place like residence, etc.
Don't repeatedly switch ON and OFF the VVPAT as it will deplete the battery as well as paper roll causing problems during the poll day.
Don't forget to switch OFF the CU while connecting or disconnecting the EVM units and VVPAT using cables
Don't pull the cable of BU & VVPAT while disconnecting from the CU.
Don't forget to earmark a government building as the cluster point for polling parties and for EVMs dispatch to polling stations on P-2/3. Don't use Police stations for such cluster points.
Don't switch on the VVPAT at the time of dispersal.
Don't connect Ballot Unit, Control Unit and VVPAT during dispersal
Don't keep VVPAT knob vertical (Working mode) while transporting.
Don't stay at any place other than designated place.
Don't remove any seal from BU, CU and VVPAT.
Don't use vehicle other than vehicle provided for dispersal.
9. DURING MOCK POLL ON POLL DAY
Don't start mock poll, if no or one election agent is present. Wait for 15 minutes.
Don't stop mock poll without casting at least 50 votes.
Don't keep BU, CU and VVPAT on one table for mock poll. (Keep BU & VVPAT at voting compartment)
Don't forget to cast at least one vote to each candidate button including NOTA during mock poll
Don't leave any mock poll slips inside the VVPAT slips compartment after completion of mock poll on poll day.
Don't forget to delete mock poll data from the CU before starting of actual poll.
Don't keep mock poll VVPAT slips unstamped in black envelope.
Don't forget to tally EVM (CU) count with VVPAT slips count during mock poll.
Don't forget to fill Mock Poll Certificate (Part-I of Presiding Officer Report)
Don't start actual poll without sealing Result Section of CU and Drop Box of VVPAT and taking signatures of polling agents.
10.DURING POLL
Don't operate the paper roll knob till the end of the poll.
Don't forget pressing of close button of CU after completion of poll.
Don't conduct mock poll in case of replacement of only VVPAT during the actual poll.
Don't hang any high illumination bulb over VVPAT at Voting Compartment
Don't Switch ON the Control Unit at the time of connection and disconnection of Ballot Unit, Control Unit and VVPAT
Don't Switch ON Control Unit when VVPAT paper roll knob is in lock position (horizontal position)
Don't forget to tape the interconnecting cable of BU/VVPAT to the leg of then table with 'transparent' adhesive tape.
Don't forget to press both side latches of connector while disconnecting the cable
Don't forget to clear mock poll data from the Control Unit and VVPAT mock slips from VVPAT in mock poll process

Don't enter into the voting compartment to educate illiterate how to cast vote. Use cardboard BU for this purpose.
Don't Switch OFF/Switch ON EVM during poll process
Don't forget to remove VVPAT Power Pack (Battery) from VVPAT before sealing of VVPAT in its carrying case after completion of poll
11.AFTER POLL
Don't keep polled units and reserve units in the same strong room
Don't transport EVM in unauthorized vehicle (not notified for transport of EVM).
Don't store the "C" & "D" category of EVMs in the vicinity of "A" & "B" category of EVMs.
Don't leave the VVPAT battery inside the VVPAT after completion of poll.
Don't forget to intimate all the contesting candidates about the storage place of category A, B, C and D.
Don't keep polled units of two or more Assembly Constituency/Segment in the same strong room, after poll
Don't transport EVMs without escort after poll from polling stations to collection centre.
12.DURING COUNTING
Don't obtain result from CUs without verifying seals.
Don't forget to write in pen, in space between counting supervisor's signature and signature of candidate/their agents/counting agents in Part-II for Form-17C "We, hereby certify that CU No.(s).....is/are the same which were used in the Polling Station No "
13.AFTER COUNTING
Don't leave CU batteries inside CUs before storing them in the strong room after counting of votes.
Don't forget to remove VVPAT slips from all VVPATs after counting of votes before storing VVPAT in warehouse.
Don't open the strong room till the completion of EP period i.e. till EP list is received from High Court concerned.
Don't store 2 or more than 2 ACs machines in same strong room after completion of poll and counting of votes till the completion of EP period.
Don't remove paper roll from VVPATs
14.FOR PENDING EPEVMs
Don't open the strong room where EP related EVMs are stored, without permission of the Court, except in exceptional cases like flood, fire, etc.

DOs AND DONTs ON USE OF VVPAT

DOs	DON'Ts
Ensure paper roll knob is locked (horizontal position) before transportation.	
In Polling Station, unlock the paper roll knob (vertical position), before switching ON the CU.	Don't switch ON CU before VVPAT paper roll knob is in unlocked condition (vertical position).
Position BU and VVPAT in Voting Compartment. Position CU on PO's Table	
Establish right connection by following the colour scheme.	Don't allow direct light or high power illumination over VVPAT.
Ensure the connectors are inserted properly.	Don't remove cables without pressing the clips on the connectors.

Switch 'ON' CU, the Power-On Green LED on VVPAT glows and VVPAT prints all 7 slips.	Don't switch OFF CU unless all 7 slips are printed and cut.
Check for any "ERROR" message on CU. Inform Sector Officer (SO) in case of any "ERROR".	Don't start polling in case of "PRINTER ERROR" message on CU.
Always switch OFF CU before making any connection or disconnection including change of battery.	Don't operate the paper roll knob till the end of the poll.
NOTE: VVPAT related messages are displayed on the CU's Display.	

CHAPTER-17

DOCUMENTATION AND MONITORING

17.1. Office of the Chief Electoral Officers shall maintain a folder in which a copy of the following documents shall be kept for records purpose

S. No.	Activity	Required document(s)
1	Opening and Closing of EVM warehouse for any purpose like a) Quarterly inspection b) Receiving or Sending of EVMs c) First Level Checking d) Taking out of EVMs for training and awareness from FLC strong room etc.	- Intimation given to the National and State Recognised Political Parties and their acknowledgement. - Proceeding of opening and closing of EVM warehouse
2	First Level Checking of EVMs	- Intimation given to the National and State Recognised Political Parties and their acknowledgement. - Attendance Register for the National and State Recognised Political Parties on daily basis. - Certification of EVMs by BEL/ECIL i.e. components of the EVMs are original countersigned by the representatives of National and State Recognised Political Parties. - Mock poll certification during FLC regarding participation and satisfaction of the representatives of National and State Recognised Political Parties. - List of FLC-OK EVMs shared with the National and State Recognised Political Parties.
3	Taking out of EVMs for Training and Awareness after FLC	- Intimation given to the National and State Recognised Political Parties and their acknowledgement. - Acknowledgment of the National and State Recognised Political Parties regarding getting list of EVMs taken out for T&A. - Acknowledgment of the National and State Recognised Political Parties regarding getting information of storage place(s) of EVMs and VVPATs pertaining to T&A. - Proceeding of the entire process with the acknowledgment of the National and State Recognised Political Parties
4	First Randomization of EVMs	- Intimation given to the National and State Recognised Political Parties and their acknowledgement. - Proceeding of the entire process with the acknowledgment of the National and State Recognised Political Parties. - Acknowledgment of the National and State Recognised Political Parties regarding getting AC/AS wise allocated randomized lists of EVMs.

5	Second Randomization of EVMs	• Intimation given to all the contesting candidate and their acknowledgement. • Proceeding of the entire process with the acknowledgment of the contesting candidates/their representatives. • Acknowledgment of all the contesting candidates regarding getting Polling Station wise allocated randomized lists of EVMs and reserve EVMs.
6	Commissioning of EVMs	• Intimation given to all the contesting candidate and their acknowledgement. • Proceeding of the entire process with the acknowledgment of the contesting candidates/their representatives. • Attendance Register for the contesting candidates/their representatives on daily basis. • Mock poll certification during commissioning regarding participation and satisfaction of the contesting candidates/their representatives. • Revised lists of EVMs to be used in polling station(s) and reserve EVMs and VVPAT to all the contesting candidates/their representatives, if any replacement of BU/CU/VVPAT due to non-functional during commissioning.
7	Dispersal of EVMs	• Intimation given to all the contesting candidate and their acknowledgements. • Revised lists of EVMs to be used in polling station(s) and reserve EVMs to all the contesting candidates/their representatives, if any replacement of BU/CU/VVPAT due to non-functional during dispersal.
8	Transportation of polled EVMs from Polling Stations to Reception Centre	• Intimation given to all the contesting candidate regarding allowing them/polling agents to follow the vehicles carrying polled EVMs and their acknowledgement.
9	Storage of various categories of EVMs after poll	• Intimation given to all the contesting candidate regarding storage place(s) of various categories of EVMs (polled, reserve and non-functional) and for deputing their representatives and their acknowledgement.
10	Meeting with National and State Recognised Political Parties	• Meeting Notice issued to the National and State Recognised Political Parties. • Attendance Sheet. • Proceeding of the meeting.
11	Objection/complaints of the National and State Recognised Political Parties and Candidates during various processes related to use of EVMs.	• Complaints/objections of the National and State Recognised Political Parties and Candidates. • Disposal of the complaints/objections in the form of proceeding/letter.

17.2. Proceeding of all the activities related to EVM shall be made as per the following draft sample:**Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Name of Election:****Name of AC/PC:****Venue:****Date:****Time:**

Purpose: [like Opening and Closing of EVM warehouse/Strong Room, First Level Checking of EVMs, 1st Randomization of EVMs, 2nd Randomization of EVMs, Commissioning of EVMs, Dispersal of EVMs, Meeting with the Recognised Political Parties/Candidates on..... etc.]

Brief description:

Example: All the Recognised Political Parties have been invited vide.....
(Notice No. and date) to remain present during opening and closing of EVM warehouse for the purpose of(like shifting of EVMs) from.....to.....

The warehouse has been opened in the presence of the Recognised Political Parties at.....AM/PM
on(date) and closed at.....AM/PM on,,,,,,,,,,,,,,,,,,,,, (date), under videography.

All are satisfied with the entire processes.

Participants:

Administrative/Election Machinery			
S.No.	Name & Designation	Dept. ID No.	Signature
Recognised Political Parties/Candidates			
S.No.	Name and designation	Party Affiliation, if any/ Independent	Signature

PART-IV			
ANNEXURES			
18	Annexures	Annexure-1 to 47	124-184

ANNEXURE-1**Master Stock Register****Name of State/Union Territory:****Name of District:****Name of sub-division/Taluka:****Address of Warehouse:****(Note: Separate Register for Ballot Units, Control Units and VVPATs)****Control Unit**

Box No.	CU ID No.	Name of Manufacturer	Year of Manufacture	Date of Receipt	Receipt Challan No.	Date on receipt Challan	Name and designation of receiver	Signature of receiver	Signature of Warehouse-In-charge	Remarks
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11

Ballot Unit

Box No.	BU ID No.	Name of Manufacturer	Year of Manufacture	Date of Receipt	Receipt Challan No.	Date on receipt Challan	Name and designation of receiver	Signature of receiver	Signature of Warehouse-In-charge	Remarks
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11

VVPAT

Box No.	VVPAT ID No.	Name of Manufacturer	Year of Manufacture	Date of Receipt	Receipt Challan No.	Date on receipt Challan	Name and designation of receiver	Signature of receiver	Signature of Warehouse-In-charge	Remarks
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11

Gist of Control Unit, Ballot Unit and VVPAT in Separate Register

Total Unit received in ware-house			Date of receipt	Total Units shifted from Warehouse			Date of Despatch	Net Availability in ware-house			Remarks
BU	CU	VVPAT		BU	CU	VVPAT		BU	CU	VVPAT	

ANNEXURE-2**Certificate of monthly inspection of EVM warehouse (s)**

I, hereby, certify that as per the Commission's instruction, I personally visited the EVM warehouse(s) and I am satisfied with the arrangements as under:

S. No.	Particulars	Inspection Report
1	(a) Location of EVM warehouse(s)	(i) District Headquarters (ii) Tehsil Headquarters (iii) Other (specify the name)
	(b) Type of building	(i) Government (ii) Semi-government (iii) Private rented
	(c) Whether any other office located in the warehouse building?	(Yes/No) If yes, please specify.
2	How many entry point(s) is/are there in EVM-warehouse(s)?	
3	What type of lock system is observed in EVM-warehouse?	
4	Other doors and windows, if any, in the warehouse are sealed with which material.	
5	(a) Number of CCTV installed	
	(b) No. of CCTV found functional	
	(c) No. of CCTV showing correct timing	
	(d) Whether DVR was connected with laptop to inspect the activities in WH? What was the observation	
	(e) Where is the display of the CCTV cameras located?	
6	(a) Whether log-book showing the duty of the security personnel was inspected?	
	(b) How many security personnel deployed in each shift?	
	(c) When was warehouse opened last time?	
	(d) Kindly mention reason for opening of warehouse and who authorized the opening of warehouse.	
7	(a) Where is the main switch of the warehouse installed?	
	(b) Whether main switch installed outside has been switched off in warehouse?	
8	(a) How many fire-fighting equipment are installed?	
	(b) Date of expiry of the fire-extinguisher	
9	Kindly attach Photographs of inspection of warehouse(s).	

Date of Inspection:

Signature.....

(Name of District Election Officer)

Name of District.....

ANNEXURE-3**Certificate of Quarterly Inspection of EVM Warehouse (s)**

I, hereby, certify that as per the Commission's instruction, I personally visited the EVM-VVPAT warehouse(s) and I am satisfied with the arrangements as under:

S. No.	Particulars	Inspection Report
1.	EVM-VVPAT warehouse is at	(a) District Headquarters (b) Tehsil Headquarters (c) Other (specify the name)
2.	a) How many entry point(s) is/are there in EVM-VVPAT warehouse?	
	(b) If more than one entry point, whether other entry point(s) is sealed with brick-masonry or concrete.	
3.	(a) What type of lock system is put in place in EVM-VVPAT warehouse	
	(b) Who are the custodian of Keys of the Locks? Name and designation of officers	
4.	Other doors and windows, if any, in the warehouse, are sealed as per extant instructions? Specify material used for sealing.	
5.	(a) Number of CCTV cameras installed	
	(b) Have you seen the past CCTV recording after the last inspection to verify that recording is happening and is satisfactory?	
6.	(a) Whether log-book showing the duty of the security personnel was inspected by senior police officers?	
	(b) How many security personnel are deployed in each shift?	
	(c) When was the warehouse opened last time?	
	(d) Kindly mention reason for opening of warehouse and who authorized the opening of warehouse.	
	(e) Whether at the time of opening and closing of warehouse (s) signature of representatives of National and State Recognised Political Parties obtained in logbook? If No, reason thereof.	
	(f) Where is the copy of videography of opening and closing of warehouse(s) kept?	
7.	(a) Where is the main switch of the warehouse installed?	
	(b) Whether main switch of warehouse installed outside has been switched off?	

8.	(a) How many fire-fighting equipment are installed?	
	(b) Dates of expiry of the fire extinguisher.	
	(c) Is Fire NOC available for the building from the municipal or other competent authority?	
9.	Details of the representatives of National/State Recognized political parties, who are present at the time of inspection.	
10.	Check for dampness/water logging/rodents/any other abnormality etc. and remarks on the internal conditions of the Warehouse.	
11.	Whether any other material (other than EVMs & VVPATs) are kept with EVMs in Warehouse(s).	
12.	Kindly attach 4-5 photographs of inspection of warehouse (s) mainly covering the entrances/exits.	
13.	Whether the warehouse is in flood-prone area considering the trend in the past 5 years?	
14.	If the warehouse is in a flood-prone area as per (Q.13), whether necessary SOP/Plan is in place for safe keeping of the EVM stock in such eventuality?	
15.	(i) Whether the necessary NOC from CPWD/PWD (Civil and Electrical) has been taken on record at the time of putting to the Warehouse to use?	
	(ii) Whether the NOCs are still valid?	
16.	If the answer to the Q. No. 15 is No, provide details of action taken thereof?	
17.	Any other Remark/Observation	

Date of Inspection:

Signature.....

(Name of District Election Officer)

Name of District.....

Signature.....

(Name of Chief Electoral Officer)

Name of State.....

(In case present at the time of quarterly inspection)

ANNEXURE-4**(Attendance Register for National and State Recognized Political Parties-FLC Hall)**

Name of State/UT:

Name of District:

Address of FLC hall:

Date.....

S. No.	Name of National/State Party	Name of representative of political party with party affiliation	Identity document No. with date	Signature of representative	Remarks, if any.

Note: If the representative of a party is absent the proof of due service of notice to the party should be pasted in the register.

(Name, Designation and Signature of officer nominated by District Election Officer)

ANNEXURE-5**SOP for Cleaning of Plastic Cabinet and Carrying Cases**

Purpose: The purpose of cleaning of cabinets and carrying cases of EVM/VVPATs is to remove all the previous traces, tags, markings, stickers and any other display tags related to its earlier usage which if not removed properly, may mislead information in its future assigned use.

Objects for Cleaning on the Cabinet & Carrying Case:

Tags, Seal, FLC Stickers, Pink Paper Seal, Other previous poll displays, Markings over Boxes etc.

Detail: The following Tags, Seal, display are normally found on the cabinet/carrying case of EVM/VVPAT after being used for Election.

- (a) **BU:** Ballot Papers, Transparent Ballot Paper screen address Tag, Top & Bottom Latches address Tag, Pink Paper Seal, Green FLC sticker.
- (b) **CU:** Battery Compartment address Tags, Candidate Set compartment address Tag, Special Tag, Green paper Seal, Outer paper strip seal, CRC door address Tag, Green FLC sticker, Pink Paper Seal, Superscriptions.
- (c) **VVPAT:** Paper Roll Compartment address tag Seal, Ballot Slip Compartment Address Tag Seal, Green FLC sticker, superscription.
- (d) **Carrying Case:** Marking/display of information such as District Name, AC/PC number & Name, Polling Station number, other information of previous poll.

Method: For Surface Cleaning & to remove the Stickers and Tags, the recommended chemical is “Iso Propyl Alcohol”. Cotton waste is to be used to apply the chemical on the surfaces of Cabinet & Carrying case.

Cotton waste should be soaked sufficiently with the Iso Propyl alcohol and gently rubbed on the stickers/tags which are to be removed without any damage or scratching on the body. Cleaning process may be repeated till the stickers are completely removed.

In any case, the Iso Propyl alcohol should not be directly poured on the Cabinet or Carrying case body, but it has to be applied through cotton waste only. Other solvents like Thinner, Water etc. should not be used to avoid damage to EVM/VVPAT units.

Other Instructions:

- 1. Writing on the carrying case body using permanent marker should be avoided and appropriate stickers to be used for display of other relevant information such as AC/PC number, AC/PC name, district name etc. Removal of permanent marker “markings” require repeated forced rubbing even with the Iso Propyl alcohol and may damage the surface.
- 2. Iso Propyl alcohol being a flammable material, proper storage & handling protocol to be maintained.
- 3. The General instruction on safety and handling of Iso Propyl alcohol are as under. Specific instructions can be referred from the Material Safety Data Sheet supplied along with the Iso Propyl alcohol by the supplier/manufacturer:-

HAZARDS IDENTIFICATION

- (a) **Primary Entry Routes:** Inhalation, skin, eyes and ingestion.
- (b) **Acute Effects:** Inhalation of vapour irritates the respiratory tract. Exposure to high concentration has a narcotic effect producing symptoms of dizziness, drowsiness, headache, staggering, unconsciousness and possibly death.

- (c) **Aggravation of Pre-existing condition:** Persons with pre-existing skin disorders or impaired liver, kidney or pulmonary function may be more susceptible to the effects of this chemical.

FIRST AID MEASURES

- (a) **Eyes:** Immediately flush eyes with plenty of water for at least 15 minutes. Lifting lower & upper eye lids occasionally. Get medical attention immediately.
- (b) **Skin:** Immediately flush skin with plenty of water for at least 15 minutes. Call a physician, if irritation develops.
- (c) **Inhalation:** Immediately bring the affected person to fresh air. If not breathing, give artificial respiration. If breathing is difficult, give oxygen. Get medical attention.
- (d) **Ingestion:** Give large amount of water to drink. Never give anything by mouth to an unconscious person. Get medical attention.

FIRE FIGHTING MEASURES

- (a) **Extinguishing media:** Water spray, Dry chemical, Alcohol Foam or CO₂ Water Spray may be used to keep fire expose container cool, dilute spills to non-flammable mixtures and to protect personnel attempting to stop leak and disperse vapour.
- (b) **Fire fighting instructions:** In the event of fire, wear full protective clothing and self-contained breathing apparatus with full face piece.

STORAGE REQUIREMENTS: Store in cool, dry, well-ventilated area away from heat source. Storage and usage area should be clarified as “No smoking Area”.

ECOLOGICAL INFORMATION: Prevent spillage from entering drains or water sources. After spills, wash area with water preventing run-off from entering drains. When released into water, this material may bio-degrade to a moderate extent.

ANNEXURE-6**(Certification of EVMs by BEL/ECIL)****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:****Date:.....**

It is certified that tests prescribed by BEL/ECIL to ascertain that all components are original were carried out on the EVMs (BU & CU) listed below on (date). On the basis of these tests it is certified that all components of the EVMs listed below are original.

CU Identification No.	BU Identification No.

(Name & Signature of BEL/ECIL engineers with ID No.)**(Name of Representatives of political parties with their party affiliation and signature)****(Name, designation and signature of officer nominated by District Election Officer)**

ANNEXURE-7**Tools and Spares to be brought by BEL/ECIL Engineers for FLC****1. TOOLS TO BE CARRIED BY ENGINEERS**

- a) Screw Drivers, Forceps, Nose-pliers;
- b) Multi-meter;
- c) Symbol Loading Unit with Accessories (SLMD with all connecting cables); and
- d) P-FLCU

2. SPARE-PARTS AND OTHER MATERIAL TO BE BROUGHT BY ENGINEERS

- a) Flaps
- b) Close Caps
- c) Latches
- d) Cables (BU, VVPAT)
- e) Buttons (Ballot, Total, Close, Result, Clear & Candidate)
- f) Spare parts mentioned above (a) to (e) should be 20% of the number of EVMs to be tested
- g) High Resolution Photographs of component side of CU-PCB and BU-PCB
- h) FLC Stickers {FLC-OK (Green), FLC-Failed (Red)}
- i) Tamper seals
- j) VVPAT Stickers (Transportation, Working and Unlock before Switch ON); and
- k) Ballot Paper of Dummy symbol

ANNEXURE-8**(Mock Poll Selection Certificate during FLC of EVMs)****Date:****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:**

It is certified that I have been allowed to pick machines (EVMs as well as VVPATs) randomly for the purpose of mock-poll.

SL. No.	Name of National/ State Party	Name of representative of political party with party affiliation	Identity document no. with date	Signature of representative	Remarks, if any.

ANNEXURE-9**(Mock Poll by Representatives of National and State Recognised Political Parties during FLC of EVMs)****Date:****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:**

It is certified that I have done mock poll on EVMs along with VVPATs and I am fully satisfied with the functioning of EVMs and VVPATs.

S.No.	Name of National/State Party	Name of representative of political party with party affiliation	Identity document No. with date	Signature of representative	Remarks, if any

ANNEXURE-10**(Mock Poll certification during FLC of VVPATs)****Date:****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:**

It is certified that the **results of the printed ballot slips of VVPATs** (*list of unique ID of VVPATs attached*) **have been tallied with the electronic result of the respective Control Units.** There are no discrepancies between the electronic count of the Control Units and count of printed ballot paper slips of VVPATs.

S.No.	Name of National/State Political Party	Name of representative of political party with party affiliation	Identity document No. with date	Signature of representative	Remarks, if any

Name and Signature of BEL/ECIL Engineers

1.

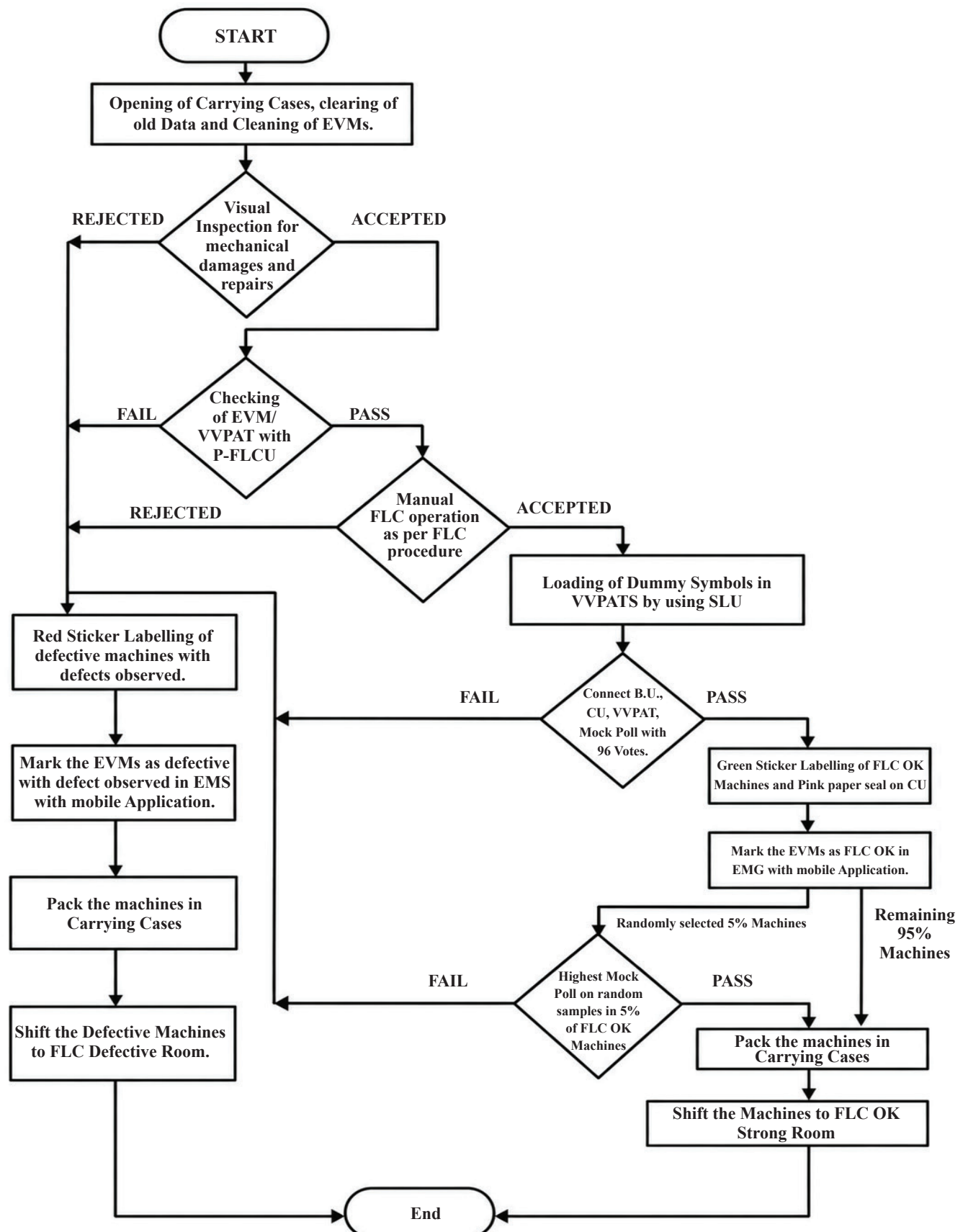
2.

3.

(Signature).....

Name of FLC-Supervisor.....

Designation.....

ANNEXURE-11**Flow Chart for FLC Procedure of EVM**

ANNEXURE-12**(Sealing of Control Unit of EVMs using Pink Paper Seal)****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:****Date:**

It is certified that the sealing of the Control Units using Pink Paper Seals has been done in my presence. I have put my signature on the Pink Paper Seals after sealing of the Control Units and I am satisfied with the sealing of the Control Units.

Sl. No.	Unique ID No. of Control Unit	Pink Paper Seal Number

(Name, Designation and Signature of officers nominated by District Election Officer)

ANNEXURE-13**(Inspection Report of arrangement for FLC)****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:****Date:.....**

Sl. No.	Particular	Yes/No
1.	Whether FLC hall is sufficiently large to accommodate the EVMs and VVPATs to be checked, officials nominated by the DEO, engineers of BEL and ECIL and also representatives of political Parties.	
2.	Whether FLC Hall well-lighted, well ventilated and dust free.	
	Whether FLC area has been barricaded and sanitized by police.	
4.	Whether adequate arrangement of fire extinguishers and fire alarm has been made inside and outside the hall.	
5.	Whether hall is free from any other electronic device or components of electronic devices other than permissible devices.	
6.	Whether facilities of drinking water, toilet, first aid etc. are available.	
7.	Whether there is only one entry and exit point to the hall and guarded by armed Police force round the clock.	
8.	Whether arrangement for installation of TV/Monitor (minimum 24 inches) with HDMI input for each SLU has been made.	
9.	Whether arrangement of one PC/Laptop with internet connectivity outside FLC Hall for transmission of FLC data from P-FLCU has been made.	
10.	Whether arrangement has been made for pasting SoP on FLC procedure in the FLC Hall.	
11.	Whether arrangement has been made for shredding of VVPATs slips by shredding machine.	
12.	Whether Door Frame Metal Detector are installed.	
13.	Whether arrangement for frisking has been made.	
14.	Whether Identity Cards for entry into the FLC hall to the authorized officials/Representatives of political parties have been issued by the District Election Officer.	
15.	Whether arrangement of webcasting have been made.	
16.	Whether log book to record entry of every person has been kept at FLC Hall.	
17.	Whether a separate log book (i.e. duty roster) to be maintained for armed police force deployed for FLC hall has been kept at FLC hall.	
18.	Whether all required registers and formats are ready and kept in FLC Hall.	
19.	Number of Armed Police Personnel in each shift.	

I have personally inspected the above arrangements.

(Name and Signature of District Election Officer)

ANNEXURE-14**(Certificate on completion of FLC process)****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:****Date:.....**

It is certified that FLC process has been completed on(date) as per instructions of the Commission on First Level Checking of EVMs and VVPATs. I personally inspected FLC on following date:

The status of EVMs and VVPATs after completion of FLC is as under:

Name of District	Available in the District			FLC Ok Quantity			FLC Reject Quantity		
	BU	CU	VVPAT	BU	CU	VVPAT	BU	CU	VVPAT

The Non-functional EVMs and VVPATs shall be shifted to the manufacturer (BEL/ECIL) on i.e. within 7 days from the date of completion of FLC process in the district.

(Name and Signature of District Election Officer)

ANNEXURE-15**Part-I (Inspection Report of arrangement for FLC)****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of FLC Hall:**.....**EVMs/VVPATs of BEL/ECIL:**.....**Date:**.....

Sl. No.	Particular	Remarks
1.	Total Number of Polling Stations.	
2.	Quantity of units (a) Ballot Units (b) Control Units (c) VVPATs	
3.	Number of engineers deployed by BEL/ECIL	
4.	Expected FLC start date.	
5.	Whether FLC hall is sufficiently large to accommodate the EVMs and VVPATs to be checked, officials nominated by the DEO, engineers of BEL/ECIL and also representatives of political parties.	
6.	Whether FLC hall well lighted, well ventilated and dust free.	
7.	Whether adequate arrangement of fire extinguishers and fire alarm has been made inside and outside the FLC Hall.	
8.	Whether FLC area has been barricaded and sanitized by police.	
9.	Whether the hall is free from any other electronic device or components of electronic devices other than permissible devices	
10.	Whether facilities of drinking water, toilet, first aid etc. are available.	
11.	Whether there is only one entry and exit point to the hall and guarded by armed police force round the clock.	
12.	Whether Door Frame Metal Detector are installed.	
13.	Whether arrangement for frisking has been made.	
14.	Whether Identity Cards for entry into the FLC hall to the authorized officials/representatives of political parties have been issued by the DEO.	
15.	Whether webcasting showing FLC tables clearly visible in DEO's chamber.	
16.	Whether log book to record entry of every person has been kept at FLC hall.	
17.	Whether a separate log book (i.e. duty register) to be maintained for armed police force deployed for FLC hall has been kept at FLC hall.	
18.	Whether all required registers and formats mentioned in the Commission's letter No. 51/8/INST/2022-EMS, dated 13 th September, 2022 are ready and kept in FLC hall.	
19.	Number of Armed Police Personnel planned in each shift.	
20.	Whether all National and State Recognized Political Parties at district and State level have been invited in writing and notices duly served.	

(Signature)
Name and Designation

Part-II (Inspection Report of quality of FLC)

Name of State/UT:

Name of District:

Address of FLC Hall:.....

EVMs/VVPATs of BEL/ECIL:.....

Date:.....

S. No.	Particular	Report
1.	Total Number of Polling Stations	
2.	Quantity of units subject to FLC (a) Ballot Units (b) Control Units (c) VVPATs	
3	Total number of BEL/ECIL authorized engineers present.	
4.	Date of FLC start	
5.	Quantity of units FLC done so far (a) Ballot Units (b) Control Units (c) VVPATs	
6.	Name and Designation of FLC Supervisor appointed by DEO	
7.	Photocopies of attendance register of political parties	
8.	Who is monitoring Webcasting of FLC process in the Control Room?	
9.	SoP to confirm that all components of the EVMs are original is available with authorized engineers of BEL/ECIL.	
10.	SoP mentioning the step-by-step instructions of checking of the machines is pasted prominently at FLC hall.	
11.	PCB and other components of EVMs are shown to the representatives of political parties.	
12.	Whether DEO is conducting a daily inspection of the FLC venue and FLC process.	
13.	Whether ECI instructions on FLC process are being followed in letter and spirit.	
14.	Kindly mention below shortcomings or suggestions for improvement.	

(Signature)

Name and Designation

Checklist on Probable Shortcomings during FLC

(To be submitted with Part-II of Inspection Report)

Name of State/UT:

Name of District:

Address of FLC Hall:.....

EVMs/VVPATs of BEL/ECIL:.....

Date of visit :.....

S. No.	Particular	Report
1.	Whether web-casting is covering the entire FLC process i.e. CCTV coverage is available in all Halls where FLC process is going on and same is visible at web-casting.	
2.	Quality of cleaning of cabinets and carrying cases of machines.	
3.	Whether FLC-OK and FLC-Rejected units are kept in separate rooms.	
4.	Whether FLC-OK and FLC-Rejected status is updated in EMS on daily basis i.e. no FLC-OK machine of previous day is pending for updating in EMS.	
5.	Whether Pink Paper Seals are affixed on FLC-OK CUs properly.	
6.	Whether sufficient quantity of spare plastic parts viz. buttons, covers and latches etc. are available at FLC Hall.	
7.	Whether paper shredding machine is available in the FLC Hall to shred the VVPAT slips. If Yes, whether VVPAT slips are disposed of on daily basis.	
8.	Observations on functional and physical status of randomly selected 10 FLC-OK units (i.e. 5 CU+ 5 VVPAT) checked on the visit date.	
9.	Observations on functional and physical status of randomly selected 10 FLC-Rejected units (i.e. 5 CU+ 5 VVPAT) checked on the visit date.	
10.	Whether the reason of rejection mentioned for the FLC-rejected units checked by you was correctly mentioned in the record.	
11.	a) No. of Engineers deployed in the District	
	b) No. of Engineers available in the District	
	c) If there is any difference between 11(a) & 11(b), reason thereof.	

Date:

(Signature)

Name and
Designation

ANNEXURE-16**Plan on Awareness for EVMs**

Name of State:.....

EVM Demonstration Centre (EDC)

Name of District	No. of EVMs Demonstration Centres (EDC) set up at DEO HQs	Address of DEO HQs, where EDC is set up	No. and name of Assembly Constituency	No. of EDC set up at Returning Officer/ Revenue Sub-Division offices	Address of Returning Officer/ Revenue Sub-Division offices where EDC is set up	Remarks, if any

Mobile Demonstration Van (MDV)

Name of District	No. and name of Assembly Constituency in the district	No. of Mobile Demonstration Vans (MDV) deployed in AC	Total No. of Polling Station Location in Assembly Constituency	Date of Start of MDV in AC	Plan to cover all Polling Stations Location in AC (atleast once)	Remarks, if any

ANNEXURE-17**Progress on EVMs Awareness**

(To be submitted every Monday till the date of announcement of elections)

Name of State:.....

Date of Report:.....

EVM Demonstration Centre (EDC)

Particulars	At DEO Headquarters	At RO/Revenue Sub-Di- vision Headquarters	Total (2+3)
1	2	3	4
1. No. of people came to EVM Demonstration Centre till previous day of the Report			
2. No. of people cast mock vote at EVM Demonstration Centre till previous day of the Report.			

Mobile Demonstration Vans (MDV)

Name of District	No. & Name of ACs in District	AC Wise Polling Locations	AC Wise Polling Locations Covered Till Previous Day Of Report	AC Wise Polling Locations Balance To Cover

ANNEXURE-18**Standard Operating Procedure (SoP) for Training including demonstration and awareness program of EVMs and VVPATs**

Following SoP shall strictly be followed for Training including demonstration and awareness program of EVM and VVPAT:

- EVM and VVPAT used for the aforesaid purpose shall be checked/tested by authorized engineer(s) of M/s Bharat Electronics Limited and M/s Electronics Corporation of India Limited, as the case may be, during First Level Checking (FLC).
- Only 'FLC-OK' units shall be used for training, demonstration and awareness campaign.
- Engineer(s) of BEL and ECIL shall ensure that there is no data (including ballot paper, in case of Ballot Unit) of previous election in the EVM.
- Engineers shall only use dummy symbols for ballot paper(s) and VVPAT as mentioned below:
 - For name of candidate – AAA, BBB, CCC,..... and so on.
 - For symbol of candidates – Alpha (a), Beta (w), Gama (y)..... and so on. Sample

For Training/Demonstration/Awareness		
1	AAA	α
2	BBB	β
3	CCC	γ

- Only Sample ballot papers, having dummy names and symbols shall be used for training, demonstration, awareness campaign and First Level Checking. Any modification or alteration in the Dummy Name, Symbol or Sequence shall require prior approval of the Commission.
- BEL/ECIL shall ensure that engineers deputed for training, demonstration, awareness campaign and First Level Checking of EVMs must carry necessary equipment/SLU for symbol loading and preparation of sample ballot Paper.
- The VVPAT shall have dummy symbols which should match with the symbols of the ballot paper.
- Demonstration and Awareness shall not be given in an open area as the VVPATs have to be shielded from direct sunlight.
- During demonstration/awareness, Ballot Unit and VVPAT shall be kept together so that voters can see the printed paper slip in VVPAT.
- Voters should be explained about the process using EVMs and also informed about their use in election.
- A Register should be maintained to record votes and signatures of all the participants on daily basis in the demonstration process.
- At the end of demonstration, the electronic result of the Control Unit shall be cleared and VVPAT slips shall be removed from the VVPAT drop box. Further, it has to be ensured that on the next day the same process is repeated.
- Proper Security arrangement shall be made for movement of EVM at awareness centers.

ANNEXURE-19**Potential Errors**

- Irregularity on use of Dummy Symbols. Hence, it shall be ensured that VVPAT slips print as per dummy ballot papers, before using for awareness purpose.
- VVPATs should be connected at the time of commissioning of the EVMs otherwise EVM will not accept a VVPAT at a later stage. Hence, the candidate setting process in EVMs should be done using Ballot Unit and VVPAT connected.
- Ensure to lock paper roll while transporting the VVPAT from one place to another, otherwise, VVPAT may go into error mode.
- Do not Switch ON the VVPAT in broad daylight or directly under a bulb or halogen lamp at the time of awareness as the VVPAT may go into error mode. Hence, ensure that awareness on EVM and VVPAT shall be done in shaded/closed area.
- Do not repeatedly switch ON and OFF the VVPAT as it will deplete the battery as well as paper roll.
- Switch OFF the CU when connecting or disconnecting the EVMs and do not pull the cable for disconnecting.
- Non-adherence of SoP on Awareness of EVMs.

ANNEXURE-20**Register for Commissioning of EVMs****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Name of Assembly/Parliamentary Constituency:****No. and Name of Assembly Segment (in case of PC):****Address of EVM-VVPAT Commissioning Hall:****Date:**

Sl. No.	Name of Candidate	Name of Representative of Candidate with Party Affiliation, if any	Identity Document No. with Date	Signature of Candidate/His representative	Remarks, if any

Note: If a candidate or his/her representative is absent the proof of due service of notice to the candidate should be pasted in the register.

(Name and signature of engineers of BEL/ECIL with ID No.)

(Name, designation, signature of officers nominated by District Election Officer)

ANNEXURE-21**Certification of EVMs by BEL/ECIL****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Name of Assembly/Parliamentary Constituency:****No. and Name of Assembly Segment (in case of PC):****Address of EVM-VVPAT Commissioning Hall:****Date:**

It is certified that tests prescribed by BEL/ECIL to ascertain that all components are original were carried out on the Ballot Unit listed below on (date). On the basis of these tests it is certified that all components of the Ballot Unit listed below are original.

BU Identification No.

(Name & Signature of BEL/ECIL engineers with ID No.)

ANNEXURE-22**Register for Sealing of Ballot Unit of EVMs using Pink Paper Seal****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Address of Commissioning Hall:****Date:**

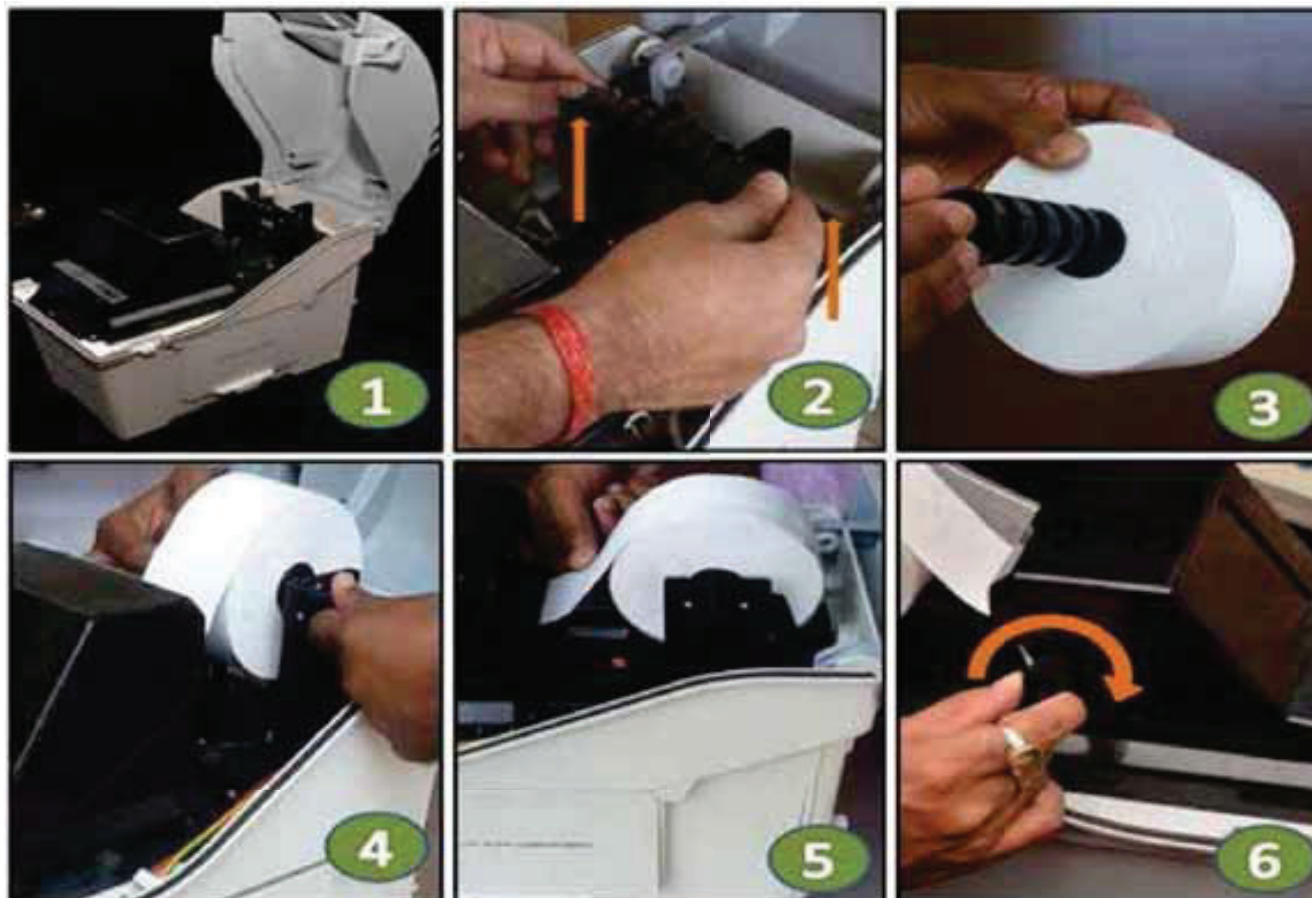
It is certified that the sealing of the Ballot Units using Pink Paper Seals has been done in my presence. I have put my signature on the Pink Paper Seals after sealing of the Ballot Units and I am satisfied with the sealing of the Ballot Units.

Sl. No.	Unique ID Ballot Unit	Pink Paper Seal Serial No.

Sl. No.	Name of Candidate	Name of Representative of Candidate with Party Affiliation, if any	Identity Document No. with Date	Signature of Candidate/his representative

ANNEXURE-23**INSTALLATION OF PAPER ROLL IN VVPAT**

- a) Open the Paper Roll Compartment by opening the side latches and by lifting the top cover. Observe the Paper Roll Compartment which holds the Paper Roll.
- b) Remove “Spindle” from its position by pulling towards upward direction.
- c) Insert “Spindle” into “Thermal Paper Roll”.
- d) Place the “Thermal Paper Roll” with “Spindle” into its position (i.e. Paper Roll Compartment) and press it towards down.
- e) Insert “Thermal Paper Roll” edge into the “Guide – Paper Entry”. Ensure that the plain paper should be on the top surface and the printed band should be on the lower surface of the Paper.
- f) Move the paper into the slot by rotating the paper feed knob clock wise.

**Paper Roll Installation steps**

ANNEXURE-24**Mock Poll certification during Commissioning of EVMs****Date:****Name of State/UT:****Name of District:****Name of Assembly/Parliamentary Constituency:****Name of Assembly Segment (in case of PC):****Address of EVM-VVPAT Commissioning Hall:**

It is certified that during commissioning of EVMs, mock poll of 1000 votes have been cast on 5% randomly selected EVMs. The electronic result tallied with paper count, picked up by me. There are no discrepancies between the votes polled during the mock poll.

Sl. No.	Name of Candidate	Name of Representative of Candidate with Party Affiliation, if any	Identity Document No. with Date	Signature of Candidate/his representative	Remarks, if any

ANNEXURE –25

SLU INVENTORY REGISTER (DEO is the custodian)					
NAME OF DISTRICT _____ NO. & NAME OF AC/AS _____					
Sl. No.	Serial No. of SLU	Container No. and Unique ID of Pink Paper Seal	Make (BEL/ECIL)	Date of Receiving	Sign of DEO

NOTE:

1. DEO shall obtain the signatures of Candidates/their Representatives and BEL/ECIL Engineer in-charge below the last entry.
2. On releasing/sending the SLUs and its accessories to the manufacturers necessary entries shall be made and signed by the DEO. Details of the dispatch shall be mentioned clearly with full particulars.

ANNEXURE – 26

SUMMARY OF SLU STORAGE CONDITIONS AND RESPONSIBILITIES				
S. No.	Stage of elections / EVM use	Type of Packaging/ Safekeeping needed for SLUs & Accessories	Storage area	Custodian/Overall responsibility
1.	During Commissioning	No packaging SLUs securely stored in locker/ safe/cupboard etc. under lock and key.	Commissioning premises	RO/ARO
2.	Completion of Commissioning till Counting of votes	Individual sealed SLU Containers	SLU Storage Room	DEO <i>Remark:</i> Only reserve SLUs shall be released on P+1
3.	Post-Counting	Sealed SLU containers kept in steel trunk under lock and key	AC/AS-wise strong room	DEO

ANNEXURE-27

SELF-ADHESIVE STICKERS-THREE SIDES OF VOTING COMPARTMENT

भारत निर्वाचन आयोग
मतदान कम्पार्टमेंट

**ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA
VOTING COMPARTMENT**

Name of Election:

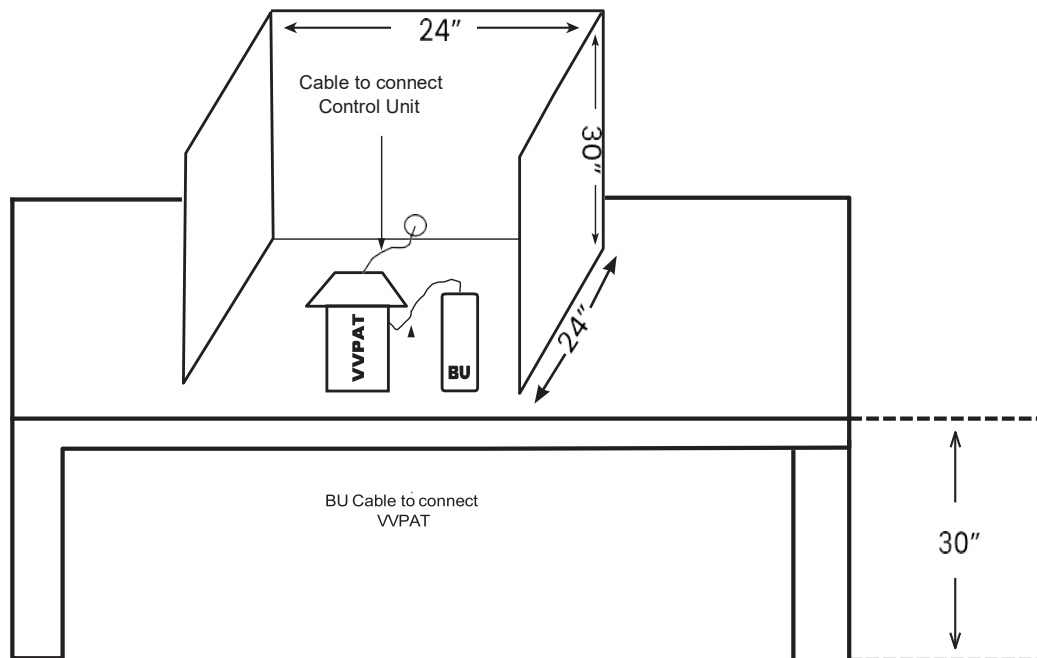
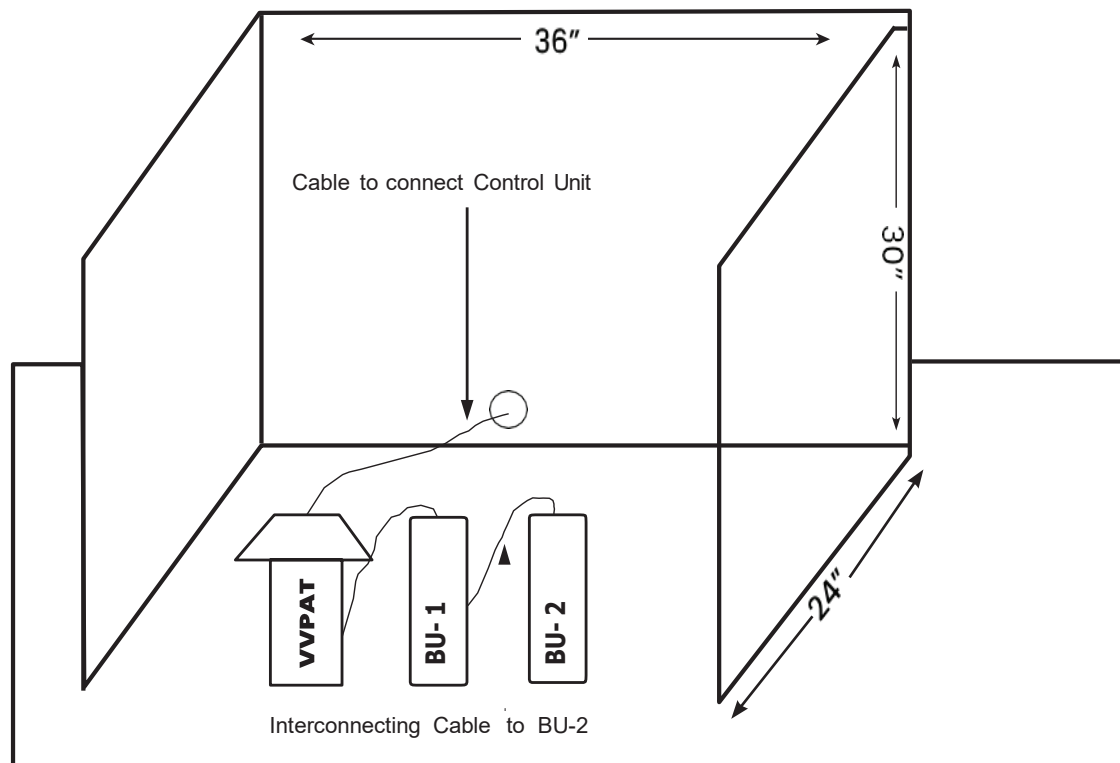
Name of State/UT:

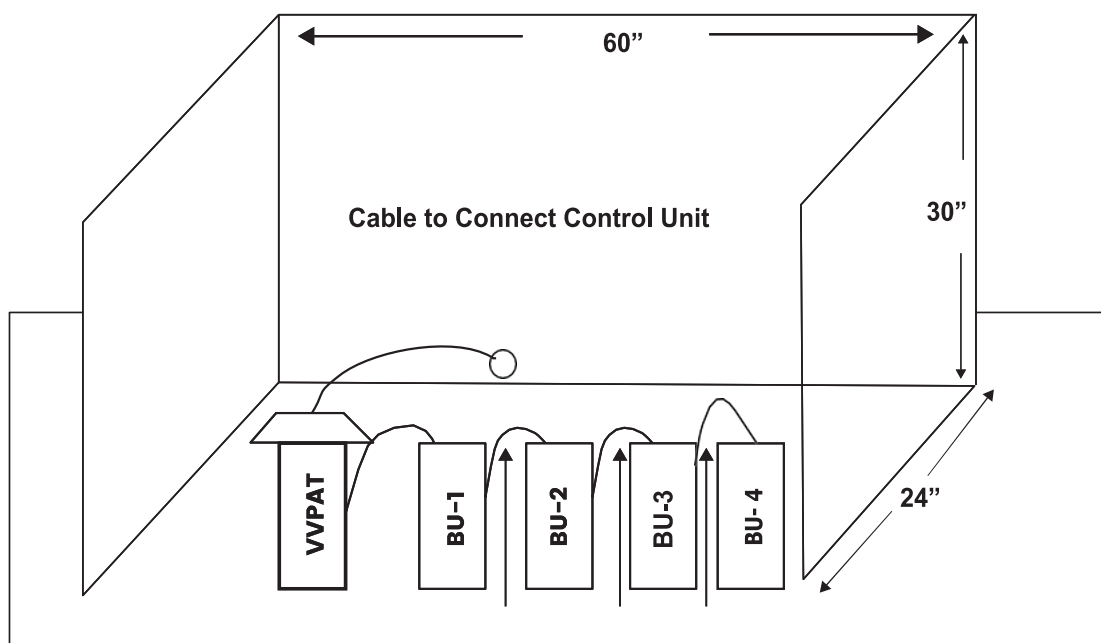
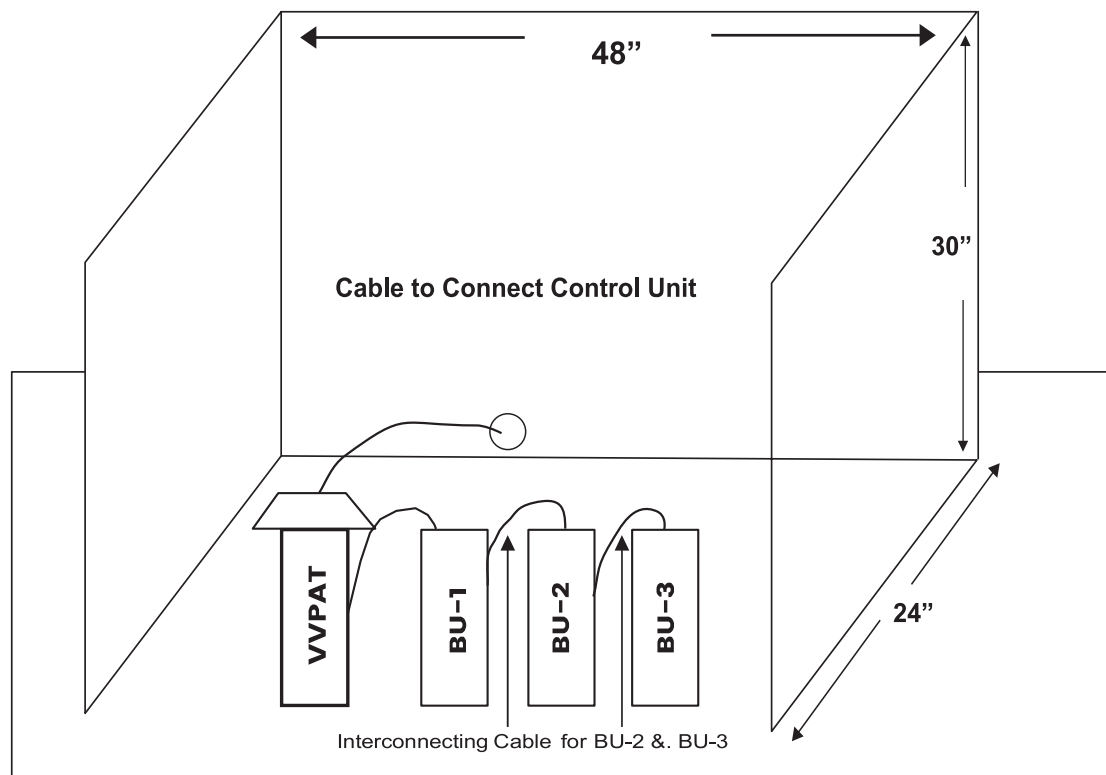
AC/PC No. and Name:

Date of Poll:

Polling Station No. and Name:

Note: The font and size printed on the stickers shall be clearly legible and readable.

ANNEXURE-28**Voting Compartment-Dimensions & Cascading of Ballot Units****Cascading of 1 BU****Cascading of 2 BUs**



ANNEXURE-29

GENERAL/Bye-Election to

SL No. and Name of Parliamentary/Assembly Constituency

No. and Name of Polling Station

FORM OF DECLARATION BY ELECTOR**UNDER RULE 49MA OF CONDUCT OF ELECTIONS RULES, 1961**

- (1) I hereby solemnly declare and affirm under sub-rule (1) of Rule 49 MA of the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961 that the paper slip generated by the printer attached to the Balloting Unit has shown the name and/or symbol of a candidate other than the candidate for whom I voted by pressing the concerned blue button against the name and symbol of the candidate of my choice on the Balloting Unit. I am ready to cast a test vote again to show that the allegation made by me is true and bona fide.
- (2) I am aware of the penal provisions of Section 175 of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 that I shall be liable to be punished with imprisonment for a term which may extend to six month, or with fine which may extend to one thousand rupees, or with both, if the declaration given by me in para-1 above to the Presiding Officer appointed under Section 26 of the RPAct, 1951 is found to be incorrect.

Signature/Thumb impression of the Elector

Name of the Elector.....

Father/Mother/Husband's Name.....

Part No. of elector roll.....

SI. No. of elector in that Part.....

SI. No. in Register of Voters (Form 17 A).....

Dated.....

Certified that the above declaration was made and subscribed by the elector above named before me.

Dated.....

Signature of the Presiding Officer.....

ANNEXURE-30**PRESIDING OFFICER'S REPORT****PART-I: MOCK POLL CERTIFICATE**

Name of Election: (to be pre-printed)

No. and Name of AC/AS (to be pre-printed)

No. and Name of PC (to be pre-printed)

Polling Station No. and Name:

(a) Conduct of mock poll and verification of mock poll data

Sl. No.	Name of Candidate including NOTA (to be pre-printed)	No. of Votes Cast During Mock Poll	No. of Vote Displayed in CU on Checking the Result	No. of VVPAT Printed Paper Slips Against Candidates	Result Displayed in CU and Printed Paper Slip Count Talled with Each Other (Yes/No)	Signature of Polling Agents with Party Abbreviation /Independent
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
	NOTA					
	TOTAL					

(b) 'CLEAR' button on the Control Unit has been pressed to clear mock poll data (Yes/No)

If Yes, then write the above sentence in ink

.....

(c) All paper slips taken out from VVPAT after mock poll (Yes/No)

(d) Empty VVPAT shown to all polling agents (Yes/No)

(e) Before actual poll ensure that no printed paper slip is in VVPAT Drop Box and shown to polling agents (Yes/No)

(f) 'TOTAL' button on the Control Unit has been pressed to show total vote '0' to polling agents (Yes/No)

- (g) Mock poll VVPAT slips stamped with 'MOCK POLL SLIP' and sealed in black envelope and then sealed with Pink Paper Seal (Yes/No)
- (h) Following polling agents witness the above process and certify that mock votes tallied, mock votes erased from the Control Unit and mock poll VVPAT slips removed from the VVPAT after mock poll and sealed in black envelope.

Sl. No.	Name of Polling Agent	Name of Party	Name of Candidate	Signature of Polling Agent

Time display on the Control Unit is minutes more/less than Indian Standard Time (IST), if any.

- (i) Signature of Micro-Observer (if posted at the polling station)

Name and Signature of the Presiding Officer

- (1) It is, hereby, certify that before commencement of actual poll, 'TOTAL' button of the Control Unit has been pressed in the presence of all polling officials to ensure that '**Total Vote is O**'.

Tick the appropriate observation:

- (i) Control Unit shows total vote 'O' OR
- (ii) Control Unit shows total vote more than 'O' (means mock poll votes not cleared), hence, clear the mock poll data.

(Signature of Presiding Officer)

Following Polling officers witness the above process and certify that mock votes erased from the Control Unit and mock poll VVPAT slips removed from the VVPAT before start of actual poll:

Sl. No.	Name of Polling Officer	Signature

PART-II POWER PACK REPLACEMENT IN CU**(TO BE FILLED DURING MOCK POLL, POLL & AFTER COMPLETION OF
POLL DEPENDING ON CASE/SITUATION)****Name of Election:** (to be pre-printed)**No. and Name of AC/AS** (to be pre-printed)**No. and Name of PC** (to be pre-printed)**Polling Station No. and Name:**.....

- (a) Details of replacement of Power Pack of the Control Unit during mock poll/actual poll (strike out which one is not applicable)
- (i) Unique ID of Control Unit:
- (ii) Reason for replacement of Power Pack of the Control Unit:.....
- (iii) Unique ID of old address tag that was cut by the Presiding Officer to replace the Power Pack of the Control Unit:.....
- (iv) Unique ID of new address tag used by the Presiding Officer to seal the Battery Section of the Control Unit:.....
- (b) Following polling agents witness the replacement of power pack from the Control Unit:

Sl. No.	Name of Polling Agent	Name of Party	Name of Candidate	Signature of Polling Agent

Repeat the above information in same format, if multiple replacements happen.**Signature of Presiding Officer****Signature of Sector Officer**

PRESIDING OFFICER'S REPORT
PART-III PRESSING OF CLOSE BUTTON
AFTER COMPLETION OF POLL

Name of Election..... (to be pre-printed)

No. & Name of AC/AS..... (to be pre-printed)

No. of Name of PC..... (to be pre-printed)

Date of Poll..... (to be pre-printed)

Number & Name of Polling Station:

It is certified that I have pressed the “Close Button” of the Control Unit at the end of poll in the presence of the following:

Sl. No.	Name and Designation of Polling Officer	Signature

Sl. No.	Name of Polling Agent	Name of Party	Name of Candidate	Signature of Polling Agent

Signature of the Presiding Officer

PART-IV:

EVM/VVPAT REPLACEMENT DURING MOCK POLL
(TO BE FILLED IF THERE IS ANY REPLACEMENT DURING MOCK POLL)

Name of Election:(to be pre-printed)

No. and Name of AC/AS(to be pre-printed)

No. and Name of PC(to be pre-printed)

Polling Station No. and Name:.....

- (a) Details of Electronic Voting Machine used- **(BU-Ballot Unit, CU-Control Unit and VVPAT – Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail)**

Sl. No.	Particulars	BU	CU	VVPAT	Signature of Sector Officer, in case of Replacement
1	Unique ID of units given at the time of dispersal				
2	(a) Tick (✓) which one found non functional during mock poll				
	(b) Reason for non-functioning (<i>mention error/code noticed in CU</i>)				
3	Unique ID of unit(s) given as replacement during mock poll				

- (b) Following polling agents witness the replacement process:

Sl. No.	Name of Polling Agent	Name of Party	Name of Candidate	Signature of Polling Agent

(Signature of Presiding Officer)

PART-V:**EVM REPLACEMENT DURING POLL****(TO BE FILLED IF THERE IS ANY REPLACEMENT DURING POLL)****Name of Election:**.....(to be pre-printed)**No. and Name of AC/AS:**.....(to be pre-printed)**No. and Name of PC**(to be pre-printed)**Polling Station No. and Name:**

a) Replacement of EVM during actual poll process

Sl. No.	Particulars	BU	CU	VVPAT
1	(a) Unique ID of unit(s) found non-functional during actual poll			
	(b) Time of occurrence of defects			
	(c) No. of votes recorded in the Control Unit by the time the unit(s) got non-functional			
	(d) Reason for non-functioning (<i>mention error/code noticed in CU</i>)			
	(e) Beep Sound is heard	Yes/No		
	(f) Unique ID of new unit(s) provided as replacement			
	(g) Time of re-starting poll			
2	Remarks, if any			

b) Following polling agents witness the replacement process during actual poll:

Sl. No.	Name of Polling Agent	Name of Party	Name of Candidate	Signature of Polling Agent

Repeat the above information in same format, if multiple replacements happen.

Signature of Presiding Officer**Signature of Sector Officer**

ANNEXURE-31**CERTIFICATE****FOR SECTOR OFFICERS / ZONAL MAGISTRATE etc.**

- a) Name of Election:
- b) No. and Name of Parliamentary/Assembly Constituency:
- c) No. and Name of Assembly Segment:

(In case of Parliamentary Constituency)

(To be filled at the time of dispersal)

- a) Name of Sector Officer/Zonal Magistrate:.....
- b) Cell No.:
- c) Polling Station Nos. assigned:
- d) Date and Time of receiving Reserve EVMs.....
- e) Details of reserve EVMs provided

Sl. No.	Unique ID of BU	Unique ID of CU	Unique ID of VVPAT

(To be filled on Poll day)

- (a) At the time of mock poll on poll day

Sl. No.	No. & Name of Polling Station	Unique ID of Units Replaced at Polling Station			Unique ID of Units Provided at Polling Station			Signature of Presiding Officer
		BU	CU	VVPAT	BU	CU	VVPAT	

- (b) At the time of Actual poll on poll day

Sl. No.	No. & Name of Polling Station	Unique ID of Units Replaced at Polling Station			Unique ID of Units Provided at Polling Station			Signature of Presiding Officer
		BU	CU	VVPAT	BU	CU	VVPAT	

(c) At the time of deposition of EVMs at Reception Centre

(i) Date and Time of Deposition of the Reserve EVMs.....

(ii) Detail of unused/Non-functional unused EVMs deposited at Reception Centre

Sl. No.	Unique ID of BU	Unique ID of CU	Unique ID of VVPAT

It is certified that the above information is correct.

(Signature)
Name of Sector Officer
Designation

It is certified that I have received the Unused/Non-functional unused EVMs and VVPATs as mentioned above from the Sector Officer (Name)

(Signature)
Name of RO / ARO

ANNEXURE-32**CERTIFICATE**

I..... (name), Returning Officer of (No. and name of AC/PC) of..... (district) in.....(State/UT) for the election to (General/Bye-election to AC/PC) hereby certify that all the unused reserve EVMs and VVPATs and non-functional un-pollled EVMs in respect of my AC/PC have been received from all the Sector Officers, the number tallied and accounted for and all these units have been safely stored in the earmarked strong-rooms, as per the extant instruction of Commission.

(Signature)

Name of RO

Date:

Place:

ANNEXURE-33**Mandatory Verification of paper slips of VVPAT of 05 randomly selected polling stations****(Separate for each polling station)**

Name of State/UT:.....

No. and Name of Assembly/Parliamentary Constituency:.....

No. and Name of Assembly Segment (in case of PC):

SL No. and Name of Polling Station:.....

Unique ID of Control Unit:.....

Unique ID of VVPAT:.....

It is certify that mandatory verification of paper slips of VVPAT of 05 randomly selected polling stations has been conducted as per the instructions of the Commission.

Name of Candidate	No. of Votes Cast		
	As per EVM	As per Printed Paper slips	Discrepancy, if any
1			
2			
3			
NOTA			
TOTAL VOTES			

Signature of Counting Agents

1.

2.

3.

Signature of Counting Supervisor

Signature of Returning Officer

Signature of General Observer

ANNEXURE-34**Mandatory Verification of paper slips of VVPAT of 05 randomly
selected polling stations****(To be sent to the Commission through the Zonal Secretary concerned)**

Name of State/UT:

No. and Name of Assembly/Parliamentary Constituency:

No. and Name of Assembly Segment (in case of PC):

SL No. and name of Polling Stations:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

It is to certify that the entire process of mandatory verification of counting of paper slips of VVPATs of randomly selected 05 polling stations has been conducted under my close and direct oversight with strict compliance of the Commission's instructions.

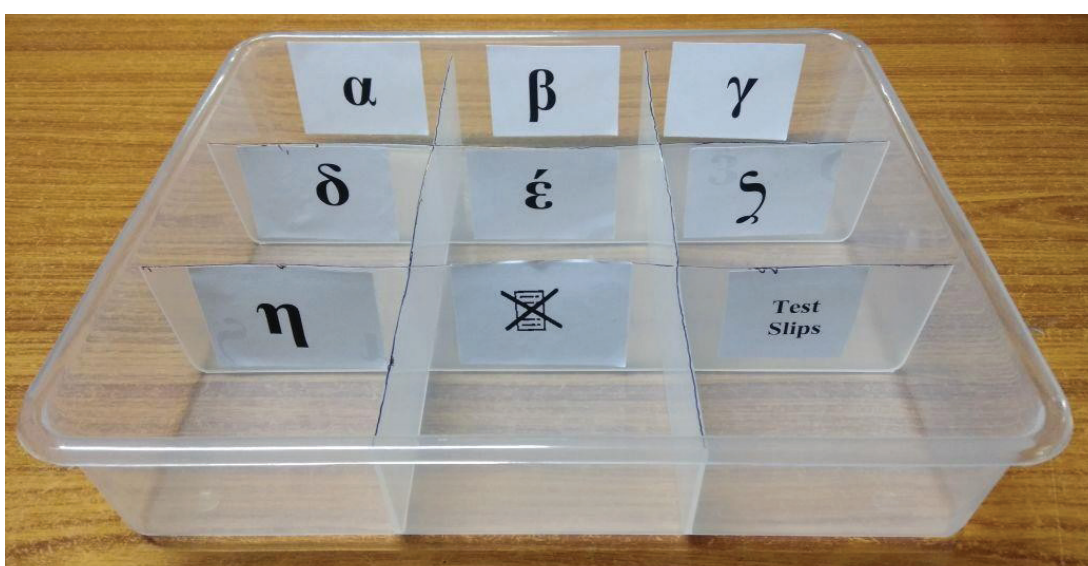
-Signature-

(Name of ECI Observer)

Observer Code:.....

ANNEXURE-35

Sample Container -14 inch X 10 inch X 5 inch (length X breadth X height)



Sample Pigeonholes (Size of each compartment 6 inch X 4 inch X 4 inch)

ANNEXURE-36**ANNEXURE to PART-II OF FORM 17-C****RESULT OF PRINTED PAPER COUNT****Polling Station No.****Total number of VVPATs used:****Unique ID of VVPATs:**

Sl.No, of Candidate	Name of Candidate	No. of Votes As Per Count of Printed Paper Slips of VVPAT	No. of Test Votes to be Deducted as per Item 5 of Part-I	No. of Valid Votes (3-4)
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

Total _____

Whether the total number of votes shown above tallies with the total number of votes shown against item 6 of Part I (YES/NO)

or any discrepancy noticed between the two totals.....

Place _____

Date _____

Signature of Counting Supervisor

Name or Candidate/ Election Agent/ Counting Agent

Full Signature

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

Place _____

Date _____

Signature of Returning Officer

ANNEXURE-37**FORM 17C**

[See rules 49S and 56C(2)]

PART I-ACCOUNT OF VOTES RECORDED

Election to House of the People/Legislative Assembly of the State/Union Territory.....
from.....constituency.

Number and Name of Polling Station:

Identification Number of voting Control Unit.....

Machine used at the Polling Station: Balloting Unit..... Printer (if used)

1. Total number of electors assigned to the Polling Station
2. Total number of voters as entered in the Register for Voters (Form 17A)
3. Number of voters deciding not to record votes under rule 49-O
4. Number of voters not allowed to vote under rule 49M
5. Test votes recorded under rule 49MA (d) required to be deducted-
 - (a) Total number of test votes to be deducted: Total No. SL.No.(s) elector(s) in Form 17A
.....
 - (b) Candidate(s) for whom test vote(s) cast: SL No. Name of candidate No. of votes
.....
6. Total number of votes recorded as per voting machine:
7. Whether the total number of votes as shown against item 6 tallies with the total number of votes as shown against item 2 minus numbers of voters deciding not to record votes as against item 3 minus number of voters as against item 4 (i.e. 2-3-4) or any discrepancy noticed:
8. Number of voters to whom tendered Ballot Papers were issued under rule 49P:
9. Number of tendered Ballot papers: SL No.
Total From To
 (a) received for use
 (b) issued to electors
 (c) not used and returned
10. Account of papers seals **Signature of polling agents**
 1. Paper seals supplied for use: Total No 1
SL No. from To
 2. Paper seals used: Total No 2
SL No. from To

3. Unused paper seals returned to Returning Officer:

Total No 3

4. Damaged paper seal, if any: SL No. from To

Total No 4

SL No. from To

Date

Place.....

Signature of Presiding Officer

Polling Station No

PART II – RESULT OF COUNTING

(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.

Total
Whether the total number of votes shown above tallies with the total number of votes shown against item 6 of Part I or any discrepancy noticed between the two totals.

Place

Date

Signature of Counting Supervisor

Name of candidate/Election Agent/Counting Agent

Full signature

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.

Place

Date

Signature of Returning Officer

ANNEXURE – 38**Appointment of Officer for shredding VVPAT slips**

It has been confirmed that no EP/Court Case is pending with regard to election _____

(Name of Election).

I hereby nominate Smt./Sh (name and designation), Officer in-charge responsible to shred VVPAT Paper slips pertaining to mock poll and actual poll _____ (Name of election).

The Officer shall submit a certificate that all VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll and actual poll of (name of election) have been shredded by using Paper Shredding Machines in his/her presence, within 7 days of issuing of this order.

By Order,

(District Election Officer)

Name of District:

ANNEXURE – 39**CERTIFICATE**

I,....., District Election Officer,....., hereby, certify that all the VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll and actual poll of (name of election), which are not involved in any Election Petition or Court Case, have been shredded out as per Rule 94 of our Conduct of Elections Rules 1961.

I, further certify that all the VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll and actual poll of (name of election, if any), which are involved in Election Petition or Court Case, have been kept, as per the Commission's instructions.

(District Election Officer)

Name of District:

ANNEXURE – 40**CERTIFICATE**

I, hereby, certify that certificates regarding disposal of all the VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll and actual poll of (name of election), which are not involved in any Election Petition or Court Case, have been received from all District Election Officers in the State. VVPAT paper slips pertaining to mock poll and actual poll of

(name of election) of the following district(s), have not been disposed of due to pendency of Election Petition or Court Case:

1.
2.
3.

(Chief Electoral Officer)

Name of State/UT:

ANNEXURE – 41**EVM-Checking & Verification Form****(To be filled by eligible candidates)**

To

The District Election Officer

.....(Name of district)

.....(Name of State)

Name of election and year

1. I.....(name), the candidate of(Name of AC/PC) was in position..... I would like to request for checking & verification of burnt memory/microcontroller for any tampering or modification in Ballot Unit, Control Unit and VVPAT for..... (name of Assembly Constituency/Assembly Segment of a Parliamentary Constituency).
2. Apart from EVM Checking and Verification (EVM C&V) through diagnostic check, I have also opted for mock poll, as per para 4 below. During mock poll, I opt to (Tick one of the following options)
(a) use already loaded symbols of VVPAT

OR

- (b) upload the symbol loaded on the Symbol Loading Units (SLU) in VVPAT afresh.
3. Signed lists of units/polling stations selected (maximum upto 5%) for checking & verification or/and units/polling stations selected for mock poll are attached herewith.
4. Summary of EVM C&V through diagnostic check and mock poll:

No. of EVM sets for C&V through diagnostic check only:	Total charges for C&V through diagnostic check only (inclusive of GST)	No. of EVM sets opted for mock poll also.	Total charges for mock poll (inclusive of GST)	Total charges (inclusive of GST)
(a) *	(b)	(c)	(d)	(e) = (c) + (d)

* Rs. 23,600/- per set (inclusive of GST); & Rs. 47,200/- per set (inclusive of GST)

5. Accordingly, I have paid the total applicable charges of EVMs C&V activity amounting to Rs.....and proof of payment by challan No.....paid at.....dated.....is attached herewith.
6. I, along with/or my representative Sh/Smt..... shall be present at the time of verification.

(Signature of candidate)

Name of Candidate:.....

Name of AC/PC:.....

Date:.....

Encl:

- (i) Signed list of BU/CU/VVPAT requested for checking and verification or/and mock poll.
- (ii) Proof of payment of applicable charges

ANNEXURE – 42**Summary of EVM-Checking & Verification Application****(to be filled by District Election Officer)**

To

The Chief Electoral Officer,

.....(Name of State/UT)

Subject: Summary of EVM-Checking & Verification Application.

Name of election and year

[

Madam/Sir,

I am to inform that total.....(number) EVM Checking & Verification Form(s) has/have been received.
Details are as under:

S. No.	Name of AC/AS of PC	Name of candidate with Party Affiliation, if any	Quantity of units to be checked and verified through diagnostic check only		
			BU	CU	VVPAT
S. No.	Name of AC/AS of PC	Name of candidate with Party Affiliation, if any	Quantity of units selected for mock poll also		
			BU	CU	VVPAT
Total no. of EVM sets selected for C&V through diagnostic check only					
Total no. of EVM sets selected for mock poll activity also.					
Amount paid by applicant candidate for diagnostic check and mock poll, if any					

It is also informed that applicable charges of Rs.

Rupees _____) has been received for the aforesaid purpose.

(Signature of DEO)

Name of DEO:

Name of District:

Date:

ANNEXURE – 43**Summary of EVM-Checking & Verification Application****(to be filled by Chief Electoral Officer)**

To

The Chairman-cum-Managing Director,

BEL/ECIL

Subject: Summary of EVM-Checking & Verification Application.

Name of election and year

Madam/Sir,

I am to inform that total.....(number) EVM Checking & Verification Form(s) has/have been received.

Details are as under:

S. No.	Name of AC/AS of PC	Name of candidate with Party Affiliation, if any	Quantity of units to be checked and verified through diagnostic check only		
			BU	CU	VVPAT
S. No.	Name of AC/AS of PC	Name of candidate with Party Affiliation, if any	Quantity of units selected for mock poll also		
			BU	CU	VVPAT
Total no. of EVM sets selected for C&V through diagnostic check only					
Total no. of EVM sets selected for mock poll activity also					
Amount paid by applicant candidate for EVM diagnostic check and mock poll, if any					

(Signature of CEO)

Name of CEO:

Name of State/UT:.....

Date:

Copy to:

Election Commission of India, New Delhi

Annexure – 44

(The Form will be preserved in the custody of DEO for a period of three months from date of issue)

Checking and Verification of EVM units-Daily Report

(To be submitted to the DEO at the end of every day of EVM C&V activity)

No. and Name of AC/PC:

No. and Name of AS (in case of PC):

Name of District:

Name of State/UT:

Date:

Start time:

End Time

S. No.	S.No. of BU	S.No. of CU	S.No. of VVPAT	Self-Diagnostic status (Functional/ Non-functional*)	Final EVM Checking and Verification status after self-diagnostic and mutual authentication tests (PASSED/NOT PASSED)

* In case a unit is non-functional, candidate has option to select another unit. In such case unit Sl.No. of replaced unit may be entered below unit Sl.No. of non-functional unit and mentioned 'replaced unit in bracket.

Name and Signature of

Engineer conducting the test

Name and Signature of

District-in-Charge

BEL/ECIL Engineer with ID No.

Annexure – 45**(This Form will be preserved in the custody of DEO for a period of three months from date of issue)****Certification for EVM burnt memory/ microcontroller****Checking and Verification conducted by BEL/ECIL****Date:.....**

Name of election and year:.....

No. and Name of AC/PC:.....

No. and Name of AS (in case of PC):.....

Name of District:.....

Name of State/UT:.....

Address of EVM C&V Hall:.....

It is certified that the following EVM units have passed the Checking and Verification process and there is no modification or tampering in the burnt memory/ microcontroller of the EVM listed below:

Sl. No.	Unit Type (BU/CU/VVPAT)	Unit Identification Number

.....

(Name and Signature of BEL/ECIL District-in-Charge engineer with ID No.)

(To be handed over to DEO)

ANNEXURE – 46

**(This Form will be preserved in the custody of DEO for a period of
three months from date of issue)**

Data/figures indicated in the EVM before erasing actual poll data

Date:.....

Name of election and year:.....

No. and Name of AC/PC:.....

No. and Name of AS (in case of PC):.....

Name of District:.....

Name of State/UT:.....

Date:

Polling Station No. and Name/ Unit ID	Candidate Serial Number	Candidate Serial Number-wise polled votes displayed on CU
	1	
	2	
	--	
	--	
	N	
		Total:

**Name and Signature
Applicant Candidate/
Authorised representative
present**

**Name and Signature
District Election Officer**

**Name and Signature
BEL/ECIL Engineer with ID
No.**

**Name and Signature
Successful Candidate/
Authorised representative
present**

**Name and Signature
All contesting candidates/
authorised representatives
present**

ANNEXURE – 47

**(This Form will be preserved in the custody of DEO for a period of
three months from date of issue)**

Mock Poll of EVM units- EVM Set-wise Daily Report

(To be submitted to the DEO at the end of every day)

No. and Name of AC/PC:.....

No. and Name of AS (in case of PC):.....

Name of District:.....

Name of State/UT:.....

Date:.....

Start time:

End time:

Unique ID of Ballot Unit(s)....., Control Unit.....and VVPAT.....

Sl.No.	Unit Type (BU/CU/VVPAT)	Unit Identification Number

.....

Name and Signature of Applicant candidate/authorised representative

Name and Signature of BEL/ECIL engineer with ID No.

Instructions issued after publication of EVM Manual**(Edition August, 2023)**

Sl. No.	Letter No.	Date	Subject
1	51/8/INST/2023-EMS	16 th October, 2023	EVM Brochure for Presiding Officer
2	51/8/INST/2023-EMS	24 th January, 2024	EVM Brochure for Candidate & Political Parties
3	51/8/INST/2024-EMS	8 th April, 2024	Advisory for using dummy ballot unit for awareness/campaigning by Political Parties and Candidates.
4	51/8/INST/2024-EMS	29 th April, 2024	Use of Symbol Loading Units (SLU) and storage of SLUs after commissioning of EVMs and VVPATs.
5	51/8/INST/2024-EMS	1 st June, 2024	Removal of VVPAT slips from VVPAT after completion of counting of votes.
6	51/8/INST/2024-EMS	17 th June, 2025	Checking and verification of burnt memory/microcontroller of EVMs post the announcement of results
7	51/8/INST/2025-EMS	24 th June, 2025	Counting of VVPAT slips in case of non-deletion of mock poll data from the control unit, non-removal of mock poll slips from VVPAT and mismatch between votes recorded in CU and Part-I of Form 17C.



भारत निर्वाचन आयोग Election Commission of India

Nirvachan Sadan, Ashoka Road, New Delhi-110001

“Greater Participation for a stronger democracy”